

How HSBC and Standard Chartered are riding high on Asia's wealth

Samuel Norman

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London's banking giants are circling the UK's **wealth management** pie. But two other top lenders could be carving out a feast 6,000 miles away. HSBC and Standard Chartered posted hefty bumps to their wealth divisions, driven by a strategic focus on Asia and the Middle East. In financial results shared on Wednesday, HSBC revealed bank-wide [...]

London's banking giants are circling the UK's **wealth management** pie. But two other top lenders could be carving out a feast 6,000 miles away.

HSBC and Standard Chartered posted hefty bumps to their [wealth divisions](#), driven by a strategic focus on Asia and the Middle East.

In financial results shared on Wednesday, HSBC revealed bank-wide wealth revenue topped \$9.4bn in 2025, up by nearly a quarter when compared with 2024's report.

The growth rapidly outpaced other divisions. In wholesale transaction banking, where the bank provides financial services to large corporate and government entities, revenue edged up four per cent. And in banking net interest income, income eked out just 0.2 per cent growth.

It comes as [chief executive Georges Elhedery](#) looks to strip away reliance on interest-bearing revenue streams amid falling rates and double down on areas like **wealth management**, which are less volatile due to relying on more capital-light sources of income in recurring fees.

In 2025, HSBC's International Wealth and Premier Banking division generated 14.6 per cent of group profit at \$4.4bn, whilst holding just ten per cent of the bank's risk-weighted assets (RWA). Elsewhere, the lender's corporate and institutional banking division made up just under 40 per cent of profit but held around 46 per cent of RWA.

Under regulatory standards, banks must maintain capital in reserves relative to the amount of RWAs it holds, meaning the fewer riskier assets, the more cash it can dish out to shareholders through dividends and buybacks.

Asia – the engine for wealth

Russ Mould, investment director at AJ Bell, told City AM the “well-heeled, sticky customers, who are prepared to pay the fees for a high-quality service” bode well for diversifying mainstream banks.

The area bore fruit for Elhedery's banking titan in the final quarter of 2025 with over \$2.1bn pocketed in fees in the three months to December alone – a 20 per cent increase on the same period in 2024.

The engine fuelling this growth came almost solely from Hong Kong, which enjoyed a 40 per cent surge in wealth income to \$2.2bn in 2025. Meanwhile, on the UK front, wealth income contracted 13 per cent to \$391m, largely due to the increased cost of customer rewards associated with the group's relaunch of its premier bank account.

Following the latest financial year, Asia holds more than \$1tn in the group's wealth balances.

But, Elhedery still remains committed to wealth expansion across the UK – even as more [mass affluent Brits lose confidence in the UK economy](#) following the Labour government's over £65bn tax grab since coming to power.

HSBC splashed [\\$5m on a wealth centre in the heart of London](#) last year in a bid to cater to high-earning customers in the City. In September, the bank also opened its Leeds Wealth Centre, serving over 350 clients holding between \$5m and \$50m assets.

"We have a strong market position," Elhedery said on Wednesday when discussing the UK wealth performance.

"We are growing and we continue to invest for growth".

Mould said: "Going forward, it still seems a reasonable premise that demographics and income trends means **wealth management** is a potentially strong, growth business, especially in Asia, even allowing for the current travails of China and Hong Kong."

He added it takes "little imagination" to see how wealth could continue to boom in the region as populations grow and economic growth expands.

Bank battle heats up for wealth push

The pattern is mirrored in HSBC's [FTSE 100 peer Standard Chartered](#), which revealed on Tuesday wealth income had rocketed 24 per cent to \$3bn after a bumper performance across investment and life insurance.

Mould notes HSBC and Standard Chartered report their divisional breakdowns differently making a direct comparison difficult, but adds 2025 numbers more than showed why "**wealth management**" is a key business for both, and why other financial services providers would like to enhance their offering".

Stanchart's total affluent assets under management jumped 22 per cent to \$447bn as the bank sealed a top 3 spot for the biggest **wealth managers** in Asia.

Momentum particularly came from Hong Kong, Singapore and Korea, where the lender opened seven new centres in the last 12 months, bringing the total to 18.

The bank also onboarded 275,000 new affluent clients in 2025, heavily concentrated in Asian markets.

Both banks have laid out gutsy targets for the years ahead with Standard Chartered aiming for \$200bn in net new money from affluent clients by 2029 and HSBC hoping to double its assets under management to £100bn by 2028.

And rival banks are hot on their heels with a push into **wealth management**.

Natwest launched its first major acquisition since re-entering privatisation earlier this month with a [£2.7bn deal for wealth manager Evelyn Partners](#).

The bank also seemed prepared to displease some investors with the move, as it said it would halt share buybacks until the second half of 2027 as part of the acquisition.

With Evelyn's £69bn assets under management under the Natwest umbrella, the bank will boast a total of £127bn assets, making it the largest of the bank-owned **wealth managers**.

Elsewhere, Lloyds made a play late last year to [take control of its six-year old wealth tie up](#) with Schrodgers. The group serves around 60,000 with near-£17bn in assets.

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News

London's Asian banks want slice of wealth pie

SAMUEL NORMAN

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LONDON banking giants are circling the UK's **wealth management** pie but full-year reporting season revealed two lenders carving out a feast 6,000 miles away.

HSBC and Standard Chartered posted hefty bumps to their wealth divisions, driven by a strategic focus on Asia and the Middle East.

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BANKING & FINANCE

Singapore remains 'bedrock' for family offices: StanChart's private bank head

Tan Nai Lun
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MORE wealthy families with family offices in Singapore are setting up additional bases in other hubs such as Hong Kong, Dubai or Abu Dhabi, said Raymond Ang, global head of private bank and affluent clients at Standard Chartered.

While Singapore "will always be the bedrock" for setting up family offices in Asia, different centres have their roles and strengths, and serve different purposes, said Ang, who is also head of wealth and retail banking for Greater China and North Asia.

According to the latest available data, the number of single-family offices in Singapore exceeded 2,000 as at end-2024, up 43 per cent on year.

Meanwhile, Hong Kong recorded 3,384 family offices as at end-2025, up 25 per cent on year. The Dubai International Financial Centre tracks family-related entities instead – which includes holding companies and foundations – and saw 1,289 of such entities as at end-2025, a 61 per cent increase from a year earlier.

"In the beginning, a lot of family offices chose Singapore as a result of wanting a safe haven, good governance and residency," he said. "But as the family offices get bigger... they want investable assets as well."

Singapore has a head start over Hong Kong and the United Arab Emirates when it comes to building an ecosystem to attract family offices, he noted.

But Hong Kong is also attractive, given its strong trading flow and active capital market, while the two cities in the UAE provide businesses a "great place of access" to the West.

These Asian families are mimicking those in the West, where the wealthy typically open their family offices in three to four places.

"In a way, it's an evolution of the tenor of wealth," Ang said.

For a bank like StanChart – which has booking centres in Singapore, Hong Kong, the UAE and Jersey – this is good news, Ang noted.

"Exactly because we are a network bank – we practice an advisory centre and booking centre kind of framework – so it doesn't matter whether a client chooses to book in Singapore, Hong Kong, Dubai or London," he said.

StanChart has ambitions to grow its affluent business. In 2024, it set a target to hit US\$200 billion in net new money and double-digit wealth growth by 2029.

With a US\$1.5 billion investment, the bank plans to hire more relationship managers, accelerate product innovation, improve its digital experience, and upgrade and launch new client centres.

It is "particularly focused" on serving global Chinese and global Indian clients.

That these two groups dominate flows is a "natural consequence", said Ang, given that China and India are the most populous countries in the world.

On top of having “culturally attuned” multilingual relationship managers, the bank has also boosted flagship client centres in key markets like mainland China, Hong Kong and Singapore, and launched dedicated Global Indian centres.

The bank’s strategy has worked thus far – its client mix has already gravitated towards the high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth segment, from the “medium range” segment.

In the past 12 quarters, it added more than 60,000 new-to-bank affluent clients each quarter.

“With this big shift (in client mix), the hub countries become very important, because when clients have more than a million dollars, they are usually more international in nature,” Ang said.

For the 2025 financial year, the bank recorded assets under management of US\$447 billion for its wealth and retail banking segment, of which 54 per cent was from its wealth segment.

Net new money from its affluent clients – those with at least S\$200,000 in deposits or investments with the bank – stood at US\$51.5 billion.

In comparison, net new money stood at US\$27.1 billion in FY2023 and US\$43.9 billion in FY2024.

On Tuesday, StanChart reported in its full-year results that pre-tax profit rose 16 per cent to US\$6.96 billion, on the back of robust performances from its global banking and wealth businesses.

In particular, its wealth management business stood out, with income up 24 per cent in 2025, driven by double-digit growth in both investment products and bancassurance.

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Business

Standard Chartered's 2025 profit jumps 16% buoyed by robust **wealth management growth**

Enoch Yiu

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The London-based bank's underlying pre-tax profit stood at US\$7.9 billion last year, versus a gain of US\$6.8 billion in 2024

Standard Chartered Bank, one of Hong Kong's three note-issuing banks, reported a 16 per cent profit jump for 2025, as strong **wealth management** growth helped it weather rising bad debt from the city's commercial real estate slump.

The London-based bank, which generates much of its revenue from Asia, reported an underlying pre-tax profit of US\$7.9 billion last year, compared with US\$6.8 billion in 2024, according to a stock exchange filing on Tuesday. This matched analysts' estimate of US\$7.9 billion.

Underlying earnings per share stood at US\$2.297, and the bank proposed a 49 US cents final dividend, bringing the total for 2025 to 61 US cents. A year earlier, it paid 37 US cents. The bank said it would set aside US\$1.5 billion to buy back shares this year, after spending US\$1.5 billion on buy-backs last year.

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"We have made a good start to the year and continue to benefit from a supportive business environment," CEO Bill Winters said in a media briefing.

Winters said the bank had seen "robust growth in all major markets" as corporate clients sought its help to diversify supply chains, while wealthy customers in India and mainland China used its international network to invest overseas via Hong Kong and Singapore.

He added that digital assets would be a key area of development, with the bank hoping to be among the first to receive a stablecoin issuer licence in Hong Kong when the Hong Kong Monetary Authority begins granting approvals in March, though the final decision rests with the regulator.

The bank's shares jumped 3 per cent to close at HK\$197.90 on Tuesday after the earnings announcement, while the broader Hang Seng Index fell almost 1.8 per cent.

Benjamin Hung, president of international at Standard Chartered, said Hong Kong's economy and capital markets had performed well in the first seven weeks this year, and he was positive about the whole year outlook.

Hong Kong remains Standard Chartered's biggest market, with its pre-tax profit in the city jumping 40 per cent to US\$2.66 billion, representing 34 per cent of the total.

But Hong Kong's property slump also meant that the bank had to contend with a higher level of bad debt. Standard Chartered's bad debt charge increased 21 per cent to US\$676 million, which included US\$253 million in Hong Kong and a US\$78 million exposure to mainland China, covering bad debt in commercial real estate, as well as defaults on credit card and personal loans.

"We continued to de-risk in China and Hong Kong commercial real estate, and have limited exposures to US regional banks and insurance companies," the lender's statement said.

However, Winters said the bank had made sufficient provisions to cover the risks, noting that its Hong Kong exposure was largely to high-quality, large developers.

"In addition, we have seen the property markets in Hong Kong become more stable," he said.

Winters also said the bank benefited from the strong growth of its **wealth management** business, which expanded 24 per cent to a record US\$3.09 billion, compared with US\$2.49 billion a year earlier.

Standard Chartered said it added 275,000 new affluent clients in 2025, with net new affluent money under management rising to US\$52 billion during the year, bringing the total to US\$447 billion as at the end of 2025.

The bank's net interest margin, an important measure of profitability, narrowed to 2.03 per cent at the end of December 2025, compared with 2.06 per cent a year earlier.

Net interest income rose 1 per cent to US\$11.18 billion in 2025, compared with US\$11.09 billion in 2024. Operating income, which is equivalent to revenue in US accounting terms, rose 6 per cent to US\$20.89 billion in 2025, from US\$19.7 billion a year earlier based on constant currency exchange rates.

The lender's digital banking business continued to report losses.

SC Ventures' underlying pre-tax loss stood at US\$167 million in 2025, narrowing from a loss of US\$385 million in 2024. The segment includes its majority-owned virtual banks Mox in Hong Kong and Trust in Singapore.

For the fourth quarter alone, Standard Chartered's underlying pre-tax profit rose 20 per cent to US\$1.2 billion, from US\$1 billion a year earlier.

Maria Ramos, group chairwoman, said in a Hong Kong media briefing that the bank had achieved its three-year growth target a year ahead of the original deadline at the end of this year. The bank thus would hold a new strategy planning day in Hong Kong in May, she added.

"Hong Kong is a critical market for Standard Chartered, so it is a natural choice for us to hold the strategy day here," she said.

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Cap Group's distribution boss on Asia no-load tie ups & advisor training

William Robins

520 words

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Citywire Asia

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Capital Group is pivoting away from the product push to combat the short-term fund flipping prevalent in Asian wealth management, with heavy investments in advisor coaching and a recent 'no-load' partnership with DBS Bank.

Guy Henriques, Capital Group's head of client group for Europe and Asia, said the firm teamed up with DBS Bank to offer local investors access to its flagship balanced fund. It offers a share class that carries no upfront sales charge.

'The back-end load, or no-load model, favours people holding a strategy for a longer time,' Henriques said. 'You can do that in a different way, which actually spreads that over a certain period of time. You don't have an upfront fee, but the fee gets charged as time goes on.'

The end cost to the client remains the same. 'It's not cheaper or more expensive, but it encourages people to invest for the longer term,' he added.

This structural shift is designed to combat the high-turnover environment in Asia.

Historically, Henriques noted, 'investors would go into a fund. It would go up a bit, then sell it. They buy another fund. Every time they bought and sold, they were paying a commission.'

Henriques cites Japan as the blueprint for this evolution, where the industry successfully transitioned from a transactional 'trading culture' to one focused on long-term wealth.

Beyond the shelf space

While the firm is aggressively pushing long-term partnership models, it is still willing to engage in tactical, bespoke deals to help partners differentiate.

A recent example includes a period of exclusivity for UBS on the Capital Group Multi-Sector Income fund, allowing the private bank to align the launch with its internal CIO Office view.

'Every now and again, clients will come and say, "Look, we want to differentiate ourselves. We would like something that nobody else has,"' Henriques said.

Capital Group is also exporting insights gleaned from the 220,000 financial advisers it works with in the US to help Asian distributors boost their own productivity.

'We have a client in Asia that came to us and said, "Look, we need to get our advisers and bankers to be more productive,"' Henriques explained.

'You can help them grow their business. Our business will grow with it. So it's a win, win. But you need to have those resources.'

Partnerships

Since Henriques joined in 2019, Capital's AUM has climbed from \$2tn to over \$3tn in 2026, fueled by high-conviction wealth partnerships:

* 2022: Exclusive UBS launch for [Capital Group Multi-Sector Income fund](#)

* 2023: Global deal with HSBC for the [Capital Group Global Corporate Bond fund \(LUX\)](#)

* 2024: DBS partnership in Singapore and Hong Kong for the global corporate bond and its [New Economy fund](#)

Henriques shared these insights during a recent visit to the Citywire studio, where he disclosed how Capital Group puts substance into its partnerships.

Having joined Capital Group in 2019 after 13 years at Schroders, Henriques now oversees all distribution outside the US.

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Business

UOB to reward junior staff with one-off payout despite fall in Q4 and 2025 net profit

Sheila Chiang

505 words

23 February 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

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SINGAPORE - UOB will give junior employees an extra half-month base salary payout, in recognition of their contributions amid a challenging external environment.

About 6,000 employees across the group are expected to benefit from the one-off payment.

The payouts will total about \$4 million and be disbursed in the second quarter of 2026, the bank said in its earnings report on Feb 24.

UOB also recommended a final dividend of 71 cents per ordinary share, bringing total dividend for 2025 to \$1.56 - a payout ratio of approximately 50 per cent.

It comes as UOB reported a 7 per cent fall in fourth-quarter net profit as net interest income moderated amid margin headwinds.

Earnings for the three months ended December were \$1.41 billion, down from \$1.52 billion a year ago. The figure missed analysts' forecast of \$1.44 billion in a Bloomberg poll.

Net fee income delivered broad based growth of 10 per cent year on year, while other non-interest income fell 28 per cent on lower trading and investment income. Total expenses declined 3 per cent from disciplined spending while total allowances halved due to lower specific allowance.

The group's performing loans coverage was stable at 1 per cent. Non-performing loan ratio stood at 1.5 per cent, with non-performing assets coverage adequate at 97 per cent or 254 per cent after taking collateral into account.

For 2025, net profit was \$4.7 billion, a 23 per cent drop from \$6.05 billion a year ago, beating a Bloomberg forecast of \$4.64 billion.

UOB said the drop in earnings was largely due to the pre-emptive general allowances that the group proactively set aside in the third quarter to strengthen provision coverage amid growing macroeconomic uncertainties.

Allowances for credit and other losses more than quadrupled to \$1.36 billion in the third quarter, from \$304 million a year earlier.

For 2026, UOB guided for full-year NIM of 1.75 per cent to 1.80 per cent, low single-digit loan growth and high single-digit fee growth.

It also expects low single-digit operating cost growth and total credit costs at 25 to 30 basis points.

UOB deputy chairman and chief executive Wee Ee Cheong said in a statement: "The group delivered a resilient full-year performance, fuelled by strong fee momentum across our diversified business franchise. Our balance sheet is strong with robust capital and liquidity and stable asset quality."

He noted that Asean's growth trajectory remains intact and the group is seeing steady momentum across its business lines.

UOB's results followed that of larger peer DBS Group which posted a 10 per cent year-on-year fall in fourth-quarter net profit as sharply lower interest rates and a stronger Singapore dollar hit loan margins.

OCBC is set to report its earnings on Feb 25.

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Former StanChart PB India head joins Nexedge Capital

Priyanka Boghani

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The former Standard Chartered **Private Bank** India head has resurfaced at a fledgling Indian wealth firm, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Pankaj Walia has joined Nexedge Capital as co-founder, based in Delhi, after over [two decades](#) at the British lender.

Walia will lead efforts to boost the firm's onshore India wealth assets, in what has become an increasingly crowded market.

He joins industry veteran, Anirudha Taparia, who founded Nexedge Capital five months ago. The new investment firm has already drawn in almost \$2bn in assets, according to a January 2026 Bloomberg report. Taparia was a former joint-CEO at Indian wealth giant 360 ONE WAM. He also spent several years at Citi as a **private banker**.

Nexedge will look to capture the growing wealth pie created from wealthy individuals and family offices in the country. It has six offices in India so far, according to the report. The firm joins a growing cohort of wealth outfits, including Neo Group, which is aggressively hiring from established wealth NBFCs and **private banks**.

At StanChart, Walia helped drive the bank's growth in India, overseeing the opening of several **private banking** centres across the country, including in non-metro locations.

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Exclusive: Barclays nabs senior private banker from DBS

Paromita Dey
405 words
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Barclays has poached a senior private banking executive from Singapore-headquartered DBS Bank as it accelerates its push for ultra-wealthy clients in the Middle East, Citywire Middle East has learned.

Murtaza Gilani has joined Barclays UAE as the head of GCC coverage for ultra-high-net-worth individuals (UHNWI) across the GCC and Levant — a newly broadened remit that underscores the bank's ambitions to scale its regional wealth franchise.

<figure></figure>

Reporting to Farzad Billimoria (pictured), [head of Barclays PB UAE](#), Gilani is mandated to increase focus on deepening UHNW relationships within Gulf families and internationally mobile entrepreneurs, while strengthening senior relationship management coverage in Dubai, now one of the world's fastest-growing wealth hubs.

Gilani brings more than two decades of cross-border banking experience, having held senior roles at Standard Chartered, Samba Financial Group ABN Amro & DBS across Asia and the Middle East.

At DBS, Gilani worked as the head of Middle East team, leading senior relationship managers.

A Barclays spokesperson confirmed the appointment of Gilani.

The hire reflects Barclays' broader strategic pivot toward high-growth wealth corridors. Since 2025, the UK lender has stepped up senior hiring and expansion to capture surging capital inflows into the Gulf, driven by family office migration, entrepreneurial wealth and global asset reallocation.

Recent moves include [appointing](#) former Emirates NBD executive Lama Aboufakhr to lead Middle East private-banking coverage from London, alongside [securing](#) a provisional Saudi Capital Market Authority licence — positioning Barclays to launch full investment-banking and global-markets operations in Riyadh by 2026.

HSBC Private Banking's former head of family office coverage for the global India and global South Asia (GSA) segment, Pritash Mathur (pictured), relocated to Dubai last month [to join](#) Barclays as the PB head for international coverage across the non-resident Indians (NRI) segment, Africa and Global South Asia corridors.

<figure></figure>

Mathur brings over 25 years of experience working with globally mobile UHNW clients and will work closely with colleagues in the investment and corporate bank to deliver a seamless, one-bank experience for clients..

Dania Daoud, who was the managing director at LGT Wealth Management in Dubai, joined the bank's wealth management team as a director in October last year.

Amid the hiring spree, Barclays' veteran banker, Rasha Badawi, who held the title of private banking UAE CEO and Mena head, [exited](#) after 15 years.

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Business

investment - DBS calls for discipline in volatile world

416 words

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Bangkok Post

BKPOST

English

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Disciplined diversification, long-term conviction, and a focus on structural themes are vital for investors to navigate global markets this year amid elevated volatility, uneven interest rate paths and persistent geopolitical risks, says Singapore-based DBS Bank.

Edwin Tan, market head of DBS, said 2025 delivered resilient yet uneven returns amid sticky inflation, shifting expectations for interest rate cuts, and heightened policy and geopolitical uncertainty.

The year underscored how quickly market dynamics can change, as the US passage of the Genius Act marked a milestone in the adoption of digital assets, while American tariff announcements triggered sharp repricing across equities, currencies, and other risk assets, highlighting the influence of policy and geopolitics on global capital flows.

"The lesson from 2025 was resilience does not come from predictions, but rather from disciplined diversification, selectivity and active stewardship," he said.

Looking ahead, DBS expects inflation to moderate and the trajectory of interest rates to remain uneven, while geopolitical developments continue to shape market sentiment. Long-term structural forces, ranging from technological disruption to demographic change, are redefining how wealth is created, preserved and transferred, said Mr Tan.

As longer, healthier lives are reshaping financial planning across work, family and legacy considerations, DBS's **private banking** strategy is increasingly focused on helping clients plan for longer time horizons.

In Thailand, DBS **Private Bank** has strengthened its wealth management platform through deeper client engagement, talent development, and closer collaboration across **private banking**, investment banking, institutional banking, and wealth planning under its one bank model.

Unlike traditional one bank concepts, DBS's approach integrates not only private, corporate, investment and retail banking, but also industry-leading wealth planning capabilities such as trust services, insurance partnerships, single and multi-family office solutions, variable capital company structures, and philanthropic advisory.

The bank also plans to launch a discretionary portfolio-managed fund in Thailand, allowing the chief investment officer's investment views to be implemented more efficiently within client portfolios, Mr Tan said.

As markets enter an "era of extremes", DBS said investors must resist short-term reactions and remain anchored to long-term objectives.

"Playing the long game means staying disciplined through cycles, combining insight with perspective, and stewarding wealth with conviction and care across generations," he said.

With Thailand's wealth management market becoming more sophisticated, the bank is well-positioned to support the evolving needs of wealthy clients through its integrated platform and focus on long-term value creation, said Mr Tan.

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KGI recruits from HSBC to lead wealth planning unit

Citywire Asia Staff

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KGI has recruited from HSBC Life for a new managing director of **wealth management**, effective 10 February 2026.

Based in Hong Kong, Aaron Long reports to James Wey, head of international **wealth management**, according to a 10 February release.

Long is tasked with leading the firm's wealth advisory practice and accelerating the distribution of wealth products. He will also focus on developing integrated solutions tailored to high net worth clients across the region.

Prior to joining the firm, Long held senior roles at HSBC, Manulife, AIG, and Aflac across China and the US. His most recent tenure included five years scaling HSBC China's **wealth management** business, where he served as the inaugural CEO of its life insurance brokerage firm starting in 2022.

The appointment is the latest in a series of senior hires as the firm builds out its international **wealth management** division under Wey, who joined in mid-2024 from JP Morgan.

Wey set goals in 2024 to [recruit](#) 50 relationship managers by 2026.

Last July, KGI [hired](#) Bryan Low as head of international **wealth management** for Singapore and Amigo Wang as relationship manager, team head for the firm's international **wealth management**.

These hires were followed by the appointment of [Cusson Leung](#) as chief investment officer for KGI Asia in late 2024, to lead regional investment and asset allocation strategies.

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StanChart taps UBS veteran to lead CIB-wealth collab

Citywire Asia Staff

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English

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Standard Chartered has kicked off the year in aggressive expansion mode, appointing a new global head of private client sales to lead a collaboration between its corporate and investment banking and wealth divisions.

Raza Jafree joined the bank on 2 February and is based in Hong Kong, according to a 9 February statement.

He reports jointly to Sharad Desai, global head of sales and structuring, CIB, and Raymond Ang, global head of **private bank** and affluent clients, and head of WRB for Greater China and North Asia.

In his new role, Jafree will lead a partnership between the corporate and investment banking unit (CIB) and the wealth and retail banking (WRB) business.

His team will offer relevant CIB solutions to single family offices and ultra high net worth individuals, both within the **private bank** as well as current clientele managed by the CIB arm.

Jafree joins after a long tenure at Credit Suisse, distributing bespoke solutions across products including private and public credit, rates, recourse and non-recourse financing.

Investment and product build-out

The appointment is the latest in a series of strategic moves to bolster the bank's investment engine.

To support its discretionary portfolio management push, the bank recently named [Sylvain Huard](#), formerly of BNP Paribas, as head of asset allocation.

Its chief investment office also saw [senior additions](#) from UBS and JP Morgan Asset Management: Sundeep Gantori joined as CIO for equities in Singapore, while Jonathan Liang was named CIO for fixed income and FX in Hong Kong.

On the product side, the bank has leaned on its long-standing [Liverpool FC partnership](#) to scale its Signature CIO funds.

It has also partnered [Barings](#) to run a collateralised loan obligation (CLO) strategy under its Singapore-regulated Variable Capital Company (VCC) platform.

In the front office, the bank continues to grow its coverage of the Greater China market, recently hiring [Hu Hong](#) from Bank of Singapore as group market head.

There has also been some leadership churn in South Asia. The bank recently saw the departure of its head of **private banking** for India [Pankaj Walia](#).

Document CWIRAS0020260209em2900001

THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

DBS to give junior staff \$1,000 special bonus; nearly 6,800 in S'pore to benefit

Sheila Chiang

404 words

9 February 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

English

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SINGAPORE - DBS on Feb 9 announced that it will be paying a special one-time bonus of \$1,000 to junior employees, as Singapore's largest bank by assets reported resilient earnings for 2025.

Over 23,000 employees across the bank's global footprint, including nearly 6,800 employees in Singapore, will benefit from this initiative.

The payouts are expected to total \$18 million, DBS said.

DBS chief executive Tan Su Shan said in a Feb 9 statement: "In spite of a difficult environment, DBS delivered a resilient set of results and we wanted to specially recognise the contributions of our junior staff."

Fourth-quarter earnings were \$2.26 billion, down 10 per cent from \$2.52 billion a year ago, mainly because of lower interest rate margins (NIM). NIM narrowed 22 basis points to 1.93 per cent due to lower interest rates and a stronger Singdollar.

Net profit for 2025 fell 3 per cent to \$10.9 billion due to higher tax expenses from the implementation of the 15 per cent global minimum tax rate. Full-year profit before tax amounted to \$13.1 billion, up 1 per cent from a year ago, as total income rose 3 per cent to \$22.9 billion despite a challenging rate environment.

During a results briefing on Feb 9, Ms Tan said the bank mitigated against headwinds with nimble balance sheet management, increasing fixed-rate assets to \$210 billion and strong deposit growth.

DBS had previously paid out a similar supplement of \$1,000 to junior-ranked employees in 2024, amounting to \$15 million. It also rewarded all staff, excluding senior managers, with a special one-time bonus of \$1,000 each in February 2025.

The bank said it plans to continue paying capital return dividends of 15 cents per share per quarter for the financial years of 2026 and 2027, barring unforeseen circumstances.

DBS proposed a total dividend of 81 cents for the fourth quarter, consisting of a final ordinary dividend of 66 cents and a capital return dividend of 15 cents per share. This brings the total dividend for 2025 to \$3.06 per share, up 38 per cent from the previous year.

Shares of DBS closed 1.87 per cent lower at \$58.19 on Feb 9.

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Document STIMES0020260209em29001md

THE STRAITS TIMES

Singapore

UOB extends opening hours, goes appointment-only for gold purchases at main branch counters

Vihanya Rakshika

334 words

9 February 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

English

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SINGAPORE – UOB customers who wish to buy or convert their holdings into physical gold at the bank's main branch will have a larger window of time to do so from Feb 13.

They will also have to make an appointment for these services, said UOB in a statement on Feb 9, amid a recent surge in demand for physical gold.

From Feb 13, gold counters at UOB's main branch in Raffles Place will stay open for 1½ hours longer on weekdays, from 9.30am to 6pm, excluding public holidays. The counters currently close at 4.30pm.

Those who wish to buy physical gold or convert their Gold Savings Account holdings into physical gold must make an appointment ahead of time. The bank will no longer accept walk-in gold purchases or conversions from Feb 13.

Customers can book their appointments via UOB's website from 6pm on Feb 12.

"With this measure, wait times should be reduced and customers can be served at the timing of their reservation," said UOB.

Customers who wish to sell gold back to UOB can continue to do so at the gold counters without an appointment from 9.30am to 4.30pm on weekdays, excluding public holidays.

Customers who buy physical gold online will be able to collect their purchases from the next working day and up to 10 working days after their purchase. From Feb 13, these online purchases can be collected via a pre-booked appointment.

UOB is the only local bank here that offers the sale and purchase of physical gold bars and bullion coins.

It reminded customers to check on the availability of gold products on its website before making a purchase.

Customers can also consider UOB's Gold Savings Account, which allows them to trade gold digitally, with the option to convert their holdings into physical gold later, said the bank.

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Document STIMES0020260209em29001jm

HSBC's Tommy Leung on strengthening desk leadership, SEA growth and PE push

Priyanka Boghani

957 words

5 February 2026

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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While the industry has veered toward retaining desk or team heads that manage their own books, HSBC **Private Banking**'s Tommy Leung believes non-producing desks heads add value.

The global **private banking**, South and Southeast Asia head gives Citywire Asia a broad update on the Southeast Asia business and the surge in private equity solutions.

Private banks in the last year have been quick to remove additional layers of management in cost-cutting exercises, squarely putting non-producing desk or team heads at risk.

Even so, Leung (pictured) stressed the importance of having 'high quality' desk heads or market heads who can supervise and guide relationship managers without any potential conflicts of interest.

'Non-producing desk heads can focus on managing people, leading by example, and supporting RMs -including joining client meetings where appropriate – to help plan and grow the business,' he said.

The proof is in the numbers.

The SEA surge

In 2025, the Southeast Asia and Singapore group head saw strong momentum, in line with the **private bank**'s performance across the Apac region. While 2024 saw Singapore growing faster than Hong Kong in terms of AUM, last year the Hong Kong equity market rally drove growth. This resulted in not just higher net new money, but also a higher proportion of client cash being deployed into investments, on a year-on-year basis, Leung said.

'Across SEA and Singapore, we're seeing healthy momentum in both asset gathering and client investment activity,' he said. The bank's SEA region includes Thailand, Indonesia, Malaysia and the Philippines, in addition to Singapore.

'The move from cash into investments has been broad-based, spanning capital market solutions, equities, fixed income, structured products, as well as annuity solutions such as mandates, alternatives, and long-only funds.'

Leung noted that a 'meaningful' portion of the bank's assets under management in the SEA region have come from deepening existing wallet share, alongside acquiring new clients.

He highlighted that while the Philippines has been a standout market in terms of revenue, the strategy across the region remains similar; larger clients or families are looking for offshore banking needs as well as family legacy planning.

Leung also singled out Australia and India as markets that continue to be interesting due to the growing need for global connectivity and solutions among the local wealthy.

India, which HSBC **Private Bank** re-entered after an eight-year hiatus, is a fiercely competitive and domestic market that requires a more nuanced strategy.

'Onshore India continues to be an important piece for us, but will we have 200 bankers on the ground? No. We want to be the Ferrari, not the Toyota, in India — with a focused, high-quality onshore team,' he said.

Private markets push

Echoing the offshore wealth hubs of Hong Kong and Singapore, alternatives have become a recurring theme for investors looking for diversification in Southeast Asia.

Interest in private equity across all of HSBC's key markets in the Southeast Asia region has grown, as clients look to diversify beyond public markets and understand opportunities in private markets better, Leung said.

An increasing number of alternative investment firms are entering Southeast Asian markets, particularly Thailand, through partnerships with local **private banks** as demand for evergreen funds that offer higher liquidity rises.

For HSBC, a double-digit percentage of its SEA clients have some exposure to alternatives.

However, Leung noted that overall alts penetration remains relatively low and more client handholding is needed in this area.

'Some client education is required in the SEA region when it comes to alternatives, particularly around correlations with public equities and bonds,' he said. 'Clients in the region tend to prefer open-ended structures and typically start with smaller ticket sizes.'

DPM and insurance interest

Meanwhile, discretionary portfolio mandates and insurance solutions have piqued interest among investors, the HSBC executive noted.

Multi-asset DPM strategies have seen demand from both new and existing clients, Leung said. Discretionary penetration among clients in Asia remains lower than in Europe, but total assets are inching up from new clients looking to hedge their portfolios in the face of falling interest rates.

Policies such as universal life (UL) are an increasingly popular form of protection.

'Insurance revenue remains one of the fastest growing areas over the last two years,' Leung said. **Private banks** and wealth managers have been building their insurance offerings and insurers have responded, launching a rash of new products to capitalise. 'It may not be the biggest in terms of contribution, but it is a focus area.'

China and the UAE in 2026

The bank will expand its Singapore and Southeast Asia teams, hiring across the board but its strategy will be to strengthen Asia and Middle East connectivity.

'We are seeing that clients in the UAE have increasingly global needs and therefore choose to book a portion of their assets in Singapore,' Leung said, adding the bank has made 'significant progress' over the past 12 to 18 months.

'For example, one of our India onshore RMs referred a client with a substantial asset base in the UAE to our Singapore team. The Singapore and UAE teams came together to pitch for the client, which allowed us to open an account quickly, deepen the relationship and grow market share,' he said.

Leung added that growing the bank's global Indian relationship manager bench, as well as its China desk, are high on the agenda this year as the China-Singapore and India-Singapore corridors become more international and relevant.

This article's headline was amended on 9 Feb 3.20pm SGT to clarify Tommy Leung's views on desk head leadership and productivity.

Document CWIRME0020260209em2500006

HSBC's Tommy Leung on non-producing desk heads, SEA growth and PE push

Priyanka Boghani

934 words

5 February 2026

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Document CWIRME0020260206em2500002

Exclusive: StanChart PB India head departs

Priyanka Boghani

196 words

5 February 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered **Private Bank**'s India head has left the bank after more than 20 years, Citywire Asia has learned.

Pankaj Walia (pictured) is no longer at the bank, where he held the **private banking** head role for over three years.

Citywire Asia reached out to Standard Chartered for a comment.

Walia helped drive the bank's growth in India, overseeing the opening of several **private banking** centres across the country, including in non-metro locations.

As of June 2024, the former **private banking** head [said](#) Standard Chartered had around \$10bn in assets under management and around 35 **private bankers**.

The British lender does not have a replacement for him in place yet, whose exit comes as the Indian **private banking** industry continues to go through waves of change as wealth players experiment with different models and strategies to retain talent and grow assets.

The battleground between foreign and domestic players has also intensified while new outfits have entered the field.

Last April, UBS [sold](#) its India wealth business to 360 ONE Wealth and Asset Management in a deal valued at \$36m, while taking a nearly 5% stake.

Document CWIRAS0020260205em2500003

Asia's ultra-wealthy drive insurance revenues at private banks

Cheryl Heng

745 words

2 February 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Private banks in Asia closed 2025 with double-digit insurance revenue growth, as the sector became a core revenue driver, with ultra-wealthy clients increasingly turning to protection for tax efficiency, and wealth planning solutions.

At DBS **Private Bank**, insurance revenue has soared over 40% from 2023 levels, cementing its lead in Singapore's bancassurance market with more than 30% share, according to Lee Woon Shiu, group head of wealth planning, family office and insurance solutions.

Citi **Private Bank** and DBS PB both reported double-digit insurance growth last year, signaling the rising importance of insurance income alongside investment and corporate banking services.

'Insurance products resonate... because they address a fundamental planning tension: how to provide for the next generation without unnecessarily locking up capital during one's lifetime,' said Lee.

As more clients adopt insurance for wealth preservation, succession, and portfolio structuring, its contribution to DBS's overall revenue has increased, he added.

Peggy Quek, chief executive officer of AIA International Wealth, said families typically only act when succession risks become unavoidable.

'In my experience, family offices rarely move on insurance planning until a structural risk becomes undeniable - specifically when the family's legacy or financial stability is at stake,' she said.

Client appeal and innovation

Much of the growth centres on jumbo insurance - large-case life policies that provide massive death benefits relative to premiums.

These policies allow clients to guarantee payouts while freeing up capital for other needs, preserving both liquidity and control, said Lee.

DBS cited the example of a client with \$34m in assets who wanted to leave \$20m to heirs. Instead of locking up the full amount, a \$6m investment into a jumbo policy secured the payout, leaving the rest for personal use.

Supporting the trend, HSBC Life in Singapore [issued a \\$400m jumbo policy](#) last September, one of several \$100m-plus cases handled each quarter.

HSBC also noted a strong uptake in products like indexed universal life (IUL), variable universal life (VUL) and whole life policies. IULs are permanent life insurance products with an investment element linked to a stock market index.

Harpreet Bindra, CEO of HSBC Life Singapore, said these products preserve capital, provide estate liquidity and deliver clearer succession outcomes.

For families with complex structures or illiquid assets, insurance also helps equalise inheritances and avoid forced asset sales, said Bindra.

Quek agreed many Asian families remain 'asset rich but cash poor', and risk fire sales of property or business stakes without adequate insurance.

DBS, in collaboration with Manulife, pioneered features like gold-indexed IULs and the ability to fund variable universal life policies with physical gold held in custody, reflecting demand for bespoke, higher-yield options.

Since DBS and Manulife launched its first IUL in Singapore in 2019, the number of providers has grown from three in 2023 to [at least nine](#) last year.

Demand drivers

Tighter taxes, low mainland China rates, and surging cross-border flows into wealth hubs like Singapore are driving insurance demand among the wealthy.

'In China, rates are low and real estate has been weak, so the money has got to go somewhere, which is why you see strong growth in areas like insurance and life policies,' said DBS CEO Tan Su Shan in the bank's third quarter earnings call on money flows.

At the same time, Asia's intergenerational wealth transfer is accelerating.

An estimated \$5.8tn is set to change hands across the region by 2030, with around 60% driven by ultra-high net worth families, according to McKinsey.

When families confront the scale of this transition, the urgency to formalise succession planning intensifies, Quek said.

'Families act when they stop seeing insurance as just a product and start seeing it as a risk-transfer instrument that protects wealth from liquidity shocks, tax friction and governance vulnerabilities,' she added.

Next-generation clients - especially those under 45 - and family heads planning succession are driving much of the momentum, observed Lee.

'Entering at a younger age allows them to secure lower premiums, stronger underwriting outcomes and higher coverage efficiency,' he said.

Banks like DBS and Citi have long-standing bancassurance partnerships, while HSBC **Private Bank** works closely with HSBC Life to co-create offerings.

HSBC has been launching life insurance offerings in key markets like Singapore to support multi-generational planning, though the bank is currently reviewing its Singapore insurance unit as part of a broader global simplification.

Document CWIRAS0020260203em2200007

Standard Chartered opens its first **Wealth Management** Centre in the Greater Bay Area

Distributed by Contify.com

741 words

29 January 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Centre offers personalized **wealth management** solutions for affluent clients.
- * New cross-border affluent clients in Greater Bay Area increase by 40% year-on-year.
- * Centre's design combines technology with Eastern aesthetics for unique client experience.

Original Press Release:

Hong Kong, Jan. 29 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

- Strategically situated in Shenzhen, offering elevated experience for affluent clients

Standard Chartered has officially opened its first **Wealth Management** Centre in the Greater Bay Area, located in Shenzhen, aiming to create an innovative experience to meet the growing **wealth management** needs of clients in the region. As an important part of Standard Chartered's business strategy in China, the new centre embodies the Bank's local insights and global vision. By integrating Chinese tea culture and artistic design, the centre offers clients with a more personalised **wealth management** experience, providing professional wealth solutions while supporting the high-quality development of China's **wealth management** industry.

Judy Hsu, CEO, Wealth & Retail Banking and ASEAN, South Asia, Greater China and North Asia, Standard Chartered, said, "The rise of affluents in Asia in recent years has become a key driver of global wealth growth. Standard Chartered is significantly expanding our affluent business, growing our new client base by approximately 10% a year, with China being one of our key markets. We are confident in the huge potential and long-term high-quality development of the China's **wealth management** market and look forward to leveraging the establishment of the new **Wealth Management** Centre in Shenzhen to further consolidate our unique role as a 'super-connector', connecting clients with diverse resources and quality services."

Stephen Man, Head of Wealth and Retail Banking, Standard Chartered Hong Kong, said, "Standard Chartered has been deeply rooted in China for over 165 years, with the Greater Bay Area being one of our core growth engines. In the first three quarters last year, our new cross-border affluent clients in the Greater Bay Area increased by 40% year-on-year. Following the opening of our sixth **Wealth Management** Centre in Hong Kong last week, we are delighted to establish our first **Wealth Management** Centre in Shenzhen, which is also our first in a Mainland city within the Greater Bay Area. This strengthens Standard Chartered's **wealth management** network in the region and reinforces our role in connecting the Chinese Mainland and Hong Kong markets. Through leveraging our unique global network and cross-border financial solutions, we aim to create greater value for our clients."

Benefiting from the growth opportunities in the Greater Bay Area, Standard Chartered continues to expand its local **wealth management** business. The newly established **Wealth Management** Centre is located in China Resources Tower, adjacent to Shenzhen Bay Bridge and Talent Park, accessing high-end commercial, financial, and talent resources, and positioning itself as a "super-connector" to provide one-stop **wealth management** services for clients in the Greater Bay Area. As one of the longest established international banks in the Greater Bay Area, Standard Chartered offers extensive business network covering core cities such as Hong Kong, Macau, Shenzhen, and Guangzhou.

The centre's design ingeniously integrates technology with Eastern aesthetics. The entrance's art wall is inspired by Standard Chartered's iconic global network of buildings, highlighting the Bank's international vision; while the

tearoom embodies 'traditional Chinese tea culture and Eastern etiquette, creating a timeless environment for **wealth management** discussion. Additionally, the centre adopts a fully concealed intelligent counter design, ensuring privacy while providing efficient services, creating an elegant and comfortable client experience.

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 54 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

The history of Standard Chartered in Hong Kong dates back to 1859. It is currently one of the Hong Kong SAR's three note-issuing banks. Standard Chartered incorporated its Hong Kong business on 1 July 2004, and now operates as a licensed bank in Hong Kong under the name of Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC.

[Category: Investment Banking, Banking and Financial Services, Business Expansion]

Source: Standard Chartered

Document ATINBK0020260130em1t00037

Standard Chartered One IFC **Wealth Management** Centre Officially Opens

Distributed by Contify.com

520 words

22 January 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Standard Chartered opens sixth **Wealth Management** Centre in Hong Kong.
- * New centre strengthens position in Affluent segment with robust growth.
- * Exclusive services include in-house tea master and chauffeured limousine services.

Original Press Release:

Hong Kong, Jan. 22 -- Standard Chartered Bank issued the following news release:

- Expanding network in strategic area to serve affluent clients' growing crossborder **wealth management** needs

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("Standard Chartered Hong Kong") officially opens its new **Wealth Management** Centre at One International Finance Centre ("One IFC") in Central. This marks the Bank's sixth **Wealth Management** Centre, following the other five centres at Exchange Square in Central, K11 Atelier in Tsim Sha Tsui, Lee Garden in Causeway Bay, Pacific Place in Admiralty, and One Peking in Tsim Sha Tsui. The opening of the new centre further strengthens Standard Chartered Hong Kong's leading position in the Affluent segment.

Mary Huen, CEO, Hong Kong and Greater China & North Asia, Standard Chartered, said, "Hong Kong is a premier **wealth management** hub in Asia. Standard

Chartered is committed to being a leading **wealth manager** for affluent clients. Through the Bank's unique global network and outstanding wealth solutions, we aim to create greater value for our clients. Driven by our affluent clients, Standard Chartered Hong Kong's Wealth and Retail Banking business recorded robust growth in the first three quarters last year. The opening of our sixth **Wealth Management** Centre reflects Standard Chartered's sharper strategic focus on servicing our clients' affluent and cross-border banking needs."

Stephen Man, Head of Wealth and Retail Banking, Standard Chartered Hong Kong, said, "With rising demand for **wealth management** services from affluent clients, we are excited to open our second **Wealth Management** Centre in Central to further enhance our one-stop shop for cross-border banking and wealth solutions, supporting clients in wealth planning and capturing global investment opportunities. We will continue to introduce more bespoke solutions for legacy planning and wealth accumulation, and enhance our digital capabilities to support clients at every stage of their wealth journey."

The 10,000 square-foot One IFC **Wealth Management** Centre is strategically located in the heart of Central, next to premium hotels, the Airport Express, and high-end shopping malls. It offers waterfront views of Victoria Harbour and features 14 private meeting rooms, including two family-friendly rooms for clients visiting with children. The new centre also provides exclusive services such as an in-house tea master and chauffeured limousine services for busy affluent clients.

Furthermore, all Relationship Managers in the new centre have native-level proficiency in Mandarin and are fluent in Cantonese and English. With a deep understanding of the needs of Chinese clients from different regions, they are committed to delivering seamless cross-border banking experiences tailored to clients' international **wealth management** needs.

Disclaimer: The full PDF release can be found at:

<https://av.sc.com/hk/content/docs/hk-20260122-press-release-on-one-ifc-wmc-en.pdf>

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Business Expansion]

Source: Standard Chartered Bank

Document ATINBK0020260123em1m000bf

Exclusive: HSBC Private Bank in hiring spree across Asia

Priyanka Boghani

356 words

16 January 2026

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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HSBC Private Bank has made a flurry of hires in Singapore to bulk up its Southeast Asia, India and offshore China desks, Citywire Asia can reveal.

The bank has hired Phaneendar Bhavaraju and Rangan Krishnan for its global India team in Singapore as senior relationship managers. Both report to Manoj Ramarao, senior desk head, global India, Singapore and Hong Kong.

Bhavaraju spent over nine years as a chief investment officer at external asset managers in the Middle East, including Jupiter Wealth Advisors and Arrow Capital. He also spent nine years at RBS and Credit Suisse in the ultra-high net worth space. Krishnan was most recently at Bank of Singapore as a team head, based in the city-state.

For its Thailand coverage, HSBC has recruited William Fok from LGT as its Bangkok-based private banking country head. He reports to Benjamin Wang, desk head for Thailand and Vietnam at HSBC Private Bank. Previously, Fok was a senior investment counsellor at LGT, and his appointment marks a return to the lender.

Meanwhile, the bank also announced two internal role changes.

HSBC confirmed Dawn Fung as its new head of wealth planning for Southeast Asia. In her role, which she was already carrying out on an interim basis, Fung will continue to lead the region's wealth planning agenda, expanding its coverage for HNW and UHNW clients and families, including multi-generational wealth and legacy planning.

Fung reports functionally to Ann Ling, regional head of wealth planning and advisory, Asia Pacific, and on an entity basis to Tommy Leung, head of private bank, South Asia.

HSBC also named Alex Liu as its market head of offshore China, extending his coverage to the offshore China teams in Singapore, in addition to Hong Kong. He continues to be based in Hong Kong and report to the private bank's head of North Asia and Hong Kong, Kanas Chan.

The bank, which confirmed the hires, said the string of senior appointments across the wealth planning, onshore Thailand, global India and offshore China segments indicate the key strategic focus areas for the business.

Document CWIRME0020260116em1g00004

HSBC completes IWPB leadership team with senior Citi hire

Cheryl Heng

257 words

9 January 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC has recruited from Citibank for its chief commercial officer overseeing its International Wealth and Premier Banking (IWPB) division.

Valentin Valderrabano joins from Citibank, effective 20 Feb, where he was most recently the chief operating officer for global wealth, according to a 9 Jan release.

His career at Citi spanned over two decades, primarily focused on retail banking, wealth management, and digital transformation.

Reporting directly to IWPB CEO Barry O'Byrne, Valderrabano will relocate from New York to Hong Kong. His mandate involves driving wealth-led growth, enhancing customer experience, and integrating the bank's digital and physical service channels.

Finalising the IWPB structure

The appointment marks the completion of O'Byrne's leadership build-out for the IWPB division, which was formed in late 2024.

The IWPB unit houses global **private banking**, asset management, and insurance. This reorganisation is part of a broader push under group CEO Georges Elhedery.

O'Byrne noted that the appointment comes as the bank seeks to accelerate its strategy in its core hubs. 'We have a clear goal to become the world's leading international wealth manager, particularly in Asia and the Middle East,' he said.

Valderrabano joins a refreshed leadership bench at HSBC that draws heavily from his former employer. Earlier this month, HSBC appointed former Citi global **private bank** head [Ida Liu](#) as CEO of HSBC **Private Bank**.

Other recent senior IWPB appointments include Victor Matarranz as head for Americas and Europe, and confirming Jean Nabaa as chief operating officer.

Document CWIRAS0020260109em1900001

Business

Hong Kong gains favour as platform for wealth planning, family offices in 2026: bank CEO

Enoch Yiu

753 words

6 January 2026

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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City's stock market and incentives will continue to attract family offices from around Asia-Pacific, Bank of Singapore's Hong Kong CEO says

Wealthy families will continue to use Hong Kong to set up family offices for succession planning and diversifying their investments in 2026, thanks to its vibrant market and government incentives, according to the Hong Kong CEO of Bank of Singapore.

The bank, which is the private banking unit of Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation (OCBC), has a bullish outlook after it reported very strong performance in 2025, according to Rickie Chan, who is also the bank's head of private banking for Greater China.

When Chan joined Bank of Singapore's Hong Kong branch as CEO in February 2024, he set a high target of achieving 50 per cent growth in assets under management by the end of 2026, he said.

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

"We achieved our goal in September 2025, one year earlier than initially targeted," he said in an exclusive interview.

"A key driver is the wealth planning business, which has seen revenue almost triple year on year as of the third quarter, as an increasing number of wealthy families from mainland China, Hong Kong, Taiwan and Southeast Asia are using Hong Kong as a platform for succession planning and wealth management."

Between 2023 and 2030, ultra-high-net-worth families with liquid assets over US\$30 million in the Asia-Pacific region were set to experience an intergenerational wealth transfer estimated at US\$3.4 trillion, Chan said, citing a McKinsey report.

"This will drive strong demand for private banks to help these clients in using various instruments such as trusts and insurance to facilitate the wealth transfer smoothly," he said. "Setting up family offices in Hong Kong is also a popular option."

While many viewed Hong Kong and Singapore as competitors in the family office space, Chan said the two were complementary.

"It all depends on the individual clients' needs," he said. "We have seen many clients set up family offices in both Hong Kong and Singapore."

"Geopolitical uncertainties and economic fluctuations have also led many wealthy clients to diversify their investment assets, he added. These clients do not want to invest solely in the US dollar, but want to diversify and invest more in Asia to leverage the region's rapid growth.

"They also want to diversify across different banks instead of just relying on US banks to manage their wealth," Chan said.

Government policies also played a role, he said.

Since 2023, the Hong Kong government has introduced eight measures, including tax concessions and investment-migration schemes, to attract wealthy individuals to set up **family offices** in Hong Kong to manage their investments, succession planning and philanthropic activities.

The measures have helped the city bag 200 new **family offices** since their launch, and Chief Executive John Lee Ka-chiu set a goal of [attracting another 220](#) over the next three years in his annual policy address in September.

“The Hong Kong government’s policies have been successful in encouraging many wealthy families to open **family offices** in Hong Kong to facilitate wealth planning and transfer their wealth,” Chan said.

Hong Kong is also a good connector for mainland Chinese businesses to use as a platform to expand in Asia, Chan said, touting Bank of Singapore’s parent company OCBC’s extensive regional network in Southeast Asia.

Hong Kong’s active [stock market](#) also makes it an ideal location for mainland businesses to invest and list their companies to raise funds, Chan said. The benchmark [Hang Seng Index](#) rose 28 per cent in 2025 and the city’s exchange reclaimed its title as the world’s largest [initial public offering](#) market.

Hong Kong and Singapore were natural choices for affluent families with regional ties or pan-Asian investments, according to Julius Baer’s 2025 Family Barometer annual report, which tracked 2,500 **family office** experts in Europe, Asia, the Middle East and Latin America about their investment plans.

Hong Kong has 2,700 single-**family offices**, while Singapore has more than 2,000. Both cities have offered tax incentives and investment-migration schemes to attract **family offices** in recent years.

Document SCMCOM0020260106em1600001

StanChart hires from BOS to grow Greater China team

Priyanka Boghani

217 words

6 January 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** has appointed a seasoned former Bank of Singapore Greater China banker as part of its push into the region.

Hu Hong has joined the British lender as group market head, where he will focus on building a new Greater China team, the bank said. He is based in Singapore and reports to Foo Tian Ong, regional head, Southeast Asia and Singapore location head, Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**.

'This appointment aligns with the development of our Greater China franchise in Singapore,' Standard Chartered said in a 6 Jan statement to the media.

Hu [resigned](#) from Bank of Singapore last September, where he was its market group head for Greater China and managed three market heads and a team of 100 frontline staff. He spent over 15 years at the **private bank** and 20 overall with its owner OCBC.

The bank most recently [expanded](#) its global chief investment office team with hires from UBS and JP Morgan Asset Management, that include Sundeep Gantori and Jonathan Liang.

Standard Chartered outlined a target of \$200bn in net new money and double-digit growth in wealth solutions income by 2029, at a seminar hosted by Raymond Ang, the bank's global head, **private bank** and affluent clients.

Document CWIRAS0020260106em1600002



Business

City 'gains favour as platform for wealth planning'

Enoch Yiu

481 words

6 January 2026

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Wealthy families will continue to use the city to set up **family offices** for succession planning and diversifying their investments in 2026, thanks to its vibrant market and government incentives, according to the Hong Kong CEO of Bank of Singapore.

The bank, which is the **private banking** unit of Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation, has a bullish outlook after it reported very strong performance in 2025, according to Rickie Chan, who is also the bank's head of **private banking** for Greater China.

When Chan joined Bank of Singapore's Hong Kong branch as CEO in February 2024, he set a target of achieving 50 per cent growth in assets under management by the end of 2026, he said.

"We achieved our goal in September 2025, one year earlier than initially targeted," he said in an exclusive interview.

"A key driver is the wealth planning business, which has seen revenue almost triple year on year as of the third quarter, as an increasing number of wealthy families from mainland China, Hong Kong, Taiwan and Southeast Asia are using Hong Kong as a platform for succession planning and wealth management."

Between 2023 and 2030, ultra-high-net-worth families with liquid assets of more than US\$30 million in Asia-Pacific were set to experience an intergenerational wealth transfer estimated at US\$3.4 trillion, Chan said, citing a McKinsey report.

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"The government's policies have been successful in encouraging many wealthy families to open **family offices** in Hong Kong to facilitate wealth planning and transfer their wealth," Chan said.

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Former HSBC GPB banker joins BOS

Priyanka Boghani

164 words

5 January 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A former HSBC Global **Private Banking** relationship manager has joined Bank of Singapore.

Priyanka Maheshwari has left HSBC to join the Singaporean **private bank**, according to her latest LinkedIn update, which said she is now part of BOS's global South Asia team.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed her hire, adding that she joined the bank as a senior relationship manager for the GSA team, effective 15 Dec 2025.

Maheshwari spent almost seven years at HSBC, based in Singapore. Prior to that, she worked at Citibank, Standard Chartered, ABN AMRO and Deutsche Bank.

In November, Bank of Singapore [named](#) Claude Andre Harbonn as its new head of investment advisory, hiring him from UBS Global Wealth Management.

The Singaporean **private bank** saw a high number of entries and exits in 2025.

This article was amended on 5 Jan to add a confirmation from a Bank of Singapore spokesperson and add details on Maheshwari's title and role.

Document CWIRAS0020260106em1500006

Former Citi global **private bank** head to join HSBC

Priyanka Boghani

270 words

22 December 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Citi's former global **private bank** head is set to resurface at HSBC, almost a year after her departure.

Ida Liu will join HSBC **Private Bank** as its CEO, effective 5 Jan 2026, the bank said in a 22 Dec statement.

In her new role, she will focus on deepening HSBC's leadership with UHNW clients, strengthening cross-border connectivity across key wealth corridors and accelerating the growth of the **private bank** globally, according to the statement. Based in New York, she will report to Barry O'Byrne, HSBC International Wealth and Premier Banking's CEO.

Liu, who joined Citi in 2007, was most recently the global head of Citi **Private Bank**, where she led a global business and advised UHNW clients on their investment, liquidity and legacy needs.

Following her [departure](#) at Citi, an internal memo said Citi's head of wealth Andy Sieg would directly oversee the **private banking** arm's operations in the UK, Europe and the Middle East, North America, Latin America, and Asia South.

Prior to Citi, Liu was an investment banker at Merrill Lynch for five years.

The hire comes after senior reshuffles and reorganisation at HSBC **Private Bank** as well. In 2024, the bank named Georges Elhedery as CEO, and its global **private banking** and wealth head, Annabel Spring, [left](#). O'Byrne became the head of the then-newly-created international wealth and premier banking division.

In Asia, HSBC GPB nabbed Hong Kong-based Kanas Chan from Deutsche Bank to be its North Asia bank head, as reported by Citywire Asia earlier this year.

Document CWIRME0020251223elcm00001

MINT, Industry

Armed with new RBI approvals, HSBC India's Hitendra Dave wants a seat at the big banks' table

Shayan Ghosh, Satish John

1,003 words

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Mint

HNMINI

English

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Mumbai, Dec. 16 -- Foreign banks might have "lost the plot" about two decades ago to make it big in India, losing ground to local **private banks**, but HSBC India's chief executive, Hitendra Dave, now wants to use a recent approval to open new branches to regain some of that ground.

In January, the bank got a Reserve Bank of India (RBI) go-ahead to open 20 branches across cities such as Lucknow, Amritsar, Bhopal, Bhubaneswar, and Dehradun among others. When completed, the expansion will take its total branch count to 46. The first of the new lot was opened in Vadodara earlier in December. Unlike other banks, Indian branches of foreign banks need regulatory approval to open branches.

"Twenty years back, foreign banks just lost the plot. We allowed **private banks** to become as big as they have become in one of the most profitable markets of the world and it was our incompetence, our inability to see the future," Dave said in an interview.

Dave, who got the India CEO role in 2021, said he wants HSBC to be the fifth largest private sector bank in India. Drivers of this growth will be the wealth and consumer businesses tapping into a growing phalanx of affluent customers.

"I think there is room for only one international bank, while retaining its international character, way of operations, governance, legal entity structure, to aspire to be as big as the top five **private banks**," said Dave.

"This is a wonderful opportunity presented to banks like ours; if we don't do justice to the opportunity, I will certainly not blame any regulatory issues or my head office."

The pecking order among private Indian banks by assets as of 30 September lists HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, Axis Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank, and IndusInd Bank as the top five.

India has seen foreign banks exiting a crowded market, especially in consumer loans where competition from local private sector banks and state-owned lenders is stiff. Local banks have the upper hand in the number of branches and feet on the street to lend and collect small ticket loans.

Of late though, some foreign banks are upping the ante with JP Morgan getting regulatory approval to open a branch, with Bloomberg calling it the first in nearly a decade. However, foreign banks still have a tiny 3.3% share in outstanding loans as on 31 March, as against 52% and 40% by public sector and private sector banks, respectively.

The most recent instance is that of Citi India selling its retail business to Axis Bank for Rs.11,603 crore. That apart, Deutsche Bank is in talks with at least three lenders to sell its retail and wealth management business in India, per a Bloomberg report from November.

HSBC India is among the few foreign banks that still has a sizable consumer business in India and is pushing for a greater presence among the affluent and the wealthy. As of 31 March, the bank had Rs.23,123 crore in non-priority sector retail loans spread across housing, credit card dues, and "other retail loans".

These form 16.7% of its overall non-priority sector loans, with the share of services sector exposure the highest at 35.8%. Banks have to set aside 40% of their total credit to sectors like agriculture, small businesses, education, and renewable energy, among others.

According to Dave, the cities where HSBC will establish branches are those with significant expansion of wealth in the recent past, significant manufacturing capabilities in and around the city, and a sizable non-resident population. "We think this is the largest branch expansion permit given by RBI to any international bank, at least going back two decades."

As part of the bank's retail push, Dave pointed to the growing number of HSBC credit cards and spends on those cards.

Per RBI data, HSBC had 954,431 credit cards in India, higher than all other foreign banks and only behind the American Express card network. HSBC credit cards have an average spend per card of Rs.17,477.5 in October, as against the industry average of Rs.18,784.4, data from RBI showed.

"My credit card spends have grown at a CAGR (compound annual growth rate) of 45% in the last two years and if I maintain a 45% growth for another five years, I will catch up on credit cards with India's 5th largest card issuer. Now, it is not that the other issuer is not doing anything, it is also growing," said Dave.

HSBC's push for more growth in India coincides with the heightened interest of foreign capital in the financial services sector. Recent deals between RBL Bank and Emirates NBD Bank as also Yes Bank and SMBC have shown how RBI is willing to allow an expanded presence of foreign capital in banking. Dave is positive that new players will come with new technology, new products, and create more interest in financial services.

"All the top **private banks** are already giving us (competition) and I would rather say that we are not even competition for them," said Dave. "Of course, competition will increase because there will be more players, but whether that will make our life more easier or more difficult, I don't think so. I think it's tough in any case."

Dave also said that HSBC India is investing in technology and hiring people with a technology and digital background. "The bank of the future will be run by these young new engineering grads that we are hiring, who are coming to our office and saying, 'My God, which era do you live in?'," he said.

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DBS makes senior MEA hire from Dubai IAM

Paromita Dey

236 words

15 December 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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DBS Bank has hired Randeep Singh as an executive director and team lead for Middle East and Africa (MEA), effective December, according to a LinkedIn post.

Singh joins from Jupiter Wealth Advisors, a Dubai-based independent asset manager, which he co-founded and was the managing director for more than three years.

In his new role, Singh will aim to build a team of senior **private bankers**, deepening relationships across the region, and supporting ultra high net worth individuals (UHNWI) with future-ready **private banking** solutions that meet the needs of a rapidly growing MEA market.

He will also spearhead the high net worth individuals (HNWI) and family office initiative at the bank.

Before co-founding Jupiter Wealth Advisors, Singh held leadership roles with Deutsche Bank, LGT, ABN AMRO, Standard Chartered, and Citibank, managing senior teams across the MEA.

The Singapore-headquartered bank has seen rising interest from Middle Eastern families establishing family offices in Asia, with Singapore and Hong Kong, home to the bank's booking centres, becoming preferred destinations. The bank has dedicated wealth planning teams to support these clients with tailored legacy and estate planning solutions to meet multi-generational needs.

In July, DBS [appointed](#) Loic Voide as the head of **private banking** for the MEA region. He reports to Vikas Jaidka, region head for Middle East, Africa, and NRI at DBS **Private Bank**.

Document CWIRME0020251215elcf00001

BBK launches a new suite of HSBC Mutual Funds to expand Global and Islamic investment opportunities

Distributed by Contify.com

533 words

4 December 2025

Islamic Finance News - Contify

ATISFN

English

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Key Highlights:

- * BBK launches HSBC Mutual Funds for global and Islamic investment opportunities.
- * Access to HSBC Portfolios, Global Investment Funds, Islamic Funds, and Global Funds ICAV.
- * Minimum investment amount is USD 5,000 with increments of USD 1,000.

Original Press Release:

Dec. 4 -- Bank of Bahrain and Kuwait issued the following news release:

BBK, a leader in retail and corporate banking in the Kingdom of Bahrain, has announced the introduction of a comprehensive range of global and Islamic investment solutions through the launch of a new suite of HSBC Mutual Funds, now available to BBK customers as part of the Bank's **Wealth Management** services.

This initiative aims to provide investors with direct access to international opportunities for growing their wealth by benefiting from the extensive global asset management expertise of HSBC. The announcement follows BBK's recent completion of the successful acquisition of the retail banking business of HSBC Bank Middle East in the Kingdom of Bahrain.

Through this offering, customers gain access to a broad selection of funds that include HSBC Portfolios, HSBC Global Investment Funds, HSBC Islamic Funds and HSBC Global Funds ICAV. The availability of this diversified range of products enhances customers' ability to build balanced portfolios and tap into global markets through trusted and internationally recognized investment solutions.

Customers can subscribe to these funds by completing the Client Investment Profiling questionnaire through the BBK Mobile App, with the customer's account required to be funded at the time of application. The minimum investment amount is set at USD 5,000 with the option to increase in increments of USD 1,000. This structure provides investors with flexibility to plan their financial strategies in alignment with both short term and long-term goals. The Bank's **Wealth Management** team is also available to support customers with suitable guidance and recommendations to help them select the investment solutions that best match their individual needs.

Commenting on the announcement, Mr. Mohamed Al Rayes, General Manager of Treasury and Investment at BBK, stated: "The introduction of HSBC Mutual Funds reflects the Bank's commitment to offering high quality global investment opportunities that allow customers to grow their wealth with confidence and transparency. The addition of these funds represents a significant step in broadening BBK's investment product range, built on international standards in asset management and the expertise of leading global financial institutions."

Mr. Al Rayes further added, "BBK's **Wealth Management** team continues to develop solutions shaped by a comprehensive understanding of market dynamics and customer needs, with a clear focus on offering integrated investment experiences that are easily accessible through the Bank's advanced digital channels. This initiative forms part of the Bank's ongoing approach to supporting customers in building well diversified long-term portfolios that are better equipped to withstand market fluctuations and achieve sustained financial stability."

Customers wishing to obtain further details are invited to contact the **Wealth Management** team on 17101010 or via email at wealth@bbkonline.com.

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Professional Services, New Offerings]

Source: Bank of Bahrain and Kuwait

Document ATISFN0020251205elc40005p

Straits Times Breaking News

Business

Backing start-ups crucial for Singapore's innovation push, despite higher risks: HSBC chief

Sheila Chiang

1,276 words

1 December 2025

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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SINGAPORE - Start-ups are key drivers of innovation, and ensuring they have adequate banking and financing support from early stage to scale-up is critical for any economy.

For Singapore to cement its position as a global innovation hub, it is especially crucial for banks to play their part in supporting the companies that will shape the future economy, even though lending to start-ups carries higher risks than lending to mature firms.

These are the views of HSBC group chief executive Georges Elhedery, who spoke to The Straits Times during a recent trip to Singapore.

The Republic, a global innovation hub, plays an important role in HSBC's global strategy, and as the bank expands in the Asia-Pacific region.

"There are great innovation start-ups in Singapore. There's a venture capital appetite in Singapore. Being able to leverage and bring all our expertise to bear in this ecosystem is paramount, and that's another major development area for us."

Speaking to ST at the HSBC office at Marina Bay Financial Centre, Mr Elhedery said that much of the gross domestic product growth in major economies, including the US, is now driven by innovation, technology and artificial intelligence (AI).

For example, while advanced technology represents only 4 per cent of the US' GDP, it accounts for 92 per cent of GDP growth, he said.

"This trend is mirrored in Singapore, making our participation in the innovation ecosystem critical for building the businesses of the future. Their (start-up) contributions are going to be critical for the growth of economies, and it's going to be no different for Singapore."

Singapore's performance in global benchmarks further illustrates this trend.

The Republic climbed to fourth place in a global start-up ecosystem ranking in 2025, up from fifth in 2024, driven by strong performance in areas such as investor presence, access to start-up opportunities, concentration of global tech leaders and corporates, as well as the depth of local talent.

According to the 2025 Global Startup Ecosystem Index by research platform StartupBlink, Singapore ranked behind Israel, Britain and the US.

The index, which evaluated the start-up ecosystems of 118 countries, highlighted Singapore's strategic focus on deep tech and key growth industries such as fintech, foodtech, AI and advanced manufacturing. More start-ups expanding abroad

Many Singapore start-ups now aim to scale internationally, and HSBC said it is seeing strong interest from clients attracted by the bank's global network.

In October, the bank launched its innovation banking services in Singapore to support venture-backed businesses and their investors, offering sector expertise, specialised products, tailored financing solutions and access to new opportunities through HSBC's global network.

The bank also pledged US\$1.5 billion (S\$1.94 billion) in funding in the Republic, targeting high-growth companies.

Many start-ups need loans to get off the ground, and even more so when they expand overseas. But banks are often absent from this stage, as they tend to be reluctant to lend to start-ups given their higher credit risk.

To manage these risks, HSBC draws on its deep sector expertise and close engagement with start-ups and their investors. Beyond banking early-stage companies, the bank also serves the wider innovation ecosystem, including their investors.

"Our involvement with start-ups, their investors and the broader ecosystem gives us insights into their needs and challenges. This expertise allows us to navigate the risks thoughtfully while maintaining growth ambitions," Mr Elhedery said.

"It gives us a better sense of where lending needs to go, what the next needs are, what the next challenges are, and how their investors see the opportunities and the challenges," he added. [More On This Topic](#) Legacy planning is no longer just for the wealthy or elderly: DBS group head of **wealth management** Market lifts as SGX reforms show results; new team tasked to push changes through

HSBC's focus on the innovation economy accelerated after the bank in March 2023 acquired the UK arm of Silicon Valley Bank (SVB) for a nominal £1 (\$1.72), with the British government and the Bank of England facilitating the sale. The acquisition helped to stabilise SVB UK from the collapse of SVB's US parent company.

HSBC is also actively engaging clients and partners to explore how a new Singapore Exchange-Nasdaq dual-listing option announced by the Monetary Authority of Singapore on Nov 19 can be integrated into clients' strategic plans.

Through its innovation banking teams in Singapore and the US, the bank helps clients navigate the implications of dual-listing, offering guidance on regulatory requirements, market dynamics and potential business impacts. Working with entrepreneurs

HSBC's push into innovation banking also supports its wider aim of helping founders manage both their business and personal wealth.

The bank is supporting entrepreneurs through a range of services, including global private banking for personalised wealth planning. Currently, close to two-thirds of the bank's global private banking clients in Singapore are entrepreneurs.

Other offerings include advisory sessions guiding founders through pre-exit, initial public offerings and succession planning, as well as networking opportunities through programmes like the "Innovation Exchange".

A 2025 global entrepreneurial wealth report by HSBC found that Singapore ranks as the world's most attractive hub for entrepreneurs, with 15 per cent planning to move their wealth here and 12 per cent considering personal relocation - a sign of strong confidence in its stability, connectivity and innovation ecosystem.

Wealth management is a major growth area for HSBC in Singapore, recording double-digit growth in assets under management and revenue for several quarters.

In the last two years, the bank also launched three wealth centres here and expanded its team of relationship managers to support wealth clients. The centres cater to clients across the wealth continuum, from the mass market to ultra-high-net-worth customer segments.

Mr Elhedery said: "Through multiple channels, we're acquiring wealth clients, including international customers, new residents in Singapore and corporate clients seeking personal banking services."

Singapore is also a key technology and innovation hub for HSBC to build capabilities in areas such as quantum computing, AI and blockchain.

HSBC in September set up a Quantum Centre of Excellence here to explore how emerging quantum technologies can be applied to financial services.

The centre will first focus on quantum-safe security - such as post-quantum cryptography and quantum key distribution - to safeguard critical infrastructure against future quantum attacks, and will work with regulators, researchers and fintech firms to test interoperability, standards and use cases.

The push comes as experts warn that powerful quantum computers could eventually break today's encryption systems, prompting regulators and banks to move early on defences. Beyond cyber security, the centre will also study how quantum computing can enhance financial modelling, optimisation and machine learning. More On This Topic Weak storytelling could cost Singapore its fintech advantage: GFTN CEO SG60: From AI to quantum - can Singapore lead the next era of financial innovation?

HSBC has also rolled out a blockchain-based tokenised deposit service in Singapore that supports 24/7 real-time instant settlement. It has since completed US dollar cross-border transactions between Hong Kong and Singapore for Ant International.

"We're building capabilities here for the group. Singapore is highly critical in HSBC's global strategy," Mr Elhedery said.

"Our ambition in Singapore is to be the No. 1 international bank across corporate and institutional banking, as well as **wealth management** and innovation banking." Sheila Chiang is a business correspondent at The Straits Times.

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Business
DBS, Alliance Bank

258 words
25 November 2025
The Straits Times
STIMES
English
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Singapore's biggest bank has withdrawn an application to start talks to buy as much as 49 per cent of Alliance Bank Malaysia, replacing it with one to acquire up to 30 per cent instead, people with knowledge of the matter said. DBS Group Holdings made the decision after failing to get approval from the Malaysian central bank for its initial request, because generally a company can only buy as much as 30 per cent of a financial institution in the country. The revised request should have a better chance of being approved by Bank Negara Malaysia, the people said. BLOOMBERG

Julius Baer

Julius Baer Group said it was booking a 150 million Swiss franc (S\$242 million) loan-loss provision as it continues to wind down lending not in line with its core wealth-management strategy.

Wealthy clients have added a net 11.7 billion Swiss francs in the ten months through October, the Zurich-based bank said in its interim statement on Nov 24. Assets under management grew 4 per cent in the first ten months to 520 billion Swiss francs. BLOOMBERG

M&C Saatchi

British advertising group M&C Saatchi on Nov 24 lowered its profit and revenue outlook for the year after the US government shutdown hit a significant business for the company during the fourth quarter.

The ad group now expects like-for-like net revenue decline of around 7 per cent for the year, with operating profit between GBP26 million (S\$44.5 million) and GBP28 million. REUTERS

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StanChart revamps North Asia investment advisory leadership

Cheryl Heng

217 words

24 November 2025

Citywire

CWIRE

English

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Standard Chartered has revamped its investment advisory leadership for its North Asia team, according to a 24 Nov announcement from the bank.

Muska Chiu, who has led the bank's investment advisory team in the past two years, has stepped into a new role as team leader.

Chiu has over two decades of experience in investment and product advisory, having driven revenue and productivity growth across the **private bank**'s Greater China and North Asia franchise, particularly among UHNW clients.

Following Chiu's transition, StanChart has hired Peter Horng as head of investment advisory and product advisory for Greater China and North Asia.

Horng joins from DBS **Private Bank** Hong Kong, where he was last head of investment products and advisory, leading the integration of the **private bank** and treasuries private client investment advisory teams.

At DBS, he oversaw the rollout of alternatives, strengthened collaboration with the Treasury & Markets unit, and continued to scale the investment business.

Horng has over 25 years of wealth management experience, including senior roles at Citibank, HSBC and UBS in New York and Hong Kong.

StanChart has also recently hired [Ares So](#) from Bank of China (Hong Kong) as team lead, who is understood to be joining with a team of at least two.

Document CWIRE00020251204elbo000hl

Exclusive: UOB appoints former Credit Suisse wealth head as advisor

Cheryl Heng

229 words

24 November 2025

Citywire Asia

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English

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UOB has appointed the former global wealth head at Credit Suisse as its first member of the newly established wealth advisory panel to strengthen the bank's retail wealth strategy, Citywire Asia has learnt.

The appointee, Francesco de Ferrari, has more than two decades of experience in **wealth management** and **private banking**.

The Singapore bank is 'accelerating its wealth franchise growth' by transforming its business across the wealth continuum - from personal financial services to **private banking** - throughout the region, Susan Hwee, group retail head at UOB, told Citywire Asia.

The wealth advisory panel has been created to provide strategic counsel and domain expertise. It will support UOB's leadership in identifying emerging trends, refining regional growth strategies, enhancing client engagement and product innovation, and driving digital transformation.

De Ferrari has held senior roles at UBS, Credit Suisse, and AMP Capital.

Prior to the 2023 merger of Credit Suisse into UBS, he served as global head of **wealth management** at Credit Suisse and subsequently as senior adviser to Iqbal Khan, co-president of UBS Global **Wealth Management**. From 2011 to 2018, he was CEO of **private banking** for Asia Pacific, based in Singapore.

Recent hires include [Luke Hui](#) from Julius Baer as team head for the Singapore market and [Luke Luo](#) from China Merchant Bank as deputy market head for China.

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Company

India's affluent investors flock to specialised wealth products — what's driving the surge?

763 words

21 November 2025

The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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India's affluent investors are increasingly gravitating toward specialised wealth products, according to online brokerage firm Groww's Q2FY26 results. The brokerage noted a sharp rise in its affluent user base, which now constitutes a growing share of total customer assets. According to Groww, the segment is expanding rapidly, showing 52% year-on-year growth compared to 20% for overall active users. These investors are turning to specialised wealth products such as Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), Portfolio Management Services (PMS), and advisory solutions, signaling a likely structural shift in the way India's affluent are managing their portfolios. It's on the back of these new flock of investors that the Dalal Street debutant appears to be eyeing an expansion of its wealth offering.

Though, in its Q2FY26 results, Groww said that its wealth offering is still at a nascent stage. Rising affluent investors: Beyond traditional strategies These numbers coincide with broader trends observed by HSBC in its 2025 Affluent Investor Snapshot. According to the report, Indian affluent investors are taking a more strategic and forward-looking approach to wealth management. Sandeep Batra, Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking at HSBC India, said on CNBC, "There is a notable shift among affluent individuals in India toward a more strategic approach to portfolio management. There is a growing emphasis on making money work harder over extended time horizons." The report highlights a rising appetite for diversified portfolios, particularly through alternatives and managed solutions. Within Indian portfolios, gold allocations increased from 8% to 15% over the past year, while alternative investments and multi-asset solutions are gaining traction. Affluent Indians are also exploring international diversification, with the US, Singapore, Hong Kong, and the UAE emerging as preferred destinations. The EY-Julius Baer report on India's **family offices** shows similar trends. The study found that more than half of surveyed **family offices** have allocated over 50% of their portfolios to growth-oriented assets, with private equity, venture capital, and other alternative assets becoming increasingly prominent. Surabhi Marwah, Co-leader, Private Tax and Partner at EY India, said: "India's **family office** ecosystem is at an inflection point where wealth preservation alone is no longer enough. Families now seek efficiency, transparency, and global access, all of which require a more structured approach." FDs losing ground to higher-yielding instruments The shift toward specialised wealth products is also being driven by a decline in the popularity of traditional bank deposits. RBI data shows that the share of households in bank term deposits fell from 50.54% at the end of FY20 to 45.77% in FY25, while mutual fund accounts grew rapidly, with assets under management tripling to Rs 69.50 trillion by April 2025. Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist at Bank of Baroda, said: "It is to do with markets but not necessarily due to demographics—this has been the trend of households moving from deposits to mutual funds." IDFC Bank's chief economist, Gaura Sengupta, noted that the move reflects a growing appetite for alternative financial instruments among Indian households. The RBI also found that 17.8% of Indian households invested in risky assets in 2022, up from 15.7% in 2019, reflecting a shift toward higher-yielding, albeit riskier, investment avenues. While savings deposits remain stable at around 77%, investors are increasingly channeling capital into equities, mutual funds, and insurance products rather than keeping funds idle in traditional savings vehicles. Alternative investments: The crown jewel of new portfolios Private equity, AIFs, and PMS are emerging as cornerstones of affluent portfolios. According to Groww, high-growth products increased their share of revenue in Q2, with Stocks up 4 percentage points year-on-year, Margin Trading Facility up 4 points, and interest-based income led by Lending Against Securities (LAS) up 2 points. Sandeep Batra, in his comments to CNBC, added, "The financial landscape for affluent Indian investors is undergoing a shift. No longer content with traditional strategies centered on safety and liquidity, they are embracing a more strategic, forward-looking approach to wealth management." Globally, younger investors—especially Gen Z and millennials—are leading this trend toward alternatives. In India, affluent investors have reduced cash allocations to just 15%, the lowest in Asia, and are exploring exposure to private markets, multi-asset strategies, and overseas investments. EY estimates that India's alternative investment industry, including PMS and AIFs, could exceed Rs 100 lakh crore in assets under management by 2030, aided by regulatory easing and favorable tax treatment.

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SC's Judy Hsu on Korea's growing wealth management sector and the importance of long term relationships

1,079 words

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Korea JoongAng Daily

JOONAI

English

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Judy Hsu, CEO, Wealth and Retail Banking and Greater China & North Asia at Standard Chartered, says SC Bank Korea's strength lies in meeting the needs of HNWIs by leveraging the global network and expertise of its British parent company.

[INTERVIEW]

Korea's wealth management (WM) sector is booming. According to the Korea Financial Investment Association, the domestic WM market grew 8.2 percent from 2.9 quadrillion won (\$1.96 trillion) in the first half of 2023 to 3.13 quadrillion won in the same period in 2024.

The growth is particularly pronounced in services targeting high net worth individuals (HNWIs). As of last year, clients holding more than 1 billion won in financial assets accounted for 2.82 quadrillion won — or 58.6 percent — of the country's total financial assets of 4.88 quadrillion won.

Standard Chartered (SC) Bank Korea, the only foreign retail bank operating in the country, has focused on this strategy, posting 271.4 billion won in cumulative noninterest income in the first three quarters of this year on the back of strong performance in its WM business. The figure marks a 13 percent increase from the same period last year.

In an interview on Friday with the JoongAng Sunday, an affiliate of the Korea JoongAng Daily, Judy Hsu, CEO, Wealth and Retail Banking and Greater China & North Asia at Standard Chartered, said SC Bank Korea's strength lies in meeting the needs of HNWIs by leveraging the global network and expertise of its British parent company. SC entered the Korean market in 2005 through the acquisition of the Korea First Bank, or Jeil Bank, and is now marking nearly 20 years of operations in the country.

The following interview has been edited for length and clarity.

Q. The role of banks in the WM market, distinct from securities firms, has become more important. What are your thoughts on this?

A. When somebody opens a bank account they usually keep it for 20 to 30 years. So that long history of trust — a relationship — and the bank's ability to understand the client needs is quite an important part of the bank's ability to extend from just doing basic banking to now advisory, which is what WM is about. WM is not just about selling a stock or a bond or a fund. Our focus is really understanding the client's needs, their financial objectives and their risk tolerance [...] and then providing a holistic platform of products and services to meet those needs. Security houses in Korea clearly have strong capabilities in equities and more trading. What banks really do is much deeper in terms of building up deeper trust, a long-term relationship and we bring balance sheet strength.

The proportion of HNWIs in the WM market is growing. What are their main interests and investment trends?

Transition investing refers to funds that invest in companies who are trying to grow increasingly green or reduce their emissions. So, we have a very broad range of products that support clients who want to really participate in that — the transition, or investing in the infrastructure for more renewable energy. I would have to say that SC is a real leading player in transition financing — in really supporting our clients in reducing their emissions. It's because of the trend, with what's happened in the amount of energy that now the world needs. And the only way to generate that is find new source of energy. Globally, we have sustainable deposits where the deposit is only used to support green energy, renewable energy or transition or other more sustainable type of investments.

What sets SC's WM business apart?

We have four big wealth hubs, which is Hong Kong, Singapore, the United Arab Emirates [UAE] and Jersey. Banks play a very key role. So, our relationship managers here are that window to the world. We want to make sure that our relationship manager here understands the clients and their need in terms of their global or their international objectives.

How does the global network function?

I think increasingly Koreans are becoming very international — they send their children overseas, they travel or immigrate. Then potentially, let's say a Korean family is moving overseas for its children's education and they want to buy a property in Britain. Our relationship managers here can then refer our clients to our colleague in Britain and we can offer a British mortgage or understand the British residential property market or we can help them to understand some of the educational needs.

As a bank, we are called a 'super connector.' You know all our teams either in Korea, in Hong Kong, in China, everyone is linked to the global network in terms of understanding what we could do to bring our network to our clients.

SC has launched a private banking center in Korea under the name Priority Private in Apgujeong in Gangnam District, southern Seoul, on Thursday. How does this differ from the services offered to HNWI's by other local banks?

We have sixteen Priority Private centers globally, including Hong Kong, Singapore, Taiwan, the UAE, India and China, and this is the seventh Priority Private center. Ultimately, as I said, our job is to build that long-term relationship and really be able to help our clients, and create and construct a portfolio that suits their risk profile. We have 23 relationship managers that will be supporting our clients and they're all trained by our SC-Insead Wealth Academy so that they are able to bring this strong platform and products and advice to our clients.

This article was originally written in Korean and translated by a bilingual reporter with the help of generative AI tools. It was then edited by a native English-speaking editor. All AI-assisted translations are reviewed and refined by our newsroom.

BY LEE CHANG-KYUN [shin.minhee@joongang.co.kr]

[Click here to see image](#)

Judy Hsu, CEO of Standard Chartered bank's wealth and retail banking and greater China and north Asia [STANDARD CHARTERED]

[Click here to see image](#)

The Standard Chartered bank logo is seen at its London headquarters on July 26, 2022. [REUTERS/YONHAP]

[Click here to see image](#)

Judy Hsu, CEO of Standard Chartered bank's wealth and retail banking and greater China and north Asia [STANDARD CHARTERED]

Document JOONAI0020251121elbl002p9

Exclusive: Standard Chartered hires China team lead from BOC

James Phillipps

166 words

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Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered **Private Bank** has hired a mainland China team lead from Bank of China (Hong Kong) **Private Banking**.

Ares So, who was a China team head at BOCHK for three and a half years, is understood to be joining with a team of at least two.

Prior to BOCHK, So spent more than eight years at China Citic Bank International in a similar role. He also had shorter stints at CMB Wing Lung Bank and Agricultural Bank of China. So started out in **private banking** working as a relationship manager at Citigold.

Standard Chartered declined to comment.

Last month, the bank's [market head](#) for Singapore and Indochina, Onnah Liew, left after four years.

In June, the British lender hired a Greater China [private markets head](#), as it continued to bolster its alternatives capabilities. Stacey Hsiao was recruited from DBS.

Back in May, Standard Chartered also appointed a Hong Kong-based [philanthropy head](#) for Asia, Scott Chang.

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Standard Chartered opens priority banking center in Apgujeong-dong for VIP customers

520 words

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Korea JoongAng Daily

JOONAI

English

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Standard Chartered Bank Korea (SCBK) opened its first priority private banking center in Korea for VIP customers with at least 1 billion won (\$680,000) on Thursday. The Apgujeong center is the bank's 16th priority private center globally.

Standard Chartered Bank Korea (SCBK) opened its first priority private banking center in Korea for VIP customers with at least 1 billion won (\$680,000) on Thursday.

The Apgujeong Priority Private Center, located in southern Seoul, is the bank's 16th priority private center globally. The Seoul branch comes after the establishment of centers in Singapore, Hong Kong, Taiwan, the UAE, India and mainland China.

The Apgujeong Priority Private Center consists of six floors, featuring a premium lounge and reception area, 11 client consulting rooms and a private vault. It boasts 22 dedicated relationship managers with over 10 years of experience in **wealth management**, including the center manager, and a team of experts in investments, foreign exchange and insurance.

The private center will provide customers with wealth solutions, personalized **wealth management** services, legacy and succession planning, global experiences and lifestyle privileges, according to SCBK.

"We are the only international bank with retail banking operations in Korea and aim to deliver a higher level of financial solutions in the local market backed by world-class global investment strategies," said SCBK CEO Lee Kwang-hee. "We plan to open additional Priority Private Centers in other regions with high concentrations of affluent clients."

The establishment comes in line with Standard Chartered's aim at "driving sustainable growth through **wealth management** business for affluent clients in Korea, one of its key markets," according to the bank's press release. Standard Chartered will also open additional branches in cities with high concentrations of affluent clients, including in Busan, as well as in the greater Seoul metropolitan area.

"Korea is a key contributor to our affluent business and an integral part of our global strategy," said Judy Hsu, CEO of Wealth and Retail Banking at Standard Chartered. "The launch of our Apgujeong Priority Private Center underscores our long-term commitment and investment in the Korean market and addresses the growing demand for tailored **wealth management** solutions and personalized services among our affluent clients."

BY YOON SO-YEON [yoon.soyeon@joongang.co.kr]

[Click here to see image](#)

Executives from Standard Chartered Bank Korea (SCBK) and guests attend a ribbon-cutting ceremony for the Apgujeong Priority Private Centre opening in Apgujeong, southern Seoul, on Nov. 20. Pictured in the front row are Choi Hee-nam, board chair of SCBK, fifth from left; Judy Hsu, CEO of Wealth and Retail Banking and Greater China & North Asia, sixth from left; and Lee Kwang-hee, CEO of SCBK, seventh from left. [SCBK]

[Click here to see image](#)

Judy Hsu, CEO of Wealth and Retail Banking and Greater China & North Asia at Standard Chartered, left, and Lee Kwang-hee, CEO of Standard Chartered Bank Korea, pose for photos with golf coach Pak Se-ri Pak at the opening ceremony of Apgujeong Priority Private Centre in southern Seoul on Nov. 20. [SCBK]

Document JOONAI0020251120elbk001rx

HSBC Malaysia expands wealth growth ambition with new Wealth Centre at Johor Bahru for Premier Elite customers

Distributed by Contify.com

1,174 words

18 November 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC Malaysia has expanded its wealth growth ambition with a new Wealth Centre at Johor Bahru for Premier Elite customers.

* The new Wealth Centre is located at HSBC's Jalan Bukit Timbalan branch and provides bespoke in-person **wealth management** solutions tailored to wealth accumulation, protection, and legacy planning.

* Johor serves as an ideal location for HSBC's wealth centre, given its proximity to international financial centre Singapore and investments pouring in from the Johor-Singapore Special Economic Zone.

Original Press Release:

Nov. 18 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

HSBC Malaysia today announced the opening of its new Wealth Centre in Johor Bahru, reinforcing the Bank's commitment to expand its wealth and affluent banking capabilities across the country. The new Wealth Centre is designed to cater to the state's growing affluent population. This milestone underscores HSBC Malaysia's strategic ambition to accelerate growth in affluent and high net worth segments while deepening its presence in key cross-border growth corridors.

Johor serves as an ideal location for HSBC's wealth centre, given its proximity to international financial centre Singapore, and further propelled by investments pouring in from the Johor-Singapore Special Economic Zone. Johor's diversification beyond manufacturing into data centres, digital infrastructure and advanced manufacturing have also contributed to its growing wealth trajectory.

Located at HSBC's Jalan Bukit Timbalan branch, the new Wealth Centre is designed to cater to the growing needs of Premier Elite[1] clients. The exclusive, appointment-only centre provides bespoke in-person **wealth management** solutions tailored to wealth accumulation, protection and legacy planning.

The opening of the wealth centre was officiated by YB Tuan Lee Ting Han, Chairman, Johor State Investment, Trade, Consumer Affairs and Human Resources Committee and witnessed by Dato' Omar Siddiq, CEO of HSBC Bank Malaysia, and Linda Yip, Country Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking, HSBC Bank Malaysia.

During his keynote YB Lee said "The positive spillover effect from the rapid growth in Johor's economy is to be channelled towards the prosperity of its people, via the creation of new job opportunities and an increase in household income. The pursuit of higher growth, coupled with a stronger ringgit are elevating living standards, bringing the achievement of higher-income status closer to fruition. The pivotal role of the financial sector is paramount in this trajectory, while international connectivity is key to further spur the growth of investments. Today, I am glad to see international banks such as HSBC expanding their presence in Johor."

Commenting on the significance of the new Wealth Centre, HSBC's Yip said, "We are proud to celebrate the opening of our new Wealth Centre in Johor Bahru, an important milestone that underscores our long-term commitment to expanding our **wealth management** franchise across Malaysia. This investment reflects our confidence in the growth potential of the state of Johor and the increasing need for sophisticated wealth solutions among our growing Premier Elite clients.

"Last year, Johor emerged as the fastest growing state in Malaysia with a growth of 6.4% surpassing the national growth rate of 5.1%^[2] and this positive momentum is expected to continue with investments pouring into the Johor-Singapore Special Economic Zone. More entrepreneurs, professionals and business owners are building their families, businesses and financial portfolios here. This growth has created a vibrant wealth diaspora, making Johor an increasingly important hub for investments and wealth preservation.

"HSBC's roots in Johor started in 1960 with the opening of the Bukit Timbalan branch, and today the Bank is expanding its presence in the state with our wealth centre which not only signifies Johor's growing wealth narrative but also reinforces Malaysia's position as a growing wealth hub in the region," said Yip.

2025 has been a pivotal year for HSBC in the affluent banking and **wealth management** space. In August this year, HSBC launched the all-new HSBC Premier in Malaysia, with a focus on four pillars, Wealth, Health, Travel and International, to meet the evolving demands of the affluent and high net worth segment in Malaysia.

"For the Wealth pillar, we wanted to bring the best in wealth offerings to our customers, from personalised and curated portfolios to a comprehensive suite of exclusive wealth, protection and legacy planning solutions. Our wealth centres are designed to provide an exclusive environment where our Premier Elite customers can engage with senior relationship managers and wealth specialists and gain valuable regional and global market insights. With Malaysia's fast expanding affluent segment, the demand for bespoke wealth products and solutions is here to stay, and we look forward to being a trusted partner to our customers," said Yip.

Also marking their presence in Johor are HSBC's lions, Stephen and Stitt. The positioning of the iconic duo, which are known to guard HSBC offices across the globe is strategically placed at the Bukit Timbalan branch, facing the prosperous Straits of Johor, signifying the international flow of wealth, and serving as tangible symbols of HSBC's international capabilities, and the Bank's commitment towards customers around the globe.

The Johor Bahru wealth centre will also house the latest art installation by renowned Malaysian artist Red Hong Yi. Aptly titled "Tides", the artwork intricately assembles 12,960 gold 50-sen coins that are inked and placed with precision to form the rising motion of ocean waves, signifying the flow of wealth, ambition and legacy across generations.

The opening of HSBC's wealth centre in Johor amplifies the Bank's growing ambition to be the leading international bank and **wealth manager** in the country. Earlier this year, HSBC opened its flagship wealth centre at the Tun Razak Exchange financial centre.

HSBC Malaysia

HSBC's presence in Malaysia dates back to 1884 when the Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited established its first office in the country on the island of Penang, with the permission to issue currency notes. HSBC Bank Malaysia Berhad was locally incorporated in 1984 and is a wholly-owned subsidiary of The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited, founding member of the HSBC Group. In 2007, HSBC Bank Malaysia was the first foreign bank to be awarded an Islamic banking subsidiary license in Malaysia, namely HSBC Amanah Malaysia Berhad. HSBC Malaysia offers a comprehensive range of banking and financial services including Islamic financial solutions. HSBC Malaysia has also led innovation in Malaysia by introducing Malaysia's first ATM and Electronic Touch Banking in the early 1980s. Today, HSBC Malaysia has launched innovative solutions such as HSBCnet for secure banking for businesses, Trade Transaction Tracker and Facial Recognition on supported mobile phones.

Footnotes:

[1] Premier Elite is available to selected holders of an HSBC/HSBC Amanah Premier Account/-i who have maintained, at all times, a Total Relationship Balance* of at least RM3 million with HSBC.

[2] Department of Statistics Malaysia

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Business Expansion]

Source: HSBC Group

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Business

Standard Chartered tailors UAE offerings to serve wealthy Chinese residents

Aileen Chuang

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SCMCOM

English

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The United Arab Emirates is a growing hub for people who come to work, set up **family offices** and start businesses, bank's wealth CEO says

[Standard Chartered](#) is targeting the growing number of Chinese individuals living, working and starting businesses in the [United Arab Emirates \(UAE\)](#) as part of a push to expand its [wealth-management business](#).

"We now bank an increasing number of Asian clients, specifically Chinese families, in the UAE," said Judy Hsu, the bank's CEO of wealth and retail banking, in an exclusive interview. "It has become a growing hub for people who come and work, set up **family offices** and start their businesses."

The bank did not disclose the number or percentage growth of its Chinese clients in the UAE. The overall population of Chinese citizens in the country was estimated at 400,000 at the end of 2022, twice the level in 2019, while about 6,000 Chinese enterprises were operating there, China's ambassador to the country, Zhang Yiming, told local media at the time.

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

Standard Chartered ramped up investments in the country's affluent private-banking business over the past four years, bolstering its platforms and relationship managers to serve the growing demand for cross-border banking solutions, said Hsu, who was in Dubai last month for the bank's [flagship event](#) for global **family offices**.

The move aligned with Standard Chartered's overall strategy to promote wealth management as its growth engine by investing US\$1.5 billion over the next five years. Its third-quarter fee and non-interest income increased 7 per cent from a year earlier to US\$3.7 billion, after logging a 31 per cent surge in the previous quarter, thanks to product launches and the addition of rich clients.

Warming ties between Asia and the [Middle East](#), as well as the UAE's preferential immigration and tax policies, propelled the flow of people and capital, Hsu said.

Annual China-Middle East trade volume had grown to more than US\$400 billion, according to government data, as countries in the region sought to diversify their economies and insulate against geopolitical shocks.

Chinese state-owned enterprises, including major oil companies, were among the first to establish a presence in the UAE, followed by businesses linked to their supply chains and entrepreneurs [setting up operations](#) in the region, Hsu said.

"A number of the affluent population of the global Chinese came here to live and start businesses, to support the local economy," Hsu said, citing sectors like education and technology. The pattern was different from that seen in Singapore, where many people from mainland China opened accounts without relocating, she added.

To meet the demand of Chinese clients and address the language barrier, Standard Chartered hired more relationship managers from mainland China and Hong Kong in the UAE. While that number was not disclosed, the overall relationship managers increased by 20 per cent this year compared with a year ago.

"Language is still important, so we need a local platform to support them as their wealth grows," Hsu said.

Additionally, the bank provides both onshore and offshore banking.

Hsu said the onshore leg offered local-currency products such as mortgages to take advantage of the growing property market in the country. The offshore element was operated in the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC), an independent financial free zone governed by its own laws and courts, where clients could invest in products and services based in Singapore or Hong Kong, she added.

One of the key propositions the bank offered was cross-border asset-backed lending, which allowed clients to use their investments, assets or properties to borrow in another market, Hsu said. "Many of our clients have accounts in the local platform, our DIFC and Hong Kong, and what we're doing right now is to link all these relationships together," she said.

In September, Hong Kong's market regulator signed [initial accords](#) with its UAE counterpart to allow public investment funds to be distributed seamlessly in both markets.

"If you look at onshore, only a few international players like us have these expansive products," said Hsu. "We have brought in a lot of our capabilities onshore, and the regulators here have supported us."

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UOB Private Bank, BCG and NUS Business School publish White Paper on navigating wealth succession within Asia

Distributed by Contify.com

1,424 words

11 November 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* More than 60% of the region's HNW individuals are already over 60, with much of their wealth tied to family businesses.

* The White Paper highlights the unique challenges Asian families face in wealth succession due to differing wealth ambitions, views on family legacy, and cultural sensitivities.

* The report offers key learnings and practical frameworks to support successful wealth transfers within families, including professionalisation of family businesses, structured governance, and appropriate ownership structures.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Nov. 11 -- United Overseas Bank Limited issued the following news release:

- Asia has projected USD 99 trillion wealth market this decade, but close to half of first-generation wealth holders are not proactively planning for handovers.

UOB **Private Bank**, Boston Consulting Group (BCG) and National University of Singapore (NUS) Business School today released its first comprehensive White Paper on intergenerational wealth transfer through an Asian lens, titled "The Asia Generational Wealth Report 2025: Succession in a new era".

The publication features perspectives from more than 220 high-net-worth (HNW) individuals and families surveyed and interviewed across Asia. Associate Professor Yupana Wiwattanakantang from NUS Business School also draws on her expertise and research in the fields of family capitalism, corporate finance and governance, and family succession planning to provide valuable insight. The White Paper illustrates the complexity in navigating intergenerational wealth transfer for Asian families at the crossroads of succession planning, along with expert insights to guide families in navigating their wealth transfer journey, build enduring legacies, and ensure their success across generations.

Mr Chew Mun Yew, Head of UOB **Private Bank**, said, "The Asia region is rapidly expanding as a dominant force in the global private wealth market. We see this in UOB **Private Bank**'s HNW client base too, which has more than doubled from 2021 to today. The next chapter of the region's wealth will be defined by the complex task of wealth transfer, with many Asian businesses being relatively young and hence lacking in institutionalised and tested governance structures."

"As a third-generation bank ourselves, we have seen how early engagement, thoughtful planning and guided conversations can transform succession. This White Paper pulls together helpful insights from both experts and regional HNW families, aiming to help other HNW families initiate meaningful conversations and provide practical guidance for smooth wealth succession."

Mr Ernest Saudjana, Head of BCG in Southeast Asia, said, "Asia's private wealth is projected to reach USD 99 trillion by 2029, underscoring the urgency of succession planning today. Singapore and Hong Kong have emerged as key destinations for wealth inflows, with more than 80 per cent originating within Asia. Much of this wealth remains tied to relatively young family businesses, where leadership transitions are complex and still evolving. More than 60 per cent of the region's HNW individuals are also already over 60, with much of their wealth tied to family businesses. With many founders now at the age of handover, continuity planning is no longer optional, but essential."

The White Paper highlights the unique challenges Asian families face in wealth succession due to differing wealth ambitions, views on family legacy, and cultural sensitivities.

The first main hurdle lies in differing wealth ambitions. Among younger cohorts aged 30 to 35, 52 per cent hold equities and 33 per cent hold digital assets as part of their top three asset classes in their wealth portfolio. In contrast, older or founding generations aged 60 and above prefer traditional assets, with close to 70 per cent having investment properties in their top three.

The second distinction is in differing mindsets around business ownership and control. While 91 per cent of first-generation wealth holders want business leadership to be retained within the family, almost a quarter cited a lack of interest from heirs. More NextGen leaders are increasingly open to appointing external professionals to run the business while retaining ownership.

Lastly, many families delay succession discussions, leading to reactive, rather than proactive, wealth transitions. 37 per cent of business founders cited health issues and 43 per cent cited business circumstances as main triggers for business handovers.

These insights reveal a tendency to underestimate the complexity of developing optimal and lasting business structures, especially when intertwined with the need for family consensus.

Associate Professor Yupana Wiwattanakantang from NUS Business School shared, "I have seen how family decisions reverberate far beyond the household. Strong family businesses drive growth, create jobs, and shape communities. Helping families navigate this transition is therefore not only a private matter but holds broader economic and social importance."

Alongside intergenerational challenges, the White Paper offers key learnings and practical frameworks to support successful wealth transfers within families.

First, succession may require professionalisation for family businesses to endure. With differing views between founding patriarchs and the NextGen leaders, more families are exploring pragmatic options, from appointing external CEOs to forming strategic partnerships.

Second, structured governance, such as formalised family charters and regular forums, can help to minimise emotional friction and ensure business resiliency. Ultimately, family consensus remains the true currency of continuity.

Third, appropriate ownership structures should be established. Scattered ownership fragments control and undermines the continuity that succession aims to secure. Incorporating early design of ownership structures helps in balancing fairness with control, preserving authority and ensuring ownership strengthens, rather than destabilises, businesses.

Lastly, preserving intangible assets is vital to maintaining the family's business edge. These include long-standing business connections and deep industry knowledge, which must be deliberately transferred and instilled in the next generation, through mentorship, board participation, and exposure to key networks.

The White Paper emphasises the integration of wealth planning with business continuity to ensure resilience through transitions. Families are encouraged to consult their relationship managers to develop tailored approaches towards wealth and business succession.

About UOB

UOB is a leading bank in Asia. Operating through its head office in Singapore and banking subsidiaries in China, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand and Vietnam, UOB has a global network of more than 470 branches and offices in 19 markets in Asia Pacific, Europe and North America. Since its incorporation in 1935, UOB has grown organically and through a series of strategic acquisitions. Today, UOB is rated among the world's top banks: Aa1 by Moody's Investors Service and AA- by both S&P Global Ratings and Fitch Ratings.

For nine decades, UOB has adopted a customer-centric approach to create long-term value by staying relevant through its enterprising spirit and doing right by its customers. UOB is focused on building the future of ASEAN – for the people and businesses within, and connecting with, ASEAN.

The Bank connects businesses to opportunities in the region with its unparalleled regional footprint and leverages data and insights to innovate and create personalised banking experiences and solutions catering to each customer's unique needs and evolving preferences. UOB is also committed to help businesses forge a

sustainable future, by fostering social inclusiveness, creating positive environmental impact and pursuing economic progress. UOB believes in being a responsible financial services provider and is steadfast in its support of art, social development of children and education, doing right by its communities and stakeholders.

About Boston Consulting Group

Boston Consulting Group partners with leaders in business and society to tackle their most important challenges and capture their greatest opportunities. BCG was the pioneer in business strategy when it was founded in 1963. Today, we help clients embrace transformation to benefit all stakeholders—empowering organizations to grow, build sustainable competitive advantage, and drive positive societal impact.

Our diverse global teams bring deep industry expertise and a range of perspectives that spark change. BCG delivers solutions through leading-edge management consulting, technology and design, and digital ventures. We work collaboratively across the firm and with our clients to help them thrive and make the world a better place.

About NUS Business School

With 50,000 alumni and 60 global chapters, the National University of Singapore (NUS) Business School is known for providing management thought leadership from an Asian perspective, enabling its students and corporate partners to leverage global knowledge and Asian insights.

The Financial Times and Quacquarelli Symonds, in recognition of the quality of its programmes, faculty research and graduates.

The school is accredited by AACSB International (Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business) and EQUIS (European Quality Improvement System), endorsements that the school has met the highest standards for business education.

[Category: Education, Asset and Wealth Management, Professional Services]

Source: United Overseas Bank Limited

Document ATINBK0020251112elbb000b6

OCBC Group Third Quarter 2025 Net Profit Rose 9% above the Previous Quarter to S\$1.98 billion

Distributed by Contify.com

1,629 words

7 November 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Total income for 3Q25 rose 7% quarter-on-quarter, driven by record non-interest income.

* Net interest income was S\$2.23 billion, 2% lower quarter-on-quarter, due to a 8 basis-point compression in net interest margin.

* Non-interest income grew 24% from the previous quarter to S\$1.57 billion, supported by broad-based growth across fee, trading and insurance income.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Nov. 7 -- Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited issued the following news release:

- Nine months 2025 net profit at S\$5.68 billion

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited ("OCBC") reported a net profit of S\$1.98 billion for the third quarter of 2025 ("3Q25"), up 9% from S\$1.82 billion in the previous quarter ("2Q25") and unchanged from the same period a year ago ("3Q24"). Net profit for the nine months of 2025 ("9M25") was S\$5.68 billion, 4% lower compared to a year ago ("9M24").

Total income for 3Q25 rose 7% quarter-on-quarter, underpinned by record non-interest income, which more than compensated for the decline in net interest income. Robust momentum in **wealth management** and treasury sales lifted fee and trading income, and insurance delivered strong results. Cost-to-income ratio ("CIR") in 3Q25 was 40.0%, and credit costs were 16 basis points on an annualised basis. Asset quality remained resilient, with non-performing loan ("NPL") ratio unchanged at 0.9%. On an annualised basis, return on equity ("ROE") improved from last quarter to 13.4% and earnings per share ("EPS") increased to S\$1.72.

Disclaimer: Table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2025/ocbc-group-third-quarter-2025-net-profit-rose-9percent.page>

3Q25 Quarter-on-Quarter Performance

Group net profit rose 9% from a quarter ago to S\$1.98 billion, driven by stronger non-interest income which cushioned the impact of a lower net interest income.

* Net interest income was S\$2.23 billion, 2% lower quarter-on-quarter. While average assets increased, this was more than offset by an 8 basis-point compression in net interest margin ("NIM") to 1.84%. The narrowing of NIM was mainly due to a downward repricing of loans from the decline of benchmark rates in SGD and other currencies, where the moderation in loan yields outpaced the reduction in deposit costs.

* Non-interest income grew 24% from the previous quarter to S\$1.57 billion, supported by broad-based growth across fee, trading and insurance income.

- Net fee income increased 18% to S\$683 million, led by a 35% rise in **wealth management** fees, reflecting strong customer activities across a broad range of products. Loan and trade-related, fund management and brokerage fees were also higher.

- Net trading income was S\$518 million, up 38% from the previous quarter. Customer flow treasury income rose 29% to S\$373 million, supported by both wealth and corporate segments.

- Insurance income from GEH was up 38% to S\$311 million, largely attributable to improved investment performance of its insurance funds. Total weighted new sales increased 3% to S\$373 million from sustained sales momentum. New business embedded value ("NBEV") grew 9% to S\$182 million, and NBEV margin improved to 48.8%.

* The Group's **wealth management** income, comprising income from private banking, premier private client, premier banking, insurance, asset management and stockbroking, was S\$1.62 billion, up 25% from the previous quarter. Group **wealth management** income accounted for 43% of total income, higher than 37% in 2Q25. Banking **wealth management** AUM grew 8% from a quarter ago to a record high of S\$336 billion, supported by net new money inflows and positive market valuation.

* Operating expenses rose 9% quarter-on-quarter to S\$1.52 billion, largely due to increased staff costs and continued investments in technology.

* Total allowances were S\$139 million, up 21% mainly attributable to higher allowances for impaired assets. Credit costs were 16 basis points on an annualised basis.

* Share of results of associates of S\$279 million was 6% above 2Q25.

3Q25 Year-on-Year Performance

Group net profit was unchanged year-on-year at S\$1.98 billion, supported by higher non-interest income and lower allowances.

* Net interest income of S\$2.23 billion was 9% lower, as NIM contracted by 34 basis points to 1.84% amid a softening interest rate environment, partly offset by average asset growth of 9%.

* Non-interest income grew 15% year-on-year to S\$1.57 billion from broad-based fee, trading and insurance income growth.

* Operating expenses were up 4% from the previous year to S\$1.52 billion, and CIR was 40.0%.

* Total allowances of S\$139 million were 18% lower year-on-year.

* Share of results of associates was S\$279 million, an increase of 11% from a year ago.

Disclaimer: Table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2025/ocbc-group-third-quarter-2025-net-profit-rose-9percent.page>

9M25 Year-on-Year Performance

Group net profit was S\$5.68 billion, 4% lower compared to 9M24.

* Net interest income fell 6% to S\$6.85 billion amid a lower interest rate environment, as the compression in NIM more than offset the 8% rise in average assets. NIM contracted 29 basis points to 1.93%, as the decline in loan yields outpaced the reduction in funding costs. The Group also continued to deploy liquidity into high-quality assets which were income-accretive but lower yielding.

* Non-interest income rose 10% to a new high of S\$4.14 billion. Net fee income grew 24% to S\$1.81 billion, led by a 35% rise in **wealth management** fees, alongside growth across most fee segments. Net trading income was 4% higher at S\$1.29 billion, driven by customer flow treasury income. Insurance income improved by 3% to S\$843 million.

* Operating expenses were S\$4.32 billion, 3% above the previous year. The increase was mainly from increased staff costs largely attributable to annual salary adjustments and IT-related costs to support the Group's business growth. CIR was 39.3%, compared to 37.8% a year ago.

* Share of results of associates was S\$816 million, 9% above 9M24.

* Total allowances were 4% lower at S\$466 million, mainly due to a decline in allowances for impaired assets.

* On an annualised basis, the Group's ROE was lower at 12.9%. EPS was S\$1.67, 4% below the previous year.

Disclaimer: Table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2025/ocbc-group-third-quarter-2025-net-profit-rose-9percent.page>

Non-performing assets ("NPAs")

* Total NPAs were S\$2.99 billion as at 30 September 2025, 7% above the previous year. On a quarter-on-quarter basis, NPAs declined by 1%, largely due to higher recoveries/upgrades and write-offs, which more than offset new corporate NPA formation.

* NPL ratio was stable at 0.9%, and allowance coverage for total NPAs was 160%.

Allowances

* Total allowances for 9M25 declined 4% year-on-year to S\$466 million, and comprised:

* Allowances for non-impaired assets of S\$167 million, which included additional allowances set aside to cater for increased macroeconomic uncertainties during the year; and

* Allowances for impaired assets of S\$299 million, which were lower than the S\$371 million a year ago.

* Total allowances of S\$139 million for 3Q25 were largely from allowances for impaired assets.

* On an annualised basis, total credit costs for 9M25 were 17 basis points, unchanged from a year ago.

Disclaimer: Table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2025/ocbc-group-third-quarter-2025-net-profit-rose-9percent.page>

* Customer loans were S\$327 billion as at 30 September 2025, up 7% year-on-year and 1% quarter-on quarter.

- The year-on-year loan growth was broad-based across both consumer and corporate loans, led by the transport, storage and communication sector. By geography, growth was underpinned by Singapore, Malaysia, as well as the Group's international markets including the United Kingdom, United States and Europe.

- Sustainable financing loans increased 17% from a year ago to S\$55.0 billion, and accounted for 17% of total customer loans; total commitments reached S\$75.8 billion as at 30 September 2025.

* Customer deposits rose 11% from a year ago, mainly driven by growth in CASA deposits from both corporate and consumer segments, with CASA ratio rising to above 50%.

* Loans-to-deposits ratio was 78.6%, largely unchanged from the prior quarter.

* The Group is subject to MAS' final Basel III reforms requirements which came into effect on 1 July 2024, and are being progressively phased in between 1 July 2024 and 1 January 2029. Group CET 1 CAR as at 30 September 2025 was 16.9%, and on a fully phased-in basis, it was 15.0%.

Message from Group CEO, Helen Wong

"We delivered a strong set of third quarter results, which underscored the resilience of our diversified banking, **wealth management** and insurance franchise. Our solid performance this quarter was underpinned by continued growth in customer activities and wealth AUM, which lifted fee and trading income. Insurance also delivered higher profit contribution.

Looking ahead, the external environment remains complex, shaped by shifting policy dynamics and geopolitical tensions. Our strong balance sheet and robust capital position provides us with flexibility to manage these risks, and enables us to support our customers and invest for future growth."

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Insurance, Banking and Financial Services, Financial Results]

Source: Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited

Document ATINBK0020251107elb7000dx

HSBC Holdings: Global entrepreneurs see UK as top destination for business

Distributed by Contify.com

916 words

6 November 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* The UK is ranked as one of the most popular markets for global entrepreneurs to conduct business, second only to Singapore.

* UK entrepreneurs are among the most optimistic in the world, with 98% saying they are positive about their business prospects.

* The UK's strengths as a location for entrepreneurs include its AI and tech credentials, world-class professional services, quality of life, and top schools and universities.

Original Press Release:

LONDON, UK, Nov. 6 -- HSBC Holdings plc issued the following news release:

Entrepreneurs around the world rank the UK as one of the most popular markets to conduct business, with only Singapore ranking higher in terms of appeal.

In HSBC **Private Bank**'s latest report, An Entrepreneurial Outlook on the UK, the UK also ranks as an attractive place for global entrepreneurs to move their financial assets to and live, despite rising competition from other international wealth centres and ongoing discussions surrounding taxation.

The UK's appeal to wealthy global business owners is driven by its strong credentials in AI and innovation. Access to advanced technology is the leading reason why global entrepreneurs say they are interested in conducting business in the UK over the coming year, cited by 39 per cent of respondents globally.

Similarly, entrepreneurs in the UK cite AI and technology as a driver behind why they are so positive about their business outlook. In fact, UK entrepreneurs are among the most optimistic in the world, with 98 per cent saying they are positive about their business prospects and 96 per cent positive about the trajectory of their personal wealth.

When asked what was driving their positive business outlook, nearly three-quarters (73 per cent) cited technology or AI as a leading reason. Entrepreneurs globally also cited the UK's strong financial and professional services, world class schools and universities, and quality of life as draws for the UK.

The report also shows some of the challenges the UK faces, including competition from rival international wealth centres, as well as the globally mobile nature of entrepreneurs.

One quarter (26 per cent) of entrepreneurs in the UK are considering a personal move or adding a new residence abroad in the next 12 months (compared with a global average of 57 per cent). While business and investment opportunities are their main motivation, tax is also a consideration for one in 10 (9 per cent). This is less than the global average of 18 per cent, but demonstrates that entrepreneurs have many global options and opportunities.

Charles Boulton, UK CEO of HSBC **Private Bank**, commented: "The UK's strengths as a location for entrepreneurs to live, work and invest remain extremely compelling. Its AI and tech credentials are increasingly appealing to both UK and international business owners, and it continues to benefit from world class professional services, a great quality of life and top schools and universities. But the UK needs to continue to adapt to thrive. Entrepreneurs are willing to explore the world for new opportunities, and with wealth rising across Asia and the Middle East, competition for the world's best and brightest is getting stronger."

The bank's report also highlights that:

The top three reasons for UK entrepreneurs feeling positive about their wealth outlook are the opportunities available to them (65 per cent), performance from their investments (62 per cent), and the outlook for the local economy (43 per cent)

UK entrepreneurs' greatest worries for their personal wealth are volatility in financial markets (40 per cent), balancing enjoying and growing wealth (37 per cent), and inflation (33 per cent)

The leading reasons why international entrepreneurs want to add a UK home are to gain access to new investment opportunities (60 per cent), expand into new markets (52 per cent), better quality of life (48 per cent), and education (46 per cent)

Expanding their business to new markets and gaining access to new investment opportunities are the leading reasons why entrepreneurs in the UK are considering moving overseas in the next 12 months (both 18 per cent of those surveyed)

About An Entrepreneurial Outlook on the UK

The findings are based on the Global Entrepreneurial Wealth Report research conducted by Ipsos UK on behalf of HSBC among 2,939 high net worth business owners – including more than 400 from the UK – with at least USD2 million of investable assets. A third (956) were ultra high net worth with a net worth of more than USD100 million. The research was conducted online in mainland China, France, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Malaysia, Philippines, Saudi Arabia, Singapore, Switzerland, Taiwan, Thailand, UAE, UK and US. Fieldwork was conducted between 19th April and 21st May 2025. See the report for the full methodology.

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy.

www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 57 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,234 billion at 30 September 2025, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations

[Category: Awards and Recognitions, Artificial Intelligence]

Source: HSBC Holdings plc

Document ATINBK0020251114elb6000er

People

Systematix appoints former StanChart execs to head private wealth unit

Ajay Ramanathan

342 words

4 November 2025

VCCircle

MMVVCC

English

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Diversified financial services firm Systematix has appointed Bhaskar Hazra and Partha Sengupta as joint managing directors and chief executive officers of its private wealth business.

Hazra brings over 26 years of experience across consumer and private banking, having held senior leadership roles at Barclays Private Bank, Standard Chartered Bank, and GE Countrywide. His career spans India, the UAE, and other key global markets.

At Systematix, Hazra will focus on strategic direction, market expansion across India and the Middle East, and drive digital transformation for the private wealth business.

Sengupta, with over 27 years of experience in banking, **wealth management**, strategy, and business transformation, has led businesses at Axis Bank, TrustPlutus **Wealth Managers**, and Standard Chartered Bank. In his new role, he will focus on building a future-ready, technology-driven, and client-centric **wealth management** platform.

"Their strategic foresight, proven leadership, and deep industry expertise will enable us to build a world-class private wealth business franchise grounded in trust, innovation, and long-term value creation," said Nikhil Khandelwal, managing director, Systematix Group, in a press note.

"This marks a defining milestone in our journey to broaden and strengthen our financial services portfolio," he added.

Founded in 1985, Systematix Group offers a suite of financial products and advisory services across brokerage, investment banking, ECM, wealth, and asset management. Systematix serves a diversified client base comprising FIIs, domestic institutions, insurers, banks, corporates, promoters, HNIs, and retail investors. It has a presence in over 30 cities and services over 40,000 registered clients.

Systematix offers a wide range of **wealth management** products in equity, currency, commodity, IPOs, mutual funds, and portfolio management services. The group's flagship entity, Systematix Corporate Services, is listed on the bourses.

In September, Systematix Corporate Services announced the first close [1] of its alternative investment fund focussed on backing small and medium-sized enterprises.

[1] <https://www.vccircle.com/systematixmarks-first-close-of-sme-focused-investment-fund>

[Click here to view story.](#)

[Click here to view image.](#)

Document MMVVCC0020251104elb40002v

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** expands flagship Global Families Network Forum with Next Gen Programme

Distributed by Contify.com

950 words

3 November 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* The Global Families Network Forum is a platform for **family offices** and high net worth individuals to connect and share best practices.

* Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** serves affluent clients across the full wealth continuum via Private, Priority and Personal Banking.

* The bank's business model combines cross-border capabilities with wealth management expertise to meet the local and international banking needs of its clients.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Dubai, Nov. 3 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

- 90 UHNW families from over 30 markets gathered for 2-day event in the UAE

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** ("Standard Chartered" or "the Bank") welcomed over 200 international clients and guests to the second edition of its flagship Global Families Network Forum in the UAE. This year's event brought together 90 global ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) families from across Europe, the Middle East, Africa and Asia.

Themed "Shifting Paradigms", this second edition of the Bank's flagship event for UHNW families takes place during a time of global uncertainty, and is aimed at supporting families with deep insights and thoughtful discussions on the issues facing their family wealth and businesses. The Global Families Network Forum provides an exclusive, closed-door platform for like-minded UHNW families to network, share their experiences and gain perspectives to guide their intergenerational wealth journeys.

New to this year's Forum is the specially curated Next Generation Programme, where participants got first-hand insights from leading Next Generation leaders and innovators and participated in a ventures workshop.

The mainstay of the two-day Forum were a welcome dinner (29 October) and a full-day conference (30 October). Attendees heard from an illustrious line-up of speakers of 15 nationalities, including Former Secretary of State for the United States, John Kerry, who spoke alongside Bill Winters, Standard Chartered's Group Chief Executive, in a fireside chat on "Building resilience amid volatility". His Excellency, Abdulla Bin Touq Al Marri, Cabinet Member & Minister of Economy and Tourism, and His Excellency Arif Amiri, Chief Executive Officer, DIFC Authority, delivered keynote addresses at the main conference and welcome dinner, respectively.

Other distinguished guest speakers over the two days include His Excellency Hadi Badri, CEO, Dubai Economic Development Corporation (DED); Dr Mary Ann Tsao, Chairwoman, Tsao Foundation, Singapore; Sabrina Fung, Group Managing Director, Fung Retailing Group; Muna Al Gurg, Vice Chairperson and Director of Retail, Al Gurg Group Founder, Meem Foundation; Shravin Mittal, Founder and CEO, Unbound; and Mohammed Abdullah Al Garafi, Founder and President, Syndicate Holding Group.

The UAE is a natural second stop for Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**'s Global Families Network Forum, following the inaugural event (Opens in a new window) in Hong Kong last year. As one of the world's leading financial centres, the UAE's stable and open economy, progressive regulations, diverse and cosmopolitan

population, and strategic connectivity across Asia, Africa and Europe makes it an ideal meeting point for global families and businesses.

As one of the four international wealth hubs in our global network along with Singapore, Hong Kong and Jersey, the UAE plays a crucial role in how the Bank serves its clients. It connects UHNW families to global business and investment opportunities, while helping to manage and grow cross-border wealth and shape legacy plans.

Raymond Ang, Global Head, **Private Bank** and Affluent Clients, and Head, Wealth and Retail Banking, Greater China and North Asia, Standard Chartered, said: "Managing family wealth is becoming increasingly complex amidst today's shifting paradigms. Our flagship Global Families Network Forum provides ultra-high-net-worth families with a trusted space to connect, share and learn, while our team of experts stand ready to support them in building resilient legacies that last for generations."

In conjunction with the Forum, the Bank this week also launched its research findings based on over 300 UHNW families and their **family office** professionals. "The Great Repositioning" provides insights to help families safeguard their wealth amidst the rapidly changing landscape. Read more here: [The Great Repositioning](#).

For further information please contact:

Khaled Abdulla, CFA®([Opens in a new window](#))

Head of Communications, United Arab Emirates

Clarissa Tee([Opens in a new window](#))

Wealth and Retail Banking Communications

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**

Standard Chartered is a leading international banking group with over 170 years of heritage and a presence in more than 50 of the world's most dynamic markets. Guided by its purpose of driving commerce and prosperity through unique diversity, the Group lives by its brand promise: Here for good.

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** is the Group's dedicated **private banking** arm, serving UHNW and HNW clients across key advisory centres – Hong Kong, Singapore, the United Arab Emirates, and the United Kingdom. It provides bespoke wealth solutions and a comprehensive suite of services tailored to clients' needs.

Offerings include access to a broad range of investment opportunities, wealth planning and family advisory, structured lending, corporate advisory, private market opportunities, and dedicated services for external asset managers and **family offices**.

Leveraging its deep-rooted franchise and international network, Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** connects clients to global opportunities, helping them grow, manage, and preserve their wealth for generations.

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 54 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

Source: Standard Chartered

[Category: Financial Results, Events]

Document ATINBK0020251104elb3000gx

HSBC taps Cathay United for new Taiwan wealth head

Cheryl Heng

238 words

31 October 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC has nabbed its new Taiwan head of international wealth and premier banking (IWPB) from Cathay United Bank.

Kevin Hu will take on the position and lead HSBC's IWPB business strategy in Taiwan effective 3 Nov, according to a statement from the bank.

HSBC has an ambitious aim of being the 'leading international **wealth manager** in the market', based on the 31 Oct release.

At Cathay United Bank, Hu has been senior executive vice president since 2022. Before that, Hu was at Citibank Taiwan for 26 years, latterly as retail banking head, where he oversaw **wealth management**, insurance and mortgage product lines.

Private banks have doubled down on their efforts in Taiwan of late amid the newly created **wealth management** zone in Kaohsiung. BNP Paribas **Wealth Management** has recruited Che-Kun Hsu from UBS as Taiwan **wealth management** head.

HSBC Taiwan's IWPB business achieved record performance in the first half of 2025, said Kai Zhang, head of IWPB Asia at HSBC.

'Taiwan plays an important role in achieving our goal to become the world's leading international **wealth manager**, particularly in Asia and the Middle East,' said Zhang, adding that the bank will invest in this priority market.

Adam Chen, CEO and head of banking at HSBC Taiwan, said Hu has a record of transforming a transactional banking business into a client-focused **wealth-management** business.

Document CWIRAS0020251031elav00001

Business

Wealth management boosts StanChart

Enoch Yiu

627 words

31 October 2025

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Standard Chartered's third-quarter net profit rose 10 per cent as strong growth in cross-border trade loans and **wealth management** buffered the bank from Hong Kong's commercial property slump and helped it beat analysts' estimates.

Net profit increased to US\$1.03 billion, or 44.5 US cents per share, in the quarter that ended in September, the London-based bank said in a filing to the Hong Kong stock exchange yesterday. The figure, based on global accounting rules, surpassed the US\$984 million expected by analysts.

Pre-tax profit rose 3 per cent to US\$1.77 billion, beating the analysts' consensus estimate.

"We now expect to deliver an underlying return on tangible equity of around 13 per cent in 2025, hitting our target a year earlier than planned," CEO Bill Winters said in the filing.

"Progress is broad-based, but our sharper strategic focus on servicing our clients' cross-border and affluent banking needs is paying off, with strong double-digit growth in wealth solutions and global banking, alongside good momentum in our global markets flow business."

Earnings growth at the bank, which generates most of its business from Asia, was partly offset by rising bad debt. The bank booked US\$195 million in credit impairments in the third quarter, 10 per cent higher than a year earlier.

This included a US\$25 million provision made for the Hong Kong commercial real estate sector to "capture the increased pressure on liquidity, interest serviceability and repayment capacity", the bank said.

The bank had kept US\$60 million in overlay for Hong Kong commercial real estate clients, the report said.

Chief financial officer Diego De Giorgi downplayed concerns about the local property market during a media briefing, saying that the increased provisions were "purely precautionary".

"Frankly, we do not see a particular worsening situation," he said. "Broadly speaking, Hong Kong is doing exceptionally well. Just witness the strengthening of the capital market in Hong Kong, which made it the world's largest [initial public offering market] in the first half of this year."

Its provisions for commercial real estate on the mainland fell by US\$9 million during the quarter due to repayments from clients, while it retained US\$49 million for the provisions.

The property slump in Hong Kong and the mainland had weighed on other banks' earnings. HSBC Holdings reported US\$1 billion in bad debt provisions in the third quarter on Tuesday, including US\$200 million that was related to the city's commercial real estate sector.

On a nine-month basis, the bank's reported pre-tax profit reached US\$6.15 billion, 20 per cent higher than a year earlier.

Standard Chartered's growth engine remained its wealth unit. The bank's third-quarter fee and other non-interest income rose 7 per cent from a year earlier to US\$3.7 billion, as the bank continued to roll out new products and opened more wealth centres in Hong Kong and the mainland to attract affluent clients.

Hong Kong, the bank's largest single market, reported an underlying pre-tax profit of US\$542 million in the third quarter, accounting for 27 per cent of the group's total and representing a 4.7 per cent decline from a year earlier.

"There are very strong capital flows in Hong Kong. The forecast is for Hong Kong to become the largest **wealth management** hub in the world," De Giorgi said, describing the bank's approach as very focused.

"Today, Hong Kong is certainly the fastest-growing in the world, followed by Singapore."

Standard Chartered's shares rose 4.3 per cent to HK\$159.50 at yesterday's close.

enoch.yiu@scmp.com

Document SCMP000020251030elav00013



Business

Ultra-rich families focus on driving impact 'across generations' in legacy planning

Aileen Chuang

766 words

30 October 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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Family offices at Standard Chartered forum in Dubai concerned with geopolitical instabilities, digital disruptions and social changes

Ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) families are putting greater focus on legacy planning to create sustainable impact for future generations amid growing uncertainty and [vast fortunes shifting](#) to younger heirs, according to participants in a Standard Chartered event in Dubai focused on **family offices**.

The emphasis among such families was changing from wealth preservation towards a strategic repositioning of **family-office** locations, governance structures, succession planning and decision-making, according to the London-headquartered bank. The Global Families Network Forum, which ended Thursday, was attended by 90 global UHNW families from Europe, the Middle East, Africa and Asia.

The event's host city in the United Arab Emirates – following the [inaugural event in Hong Kong](#) last year – is one of Standard Chartered's international [wealth](#) hubs and is known for its strategic location, open economy, progressive [regulations](#) and diverse population, the bank said in a press release.

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

"Managing family wealth is becoming increasingly complex amid today's shifting paradigms," said Raymond Ang, global head of private banking and affluent clients. He added that the forum was a "trusted space" for UHNW families to connect, share and learn.

The event's headline session was a fireside chat between John Kerry, former US secretary of state, and the bank's group CEO Bill Winters.

Other speakers included Sabrina Fung, group managing director of Hong Kong tycoon Victor Fung Kwok-king's Fung Retailing Group, and Mary Ann Tsao, chairwoman of Tsao Foundation, which mainly provides services for the elderly in Singapore.

"Any businessman cannot say that now that he has done it, he's leaving a business [as] the [only] legacy," Narendra Raval, group chairman of Devki Group of Companies, said on the sidelines of the forum. "Once you reach a certain level, you also think about giving back to society."

Raval said that was the "legacy we want to leave with our children, so they continue justifying and doing the right thing".

Devki Group is the largest private-sector employer in Kenya, producing construction materials including steel, cement, clinker and roofing sheets. Raval said his company aimed to employ 41,000 Africans by 2027, becoming the continent's single largest private-sector employer as part of his vision to support job creation.

He brought his children to the two-day forum, which featured a programme for next-generation members of UHNW families.

"Knowledge is more important for any legacy, for any successful business entity," he said. "That is what we are gaining from this kind of forum, where our children can learn, connect with other family members and listen to them."

The knowledge-sharing was useful to Victor Murthi, founder and CEO of Karya Hutan, which provides technology-driven solutions to promote sustainable forestry in Indonesia.

"I'm in a third-generation business, and by observing families in their seventh or eighth generation, we learn how they manage succession, handle differing passions among family members and ensure their vision continues across generations," he said.

Murthi, who also spoke at the event on driving long-term impact through business sustainability, said that people should dispel the misconception that sustainability was loss-making.

With the help of advanced technology and next-generation customers' growing focus on sustainability, some activities around the topic were profitable, he added. "The key is that if you are willing to do the initial investment properly, it can produce a very generous reward," he said.

According to a Standard Chartered survey of 300 global UHNW families and their advisers released on Monday, more than half were considering relocating their **family-office** locations, 87 per cent believed stronger succession planning could save their families millions, and 76 per cent were open to using artificial intelligence to support wealth decisions amid geopolitical instabilities, digital disruptions and social changes.

"The most sophisticated families are now strategically reviewing their entire wealth ecosystem: where it is housed, how it is governed and who makes decisions," said Ang, who is also Standard Chartered's head of wealth and retail banking for Greater China and North Asia, in the survey report. "This is not only about mitigating risk – it's about building resilience in an age of uncertainty," he said.

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Business

Standard Chartered's profit rises, beats estimates on trade loans, [wealth management](#)

Enoch Yiu

864 words

30 October 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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Net profit rose to US\$1.03 billion, or 44.5 US cents per share, in the quarter that ended in September, the London-based bank said in a filing

[Standard Chartered](#) 's third-quarter net profit rose 10 per cent, as strong growth in cross-border trade loans and [wealth management](#) buffered one of Hong Kong's three note-issuing banks from the city's [commercial property](#) slump and helped it beat analysts' estimates.

Net profit increased to US\$1.03 billion, or 44.5 US cents per share, in the quarter that ended in September, the London-based bank said in a filing to the [Hong Kong stock exchange](#) on Thursday. The result, based on global accounting rules, surpassed the US\$984 million expected by analysts.

Pre-tax profit rose 3 per cent to US\$1.77 billion, beating the analysts' consensus estimate, said the bank, which generates most of its business from Asia.

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"We now expect to deliver an underlying return on tangible equity of around 13 per cent in 2025, hitting our target a year earlier than planned," Standard Chartered's CEO [Bill Winters](#) said in the exchange filing.

"Progress is broad-based, but our sharper strategic focus on servicing our clients' cross-border and affluent banking needs is paying off, with strong double-digit growth in wealth solutions and global banking, alongside good momentum in our global markets flow business."

The bank's earnings growth was partly offset by rising bad debt. The bank booked US\$195 million in credit impairments in the third quarter, 10 per cent higher than a year earlier.

This included a US\$25 million provision made for the Hong Kong commercial real estate sector to "capture the increased pressure on liquidity, interest serviceability and repayment capacity," the bank said.

The bank has kept US\$60 million in overlay for Hong Kong commercial real estate clients, the report said.

Standard Chartered chief financial officer Diego De Giorgi downplayed concerns about the Hong Kong property market during a media briefing, saying that the increased provisions were "purely precautionary".

"Frankly, we do not see a particular worsening situation," he said. "Broadly speaking, Hong Kong is doing exceptionally well. Just witness the strengthening of the capital market in Hong Kong, which made it the world's largest [initial public offering market] in the first half of this year."

Its provision made for mainland China's commercial real estate fell US\$9 million during the quarter due to repayments from clients, while the bank retained US\$49 million for the mainland commercial real estate.

The property slump in Hong Kong and the mainland had weighed on banks' earnings. [HSBC Holdings](#) reported [US\\$1 billion in bad debt provisions](#) in the third quarter on Tuesday, including US\$200 million that was related to Hong Kong's commercial real estate sector.

Standard Chartered's shares rose 4.3 per cent to HK\$159.5 at Thursday's close after the release of the bank's earnings report.

On a nine-month basis, the bank's reported pre-tax profit reached US\$6.15 billion, 20 per cent higher than a year earlier.

Standard Chartered's growth engine remained its wealth unit. The bank's third-quarter fee and other non-interest income rose 7 per cent from a year earlier to US\$3.7 billion, as the bank continued to roll out new products and opened more wealth centres in Hong Kong and mainland China to attract affluent clients.

Hong Kong, the bank's largest single market, reported an underlying pre-tax profit of US\$542 million in the third quarter, accounting for 27 per cent of the group's total and representing a 4.7 percent decline from a year earlier.

"We are very focused and very purposeful, pushing towards an increased presence in **wealth management** in Hong Kong and elsewhere in our footprint," De Giorgi said.

"There are very strong capital flows in Hong Kong. The forecast is for Hong Kong to become the largest **wealth management** hub in the world," he said. "Today, Hong Kong is certainly the fastest-growing in the world, followed by Singapore."

The lender booked more fee income than interest income in the third quarter, continuing the trend started in the second quarter, which is the goal of the bank to cut down reliance on interest income, which is more fluctuating than stable fee income.

A lower interest rate, with the [US Federal Reserve](#) cutting the key rate by 25 basis points on Thursday after a previous cut at the same margin in September, has led net interest income down 5 per cent to US\$1.4 billion in the quarter.

Winters told the Post that Hong Kong would be the focus of Standard Chartered's [US\\$1.5 billion investment in its wealth management business](#) over the next five years.

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Companies

HSBC launches 'entrepreneurial wealth proposition' in Singapore

Shikhar Gupta

282 words

25 October 2025

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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HSBC on Friday (Oct 24) announced the launch of an "enhanced entrepreneurial wealth proposition" in Singapore, aiming to provide "dedicated support" for entrepreneurs. This follows the lender's Global Entrepreneurial Wealth Report 2025 released in September, in which 15 per cent of entrepreneurs cited Singapore as the top destination for their wealth. The Republic was also ranked the No 1 destination for personal relocation by 12 per cent of respondents.

"Currently, close to two-thirds of our global **private banking** clients in Singapore are entrepreneurs," said Tommy Leung, HSBC's head of global **private banking**.

In a press release, the lender said the new proposition combines its capabilities in global **private banking** and corporate banking.

The proposition includes private wealth entrepreneur incubation, intended for "existing corporate clients who have yet to onboard with the **private bank**". It will offer "early access to tailored wealth planning, investment events and a global network of industry experts", HSBC said.

Educational and advisory sessions will also be offered to guide founders through pre-exit, initial public offerings and succession planning.

In addition, HSBC will introduce an "innovation exchange" -- which has already been launched in Hong Kong and the United Kingdom -- to connect **private bank** clients with "cutting-edge entrepreneurs and ventures" across Asia.

The bank's September report also said that Singapore attracted the largest inflows of wealth from its neighbours, especially Indonesia and Malaysia.

"We're seeing more entrepreneurs across Asia looking beyond growth to legacy -- how to transition their success to the next generation," said Leung. "Singapore's international platform, and depth and breadth of expertise, make it a natural hub for that next chapter."

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Standard Chartered hires ex-DBS investment advisor in Dubai

Paromita Dey

190 words

22 October 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered **Private Bank** has appointed Dhaval Mehta as executive director for investment advisory, based in the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC).

Mehta joins from Singapore-headquartered DBS **Private Bank**, where he spent eight years as a senior investment advisor in Dubai.

In his new role, he will focus on delivering multi-asset investment advisory services to the bank's **private banking** clients, while working closely with relationship managers to provide holistic and tailored wealth solutions.

He will report to Rohit Sharma, head of investment advisory, at the **private bank**.

With over 20 years of experience across India, Singapore, and the UAE, Mehta has also held senior roles at Citi and HSBC.

The appointment follows a series of senior hires at Standard Chartered **Private Bank**. In September, Ali Raza [joined](#) as cluster head for the Middle East and Africa, based in Dubai, with a mandate to expand the bank's GCC team.

Earlier this year, the British lender also [launched](#) its first 'Priority Private' centre in the Middle East, Europe, and Africa (Mena) region, dedicated to serving high-net-worth clients.

Document CWIRME0020251022elam00004

Banking

DBS' goal is to be a universal bank with SME & retail focus: CEO Rajat Verma

Joel Rebello and Sangita Mehta

912 words

22 October 2025

The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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Five years after taking over the troubled Lakshmi Vilas Bank, Singapore's banking major DBS has built a strong base for steady growth in India, CEO Rajat Verma said. The bank's net profit increased 81% year on year to Rs 684 crore in FY25. Verma told Joel Rebello and Sangita Mehta that DBS would step up its retail and SME banking over the next few years, as these two segments would ultimately dominate its loan book, underpinned by growth prospects in gold loans and mortgages. Edited excerpts: The banking sector is buzzing with lots of changes. RBI has also announced a slew of reforms. What are DBS' plans amid all this? Our goal is to be a universal bank. We have a decent corporate bank as we work with the large companies. We have also started working a lot with medium size companies and we are committed to lending to that space. Our SME book has crossed Rs 10,000 crore and will grow at 40% CAGR so that we are closer to a Rs 13,000 crore book by FY26.

It is an area where we have put in a lot of effort and our ambitions here are broader and bigger starting from funding micro enterprises with annual turnover of about Rs 5 crore going up to Rs 600 crore. We have also seen a benign credit environment which gives us confidence to underwrite credit. How does the DBS India loan book look like currently? Our loan book is around Rs 60,000 crore and about one-fourth will be SME. Retail and SME books are about the same and the corporate book is about 58%. In retail lending we are keen to invest and expand the business. We have got the team and the models in place, but a lot of work is ongoing. We expect retail and SME books to eventually become more than 50% of our loan book in India. In retail there is a lot of scope in Consumer Loans Against Property (CLAP), which is adjacent to the SME business, where we have had success, hence, we are quite bullish. We are very bullish on the gold loans business, not only for DBS Bank India, but even as an industry as the potential is massive. It is an essential product for this country, given the amount of gold in Indian households, an underutilised asset. There is a large potential to unlock credit with gold loans given the size of the market and acceptability of the product. Both these products are scalable and can spur entrepreneurship at the ground level and have lower default rates. What are your plans on corporate loans? Corporate loans are about 58%, which includes trade finance, project finance and even real estate. In the past, we have said that retail and SME will be 25% each and corporate will be about 50% of the book. Our goal is much more, in terms of retail and SME because I think it is possible to do it in a risk-adjusted, return-adjusted manner. Which means the corporate will not be at 50, it will be lower than that and not be as high as it is today. As markets evolve, corporates have other alternatives (to raise money) such as insurance companies. Therefore, corporate books will grow. But the other parts will grow faster. What about the other parts of business-like **wealth management**? We have a **wealth management** product called Treasures. We are thinking of ways to strengthen that proposition. We are working on how to do more business with non-resident Indians and also wealthy Indians. International connectivity is going to be one of our themes — we have the ability to create products at a global level which can be replicated for India. In **wealth management**, we are a leading institutional player in Asia. We can create suitable products (for customers). It is also helpful in getting low cost deposits. Corporate banking has always been there. Any new products or initiatives there? We continue to invest in our corporate banking business. We are ranked third in India's league table in 2025 in terms of volume. We are also setting up a specialised team to bank the start-ups in Bengaluru. This is a slightly different type of business because we cannot look at the standard parameters for lending. We call it the Digital Economy Group (DEG) internally. We will expand to other cities as well. These companies need different kinds of services like support in setting up an overseas office — say in Singapore. So our services are not just to do with lending. Many banks with deep pockets like Emirates NBD, SMFG have doubled down investments in India. How do you see competition panning out? And how will you stay ahead? India is one of our six core markets in DBS globally and very important for us. It is a really large market with many pockets of opportunity. We have invested a lot of capital and we have many pockets to productively use that capital. Some of the structural things that have happened in India are not an accident like coming to under 2% of gross NPAs. The whole transparency, the rigor around it, the credit bureaus, is not an accident. Structurally one feels very comfortable.

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Business Times Breaking News

Companies & Markets

In a world of AI, UOB's future playbook begins with its people

Evan See

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The bank hopes to develop rather than displace jobs as it upskills its workforce across South-east Asia

[SINGAPORE] Ivan Aw's first three months in his new role at UOB **Private Bank** were, in his own words, a "bruising" experience.

After spending more than a decade in personal financial services at UOB, he felt like he was starting from scratch, having stepped into the world of **private banking** and swapping familiar playbooks for a role with new jargon, ultra-high-net-worth clients and bespoke products.

"Growth often starts with discomfort," recalled Aw, now vice-president of segment insights and digital engagement at UOB **Private Bank**. "What matters is your willingness to learn and adapt."

This challenge was not simply a leap of faith; it was one well-supported by structured learning and mentorship. As part of UOB's Better U Pivot Programme, Aw was able to undergo an on-the-job training plan with weekly learning objectives, while easing into the role with micro-projects.

The 12-month structured programme was designed to help employees of the bank reskill and transition into other roles within the organisation.

What Aw found particularly helpful were the weekly coaching sessions that the programme afforded him.

"These sessions provided a safe space for open conversations about areas I could upskill in," he said.

"Through those discussions, I was guided to courses that helped me build confidence and grow faster in my new role."

Launched in October 2024, the Pivot Programme aims to reskill up to 500 UOB employees across the bank's Singapore and Malaysia workforce over two years.

This initiative builds on the foundations of the bank's wider Better U Programme, which was first launched in 2019 and has helped more than 26,000 employees enhance their skill sets across various banking and critical skill areas – including the use of artificial intelligence (AI).

The Better U Programme extends across UOB's international presence in eight South-east Asian countries, and other parts of Asia including China, India, Japan and South Korea.

But as many in the banking sector have come to realise, learning to combine emerging digital tools such as AI with human skills has become crucial to defining the modern workforce.

Dean Tong, UOB's head of group human resources, said: "In the financial services space, we're seeing constant changes – new regulations, emerging technologies and macroeconomic volatility – all of which require organisations to respond quickly."

For many employees, the choice is between learning to incorporate AI into their daily tasks, or risking replacement altogether.

UOB is keenly aware of these threats. “The challenge is to use AI to complement and augment human capabilities rather than displace jobs,” said Tong. “This requires upskilling and redesigning roles to ensure no employee gets left behind,” he added.

This vision was on full display at UOB’s Better U Festival on Oct 1, where the bank announced the launch of an organisation-wide AI upskilling programme. Under the new initiative, all employees will be equipped with foundational generative AI and productivity-boosting automation skills.

The new initiative will complement the Better U Pivot Programme. The bank said it will also develop talent to take on advanced digital roles, or serve as “innovation champions” who will drive adoption of generative AI into business processes throughout the organisation.

During the festival, UOB signed a memorandum of understanding with three learning institutes to enhance its efforts to upskill its employees.

A partnership with the Institute of Banking and Finance Singapore will focus on developing industry-accredited training programmes in areas such as generative AI and data fluency, the bank said.

UOB will also work with Workforce Singapore to redesign jobs most impacted by technological changes, in order to support the reskilling of affected employees.

Meanwhile, a collaboration with Ngee Ann Polytechnic will enhance these learning processes by introducing behavioural prompts and measuring their effectiveness.

Aw said that incorporating generative AI tools into his transition journey helped him gain confidence as he approached an unfamiliar work environment.

“These tools helped me bridge knowledge gaps quickly, whether it was summarising complex financial concepts, brainstorming campaign ideas or making sense of data,” he told The Business Times. “It didn’t replace the need to learn, but it definitely made the process faster and less overwhelming.”

Accelerating leadership growth

Beyond developing its employees across different banking skill sets, UOB has also prioritised developing effective leaders across its local and regional operations.

The bank has helped high performing individuals to develop their leadership potential and skills through its Leadership Acceleration Programme (LAP). Tong explained that the initiative was designed to provide strong performers with development opportunities through leadership coaching, job rotations and strategic project assignments.

Kacha Chotchaisatit is one such individual. Currently head of portfolio management and models for business banking at UOB Thailand, Kacha was selected to join the LAP in 2020 after going through a rigorous selection process.

Like Aw, Kacha’s growth as a leader required him to learn about new areas of the banking business. Despite being a domain expert in data-driven strategy, Kacha found his rotations into areas such as credit and risk management to be “humbling”.

But he believes they also transformed him into a better leader. “I no longer lead solely by providing answers,” he said. “Instead, I focus on setting the strategic direction and empowering my team to develop solutions themselves.”

Through initiatives such as the LAP and UOB’s Better Leader Programme, Tong noted that managers across UOB are developed to help their teams achieve growth.

Tong said these programmes “equip managers to lead authentically and effectively, promote psychological safety and build high-performing teams”.

He noted that UOB aspires for leaders such as Kacha to embody the “UOB way”: a people philosophy built on care, growth and trust, where employees are encouraged to take ownership of their work, as well as professional development.

But where generative AI is concerned, Tong acknowledged that risks remain as employees learn to incorporate new skills into their work.

"We are cognisant of the risk of an overreliance on generative AI, resulting in cognitive offloading. It is important for us to create a balance and ensure our people are also reskilled in critical thinking," he said.

"We need to equip employees to use AI effectively and responsibly."

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Front Page Business

Legacy planning is no longer just for the wealthy or elderly: DBS wealth head

Sheila Chiang

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STIMES

English

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Asia, seen as a safe haven amid geopolitical tensions, is drawing wealth into the region even as its people are becoming more affluent, and a good chunk of it is landing in the wealth hub of Singapore.

The rich and newly rich are turning their attention to preserving and passing on their riches and assets to future generations, and this is prompting a growing demand for legacy planning services from their **wealth managers**.

One hallmark of the trend for DBS Bank is that this demand cuts across retail and **private banking**, with its clients across all ages prioritising legacy planning and protection.

It is also spurring change in how South-east Asia's largest bank is grooming its **wealth managers** and designing investment products and strategies to serve the new generation, DBS group head of consumer banking and **wealth management** Shee Tse Koon told The Straits Times.

He cited an example of a high-net-worth client in his 30s who made a fortune in crypto trading. When he became a father, he started engaging with the bank's wealth advisers to do legacy planning.

DBS helped structure a trust for him and the man placed his digital assets under the trust.

"We see the older generation trying to think about transitioning their wealth. We also see some of these young people, as they progress through life, starting to think about legacy planning. Part and parcel of this legacy planning also leverages insurance solutions," Mr Shee said.

Legacy planning and protection refers to the process of organising how one's wealth, assets and values will be preserved, managed and passed on to future generations or beneficiaries. Insurance solutions involve life insurance or long-term care insurance to protect wealth.

"If you look at the whole **wealth management** space, there are clearly young people getting engaged much earlier on in the journey of investments and financial planning," he noted.

This can be attributed to the advent of technology, which has made access to knowledge easier, as well as to the younger generation's greater financial literacy compared to previous generations.

"Increasingly, we are seeing the ability for... both investments and insurance to come together to stitch a whole value proposition," he added.

Customers progress along the entire continuum of wealth, from as little as \$1,000, said Mr Shee, adding that many begin their journey with digital financial planning tools and self-directed trading.

"We see a whole wealth continuum being built out in this part of the world. We have clients who would have their first \$1,000 to invest, right through to their first \$100,000 and right through to their first million," he said.

Customers who moved from the retail segment to the affluent segment more than doubled year on year. Among them, more than half qualified as accredited investors -- those with net personal assets exceeding \$2 million, among other criteria.

To date, up to 40 per cent of new **private banking** clients have come from the bank's existing base of clients who moved up the wealth ladder.

The number of high-net-worth individuals in Asia-Pacific is projected to have grown 5 per cent year on year to 855,000 in 2024, according to Julius Baer.

As customers get more and more wealthy, they would need access to more holistic advice and more sophisticated products, Mr Shee said.

That is why DBS is combining trading and advisory capabilities, serving clients through digital platforms for them to tap self-directed investing and advice and relationship managers to provide more complex advisory services.

"Whether it's your first \$1,000, first \$100,000 or first million, even with billionaires, through this entire wealth continuum, we serve them through the phygital model -- a blend of physical and digital. Certain capabilities, products and services are easier to be done digitally, but as you progress through the continuum, some of them do need their physical interaction."

Relationship managers in **private banking** are expanding their focus beyond personal wealth to meet clients' business needs, including mergers and acquisitions and initial public offerings.

"We have been able to structure deals. We have been able to bring advice to them that is beyond just their investments, but also how to better use the assets they have in their businesses."

Customers are also getting more knowledgeable about diversifying their portfolios and tapping private assets, Mr Shee said, noting that clients' assets under management (AUM) in private assets jumped nearly fivefold over the past five years.

Such private assets include private credit, private equity, infrastructure, hedge funds, and digital assets.

There has been a bigger appetite for digital assets among the high-net-worth and the ultra-high-net-worth. Since 2023, the number of clients in these two segments investing in digital assets via DBS' digital exchange has grown nearly 40 per cent, with active traders almost tripling, and trading volumes soaring more than fourfold.

The bank is also seeing demand from high-net-worth individuals, particularly among those in their 30s to 40s, for ESG investing for social and environmental impact.

By integrating MSCI ESG ratings into its product suite, DBS gives clients the option of incorporating ESG (environmental, social and governance) as an input in their investment process.

As at June 2025, over 60 per cent of its clients' investment assets comprise "sustainable investments", defined as those rated BBB and above -- average to strong performers in managing ESG risks and opportunities -- based on MSCI's ESG Ratings.

DBS has also expanded its product offerings in this space, including climate thematic investment products and impact investing opportunities.

Mr Shee highlighted that the Asia boom is enabled by two mega trends -- the creation of wealth in Asia and the rapid shift of wealth to Asia.

"In Asia today, there has been a very rapid creation of wealth. We always read about the emerging middle class, but it's more than that. It's actually the entire business environment. New businesses are being set up, being listed," he said.

"And we have seen billionaires, multi-generational wealth being transitioned. We have also seen new wealth being created with new entrepreneurs, new start-ups, listings either in this part of the world or the US."

Business owners or entrepreneurs make up 70 per cent of DBS' wealthy clients. DBS also banks more than one-third of the single-family offices established in Singapore, and its family office AUM more than doubled in the last two years.

There has also been a rapid shift of wealth to the region, given geopolitical tensions and Asia being seen as a safe haven, he added.

At the centre of the wealth boom in Asia are the two key markets where DBS is operating -- Singapore and Hong Kong. In 2024, Singapore and Hong Kong saw very robust AUM growth, he said.

Citing a Boston Consulting Group report, he noted that the Asia-Pacific is projected to surpass Switzerland as the world's leading wealth centre by 2029.

The Asia-Pacific is forecast to lead global financial wealth expansion, with a growth forecast of about 9 per cent annually through 2029 -- outpacing growth in North America and Western Europe.

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Business

1MDB liquidators lose bid in S'pore court to sue StanChart, BSI

554 words

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The Straits Times

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English

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The High Court has prevented foreign liquidators from suing Standard Chartered Bank and BSI Bank over transactions allegedly linked to the 1Malaysia Development Berhad (1MDB) scandal, ruling that Singapore's cross-border insolvency framework cannot be applied to deals executed before the law took effect in 2018.

The liquidators of Blackstone Asia Real Estate Partners and Brazen Sky, two companies embroiled in the multibillion-dollar 1MDB affair, had sought to bring avoidance claims -- a legal mechanism allowing liquidators to reverse suspect transactions and recover assets improperly transferred from creditors -- against the banks in Singapore.

The applications are part of wider international efforts to recoup assets lost in one of the world's largest financial scandals.

Justice Aidan Xu dismissed both applications, citing Article 23(9) of the Insolvency, Restructuring and Dissolution Act, which enacted the Model Law on Cross-Border Insolvency in Singapore.

This provision, unique to the Republic and not found in the United Nations Commission on International Trade Law framework, explicitly bars foreign liquidators from challenging transactions entered into before the legislation came into force.

Justice Xu acknowledged that the ruling leaves the liquidators with limited recourse despite what he described as "apparently dubious transactions". He noted that while workarounds may exist, these would entail additional expense and time.

The judge recognised his decision could appear at odds with Singapore's broader commitment to facilitating cross-border insolvency cooperation. But, he noted the Parliament had deliberately included the 2018 cut-off when enacting Model Law. "That is the law here in Singapore. The court must give effect to what that law lays down," he said.

The case turned on competing interpretations of Singapore's Model Law provisions.

The liquidators argued that the courts have wide powers under Article 21 of the Model Law to give "additional relief" to foreign liquidators, including permission to sue over past fraudulent transactions. Without such permission, they said, wrongdoers could escape responsibility simply because of timing, and foreign liquidators would be forced to start entirely new proceedings in Singapore, wasting time and money.

The banks relied on Article 23(9) of the Singapore Model Law. This provision clearly says that foreign liquidators cannot sue over transactions entered into before the law took effect.

This was a deliberate choice by Parliament, the banks argued, meant to avoid changing the legal status of past actions after the fact. Academic commentary also supports this view, noting that Article 23(9) was intended to protect parties' expectations and prevent disruption of transactions completed before the law came into effect.

Justice Xu agreed with the banks. He ruled that the plain wording of Article 23(9) bars foreign liquidators from suing over pre-commencement transactions, and that the broad powers under Article 21 cannot override this restriction. While this may limit the ability of foreign liquidators to recover assets linked to the 1MDB scandal, any change must come from Parliament, not the courts, he added.

The liquidators may still pursue claims through traditional court proceedings in Singapore, though such routes lack the streamlined mechanisms available under the cross-border insolvency regime.

In the case of Brazen Sky, separate proceedings are already under way against BSI and certain bankers for claims of dishonest assistance arising from the same transactions. THE BUSINESS TIMES

Document STIMES0020251001ela20026x

HSBC nabs two Indonesia bankers from UBS in Asia hiring spree

James Philipps

355 words

1 October 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** has bolstered its Southeast Asia frontline staff, hiring two Indonesian bankers from UBS, among six new recruits in Singapore.

Edy Panggabean joins as senior relationship manager and cluster head for Indonesia, reporting to HSBC's Indonesia desk head Urban Binggeli. Panggabean previously focused on ultra-high net worth clients and family offices at UBS Global Wealth Management.

Xilin Yeo has made the switch alongside Panggabean, also joining UBS, but as a relationship manager.

Elsewhere, Kraisit Buakruen has been recruited as a Singapore-based relationship manager focused on the Thailand market. Buakruen, who was previously at Kasikornbank in Bangkok, reports to Benjamin Wang, desk head for Thailand and Vietnam.

Fiona Gan, another UBS GWM banker, has been brought in as a Greater China relationship manager, reporting to Catherine Claire Lim, desk head for China and Hong Kong.

Shobana Vaidhyanathan and Sangeet Batra have also been added to the global India team in Singapore as relationship managers.

Vaidhyanathan was most recently at Citi **Private Bank** and has worked in both Singapore and India, while Batra was previously at \$2bn hedge fund Southern Ridges Capital.

Additionally, HSBC has announced a flurry of appointments in its client lifecycle management (CLM) teams in the region.

Tommy Leung, head of global **private banking**, South Asia, HSBC, said: 'This is about positioning HSBC for the next three to five years – building a strong bench of relationship managers, alongside a resilient second line of defence – so that our growth is both sustainable and safe.'

Clarence Arokiasamy has been named regional head of CLM, GPB, based in Hong Kong. A nine-year HSBC veteran, he was credited with enhancing due diligence globally at the bank.

Souvik Bera joins from UBS as regional head of client due diligence advisory, GPB and Mingying Chen, most recently at Credit Suisse, has been appointed regional CDD quality assurance team lead. Both join later in the month.

Samm Zhuo becomes Singapore head of CLM from 15 October and Liam Gormley is set to join as senior business financial crime risk manager, Asia GPB & WPS.

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This Unexpected Company Just Achieved a Quantum Computing Milestone. Should You Buy Its Shares Here?

Aditya Raghunath
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English

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HSBC Holdings([HSBC](#)) has delivered the world's first empirical evidence that current quantum computers can solve real-world algorithmic trading problems. This event marked a [significant breakthrough](#) for the banking giant's technological capabilities.

Working alongside IBM([IBM](#)), Europe's largest lender achieved a 34% improvement in predicting bond trade execution probability compared to traditional classical computing methods.

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The quantum-enhanced system successfully optimized corporate bond trading in over-the-counter (OTC) markets, where complex algorithms must rapidly process real-time market conditions and risk estimates to inform trading decisions.

HSBC demonstrated superior performance in analyzing pricing signals within noisy market data for European corporate bond transactions. This was done using IBM's Heron quantum processor integrated with classical computing workflows.

Philip Intallura, HSBC's Group Head of Quantum Technologies, emphasized it represents tangible evidence of quantum computing's competitive advantages at production scale. The breakthrough positions HSBC ahead of competitors in adopting next-generation computing for financial services applications.

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The Bull Case for HSBC

HSBC continues to execute its strategic transformation under the leadership of CEO George Quinn. In the first half of 2025, HSBC delivered an impressive 18% return on tangible equity, with all four priority businesses achieving mid-teens returns while generating consistent revenue growth.

CFO Pam Kaur outlined the bank's dual-track approach to value creation, which involves \$1.5 billion in cost savings from [organizational simplification](#) and an additional \$1.5 billion from strategic exits and portfolio optimization. The cost reduction program is ahead of schedule, with \$400 million flowing to the bottom line by year-end, above the initially projected \$300 million.

Wealth Management emerged as a [standout performer](#) as sales rose by 22% due to strong inflows from Hong Kong, a region that added 100,000 new customers each month. The bank added \$75 billion in net new invested assets and maintained its dominant deposit franchise with \$83 billion in annual growth.

Despite challenging conditions in Hong Kong's commercial real estate, HSBC maintains comfortable capital levels. It ended the quarter with a CET1 ratio of 14% while deploying capital towards buybacks and dividends. It announced a \$3 billion share buyback and paid a \$0.10 dividend per share. Total cash returned to shareholders hit \$9.5 billion for the half-year.

Management's disciplined approach to acquisitions and focus on organic growth in **wealth management** and wholesale transaction banking positions HSBC well for sustained outperformance.

HSBC posted solid second-quarter results, despite the decline in Hong Kong interest rates. Revenue in Q2 climbed 5% to \$17.7 billion, while fee income from transaction banking and **wealth management** drove most of the growth.

The bank maintained its full-year net interest income target of approximately \$42 billion. Deposit growth and hedging strategies helped offset the impact from lower Hong Kong rates. Furthermore, management anticipates that rates will rebound above 2% in the third quarter.

However, Hong Kong's commercial real estate segment continued to struggle. The bank has raised its credit loss forecast to 40 basis points for the year, up from the previously expected range of 30-40 basis points. About \$1.4 billion in troubled loans have debt-to-value ratios above 70%, and HSBC has already set aside \$500 million to cover potential losses.

Customer deposits jumped \$83 billion over the past year, and the wealth division generated \$75 billion in new invested assets.

What Is the Price Target for HSBC Stock?

Analysts tracking HSBC stock forecast revenue to rise from \$67.4 billion in 2025 to \$72.6 billion in 2028. In this period, adjusted earnings are forecast to expand from \$1.38 per share to \$1.63 per share.

Today, HSBC stock is priced at 9.9 times forward earnings, which is below its 10-year average of 10.1 times. If HSBC is priced at 10 times earnings, it could gain over 12% from current levels.

Out of the 14 analysts covering HSBC stock, six recommend "Strong Buy," two recommend "Moderate Buy," and six recommend "Hold." The average HSBC stock price target is \$68, just below the current price of \$70.

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On the date of publication, [Aditya Raghunath](#) did not have (either directly or indirectly) positions in any of the securities mentioned in this article. All information and data in this article is solely for informational purposes. For more information please view the Barchart Disclosure Policy [here](#).

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Document BARC000020250930e19t000jo

Former Julius Baer team head resurfaces at UOB Private Bank

Priyanka Boghani

152 words

26 September 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A former Julius Baer team head has joined UOB Private Bank in a similar capacity.

Luke Hui is now team head for the Singapore market at the Singaporean private bank, according to his latest LinkedIn update.

Hui was previously at Julius Baer for over two years as a team head. Prior to that, he worked at Credit Suisse.

In March, the Swiss private bank underwent a restructure that removed management layers across the globe, including in Hong Kong and Singapore. Team leader roles, in particular, were affected, according to the plans of chief executive Stefan Bollinger, as the bank looked to consolidate teams under group heads.

Meanwhile, UOB Private Bank has recently hired a former China Merchant Bank assistant general manager, Luke Luo, to cover the China market.

The bank has an AUM target is S\$145bn (\$110bn) by 2026.

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Exclusive: Former CMB assistant GM to join UOB Private Bank

Priyanka Boghani

163 words

26 September 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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UOB Private Bank has hired the former assistant general manager at China Merchant Bank (CMB) to cover the China market, Citywire Asia understands.

Luke Luo has joined the Singaporean private bank as deputy market head for the China market, multiple sources close to the matter have said.

UOB Private Bank declined to comment on the hire.

Luo was at the Chinese private bank for over eight years, based in Singapore. Prior to that, he spent more than three years at Goldman Sachs as an assistant and analyst in Singapore and Hong Kong, according to his LinkedIn profile.

UOB's head of private wealth Chew Mun Yew had told Citywire Asia in an earlier interview that UOB PB is not dependent on hiring relationship managers to bring in new money, expecting asset growth to come from existing customers of the wider group. The bank's AUM target is S\$145bn (\$110bn) by 2026.

Document CWIRAS0020250926e19q00003

Business

Standard Chartered Bank doesn't want single-product customers: CEO

FE Bureau

821 words

26 September 2025

Financial Express

AIWFIE

English

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Standard Chartered Bank is rewriting its India strategy, with a clear focus on cross-border banking, wealth management and multi-product retail relationships, as it targets double-digit corporate growth and deeper integration into India's evolving financial ecosystem.

Driving cross-border growth

"Indian corporates have been waiting for right valuations to go offshore. With more sensible pricing now, we are seeing outbound M&A activity pick up," said PD Singh, CEO, India & South Asia at Standard Chartered Bank, citing the bank's advisory role in seven landmark M&A deals worth \$6 billion in H1FY26, including Titan's acquisition of Damas Jewellery in the West Asia. The bank is also investing in corridor-native strategies, helping clients move into new geographies with regulatory and banking support. "I have coined the term corridor natives; companies expanding into new markets need deep advisory, and that's where we step in," Singh said.

ALSO READAmit Shah to be Chief Guest at FE Best Banks Awards today

India's wealth boom is central to Standard Chartered's global ambitions. Singh confirmed that India will play an important part in the bank's target of \$200 billion in net new money globally by 2029. "We are hiring wealth managers, but it's not just about headcount, it's about cultural fit and long-term engagement," he said. The bank is building priority centres within branches, with seven already live this year, and plans to take the count to 21 by year-end.

On the retail front, Standard Chartered is doubling down on multi-product relationships. "We don't want single-product customers. The ideal client has a home loan, credit card, savings account, and we bank them personally and professionally," said Singh.

The bank's SME strategy is tightly integrated with its private banking arm, with 70% of private clients being business owners. Branch upgrades are underway, but Singh stressed that digitisation is reducing the need for physical expansion. "We have opened large-format branches in Chennai and Kolkata, but 95% of payments and 92% of corporate transactions are already digitised."

ALSO READGST 2.0: Credit card spends up fivefold in 3 days

Doubling down on corporate finance

Standard Chartered expects a 10% growth in its rupee corporate loan book in FY26, driven by syndicated facilities, private finance, and project lending. "We have participated in 38–40% of syndicated deals this year. Corporates are demanding blended finance and equity-alternative structures, and we are connecting those dots," he adds. The bank is active in infrastructure finance, supporting electric vehicle (EV) buses, solar and wind projects, and green mobility. "For a foreign bank to do project finance in India is rare. We are doing it because we believe in the India story," Singh added.

Rupee invoicing is gaining traction, but slowly. "We have seen some shift in renewable energy imports from China. The time for rupee invoicing is coming, especially in bilateral corridors," Singh said, predicting the West Asia as a likely growth zone.

Meanwhile, he flagged broader tariff tensions as a factor in cross-border strategy. "We are seeing clients hedge against tariff risk by diversifying supply chains and exploring rupee invoicing," he said. Standard Chartered's corridor-native approach supporting clients as they expand into new geographies is gaining traction amid these

shifts. "Whether it's M&A, trade finance, or custody, our role is to help clients navigate complexity. Tariffs and regulatory shifts are part of that equation," adds Singh. The bank is also preparing to launch dollar clearing in GIFT City on October 7, in partnership with CCIL. "This will localise dollar settlements and reduce dependency on US clearing hours," Singh confirmed.

On the H1B visa front, Singh was cautious. "It's too early to assess the impact, but we are watching closely, especially with the HIRE (Halting International Relocation of Employment) Act coming in," he said, adding that "Our GCC clients are already evaluating operational models, and we are advising them on risk mitigation and corridor diversification." Standard Chartered banks five to seven new GCCs monthly and operates its own centres in Chennai and Bengaluru with 24,000 employees. "It's no longer a cost play; it's a skills play. India has the talent, and that's where growth will happen," Singh stated.

Singh linked capex to sustained consumption. "If the consumption spike holds, capex will follow. We are already seeing investment in steel, cement, and allied sectors," he said. On AI, he noted productivity gains in transaction monitoring and relation manager (RM) support but dismissed fears of job displacement.

With a 170-year legacy in India, Standard Chartered is positioning itself not just as a bank, but as a strategic partner in India's next phase of growth. "We are building for the next century, not the next quarter," Singh said.

[Standard Chartered's India Strategy.](#)

Document AIWFIE0020250926e19q0000h

COMPANIES & MARKETS

DBS aims for S\$2b in multi-family office assets under management

Genevieve Cua

548 words

24 September 2025

Business Times Singapore

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DBS Private Bank's multi-family office (MFO) service has attracted S\$1 billion in assets under management (AUM) from more than 25 ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) families in two years since its launch in 2023.

Lee Woon Shiu, DBS Private Bank group head of wealth planning, family office and insurance solutions, is confident AUM under the DBS Multi Family Office Foundry VCC would hit S\$2 billion by next year.

"It's very promising, because the pipeline is there... We've seen a lot of traction in many markets we travel to. Many people have heard of VCC (variable capital company) in Singapore and want to understand more."

In a statement, DBS said some families who have signed on were originally considering a single family office (SFO) but were persuaded by cost optimisation, manpower benefits and ease of administration which DBS MFO offers.

The cost of establishing and running SFOs in Singapore has risen since regulations were tightened in 2023, following a high-profile money laundering case involving S\$3 billion in assets. In addition to broader due diligence checks, the processing time for tax incentives under the Monetary Authority of Singapore has also lengthened. All that is in addition to rising overhead costs, and the challenge of hiring qualified investment professionals.

DBS MFO claims to be the world's first bank-backed MFO that leverages Singapore's VCC structure. It is designed as a "plug-and-play" offering, where DBS will set up sub-funds which automatically benefit from the VCC's tax incentives. Ongoing regulatory reporting requirements are also managed on the client's behalf. The minimum asset threshold is S\$15 million.

Elsewhere in the market, families may have to set up their own fund entities and apply separately for tax incentives.

DBS MFO does not impose any pre-determined investment philosophy, and clients are not required to invest in DBS products. Clients are free to customise their own investment strategies that are aligned with the family's long-term vision. Capital is held and managed professionally by DBS.

Lee said: "While the traditional SFO model still appeals to many, we anticipated very early on that there would be growing demand for cost efficient yet institutionally supported solutions... Response has exceeded expectations."

DBS claims to serve more than a third of SFOs established in Singapore.

"Client interest in succession planning and wealth preservation has intensified, and we're currently in talks with more than 15 prospects who see DBS MFO as an attractive solution.

"With this in mind, we're on track to double our AUM to S\$2 billion by end-2026, achieving in just over half the time what it took to reach our first billion," said Lee.

In its family office practice, the bank offers other structures such as family trusts, private trust companies and donor-advised funds to address wealth and legacy planning needs.

DBS said it has also seen more UHNW families committed to using their wealth as a "force for good", either through impact investment or philanthropy. DBS MFO's efforts will focus on "unlocking strategic structural advantages" for clients in priority markets such as Taiwan, Japan and the United Kingdom.

Business Times Breaking News

New Articles

DBS aims for S\$2 billion in multi-family office assets under management

Genevieve Cua

569 words

23 September 2025

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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It also sees more ultra-high-net-worth families committed to using their wealth as a 'force for good'

[SINGAPORE] DBS Private Bank's multi-family office (MFO) service has attracted S\$1 billion in assets under management (AUM) from more than 25 ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) families in two years since its launch in 2023.

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Middle East

UAE: HSBC sets up shop in Dubai with region's first wealth centre to court wealthy clients

TOI World Desk

1,013 words

17 September 2025

The Times of India

TOI

English

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HSBC, Europe's largest bank by total assets, is expanding its footprint in the UAE with the opening of a dedicated wealth centre in Dubai. This new facility at the bank's flagship Jumeirah branch marks a strategic move to capture a larger share of the region's booming wealth and asset management business, amid an influx of millionaires moving to the UAE. The move comes at a time when the UAE is solidifying its position as a global hub for high-net-worth individuals, attracting more millionaires than any other country worldwide. HSBC's new wealth centre is designed to cater to the growing number of affluent clients in the region, offering a premium environment for **wealth management** consultations, bespoke financial solutions, and exclusive networking events. A new hub for high-net-worth clients HSBC's newly inaugurated wealth centre in Dubai is tailored for the bank's premier and high-net-worth clients.

The centre offers a private, exclusive space where clients can meet with specialist relationship managers, consult on asset management, and receive personalized services to grow, manage, and protect their wealth. The facility also includes an event space, which will host various exclusive functions such as seminars, educational sessions, and networking events, further fostering an atmosphere of financial empowerment for wealthy clients. The opening of this centre aligns with HSBC's broader strategy to expand its **wealth management** offerings globally. The bank has already launched similar wealth centres across markets in China, Hong Kong, Taiwan, the U.K., Malaysia, and Mexico. With these international hubs, HSBC is seeking to provide clients with seamless global connectivity, offering solutions that allow them to efficiently manage liquidity, currency transactions, and asset allocation across multiple regions. "We are making our biggest investment in our international wealth and premier banking business in the last two decades," said Dinesh Sharma, Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking for the Middle East, North Africa & Turkey. "This wealth centre is the first in a series of investments to establish the UAE as a key wealth hub in our global network." The UAE: A global magnet for millionaires The opening of HSBC's wealth centre is happening amid the UAE's surge as the world's top destination for millionaires. According to Henley & Partners' wealth migration data, the UAE is set to attract a record 9,800 new millionaires in 2025. This influx is expected to bring in a staggering \$63 billion (Dh231 billion) of investable wealth. This follows a trend from 2024, where the UAE welcomed 6,700 millionaires, maintaining its top spot globally. "The UAE has become the world's top destination for wealthy investors and entrepreneurs," said Mohamed Al Marzooqi, Chief Executive of HSBC Bank Middle East. "Measures like long-term residency and tax benefits have created a conducive environment for wealthy individuals, expanding a client base that aligns directly with HSBC's expertise in **wealth management** and cross-border banking." Currently, the UAE is home to approximately 130,500 millionaires, 325 centi-millionaires (those with \$100 million or more in liquid assets), and 28 billionaires. Dubai, in particular, remains the epicentre of wealth and investment, solidifying its reputation as a global wealth hub. Growth despite regulatory challenges While HSBC is making significant investments in the UAE, the bank recently faced scrutiny over regulatory issues in the region. Reports from Bloomberg and the Financial Times revealed that HSBC had to let go of over 1,000 wealthy clients across the broader Middle East, amid investigations into high-risk clients. These included individuals from Lebanon, Egypt, and Qatar, many of whom held assets exceeding \$100 million. Despite these challenges, HSBC has reaffirmed its commitment to the UAE and the broader Middle East region. Dinesh Sharma emphasized that the region remains a cornerstone of HSBC's global growth strategy. "The Middle East, North Africa, and Turkey (MENA) region generated 37% of our total revenue in the Middle East business in 2024," Sharma noted. "It also accounted for 13% of HSBC's overall international wealth and premier banking revenue last year." The UAE, in particular, ranks among HSBC's top five markets globally, underscoring the importance of the region to the bank's future growth. The creation of the new wealth centre is a direct response to the expanding market demand in the region. "We are investing heavily in infrastructure, products, and people to cater to the growing needs of the affluent population here," Sharma said. "In fact, the wealth of the UAE has been growing by over 20% in the past three years, reaching over \$700 billion in personal financial assets." A strategic step forward for HSBC The launch of this new wealth centre also

highlights HSBC's long-term vision for the region. As part of its growth strategy, the bank is considering further wealth centre locations, with Abu Dhabi being a potential candidate for a future site. The UAE's favorable regulatory environment, tax advantages, and its strategic position as a gateway to the broader Middle East, Africa, and South Asia have made it an attractive market for both family offices and institutional investors alike. "We've seen a historic influx of millionaires into the UAE," Sharma noted. "For the past decade, we've primarily seen millionaires from India, but now we are also seeing significant interest from China. Last year, China was the fourth-largest real estate investor in the UAE, accounting for 9% of all real estate transactions." In addition to the notable presence of Indian and Chinese investors, the UAE is also drawing significant numbers of millionaires from other regions. According to The National, over 20% of the new wealth in the UAE comes from other Middle Eastern markets, while 14% originates from Russia and the Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS). The UK and Europe account for 12% of the influx, reinforcing the UAE's status as a global magnet for wealthy investors across diverse nationalities.

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COMPANIES & MARKETS

UOB Private Bank the first to distribute Asia-focused private equity evergreen fund

Wong Chia Peck

587 words

12 September 2025

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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UOB, South-east Asia's third-biggest bank by total assets, said it is the world's first to distribute an Asia-focused private equity (PE) evergreen fund to its **private banking** clients.

Launched by Hamilton Lane, the Asia Private Assets Fund invests in private companies in the region.

Forty per cent of the fund will be invested in developed markets such as Japan, South Korea, Singapore and Australia. Another 40 per cent will be in emerging Asian countries, with the rest in global markets.

UOB **Private Bank**, which caters to clients with investable assets of S\$5 million, will be the fund's sole distributor from Thursday (Sep 11) for a few months.

Investors want to access private Asian companies, given that "86 per cent of (the) businesses in Asia are privately held, and there is already a very sizeable Asian PE market with about US\$3 trillion" in assets under management, said Wong Meng Keet, head of managed products and alternative investments at UOB **Private Bank**.

However, the traditional closed-ended PE fund structure with a lock-up period for as long as 12 years makes investing in private companies relatively unappealing to retail investors, who usually prefer more liquidity to address their cash-flow needs.

Enter evergreen funds, which are more palatable to these investors, because the minimum investment is typically lower than that of closed-end funds that target mostly institutional investors.

For the Asia Private Assets Fund, this amount is S\$100,000.

They are also more appealing to retail investors as they operate indefinitely, allowing continual capital raising, investment and distribution. Investors can enter and exit at periodic intervals. This is why such funds are also known as semi-liquid funds.

As PE funds target high-net-worth individuals, there has been a "proliferation" of evergreen funds globally, with more than 400 launched in the last few years, bringing the total to 509 as at January 2025, said Wong.

"The evergreen structure has been a game changer for targeting the (private) wealth space, because it dramatically reduces the administrative burden (found) in a traditional lock-up structure."

UOB **Private Bank**'s clients' current allocation to alternative assets is around one-third, creeping up from the low-teens percentage allocation from three years ago, Wong added.

Apart from a long lock-up period, investors need to grapple with J-curve and capital calls with closed-ended funds. J-curve refers to the initial period when the returns on an investment fall, before rising further out. This happens as fund managers do not deploy all the funds at once.

UOB **Private Bank** currently offers evergreen funds in other private assets, such as private credit, infrastructure and real estate.

As the bank's clients are already actively investing in private assets through their family offices, they are "very receptive" to the idea of accessing Asian PE through an evergreen structure, Wong said. Therefore, he is confident that the fundraising will be strong.

This is especially since Hamilton Lane itself, and through its senior managers, has invested in the fund. In addition, there is an institutional investor who is putting in a sizeable amount, he said.

With rising appetite for private assets globally, the traditional portfolio construction of 60 per cent stocks and 40 per cent bonds is evolving into 60 per cent public equities and debt, and 40 per cent in their unlisted peers, he added.

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Business

HSBC office for rich clients opens at ICC

Enoch Yiu

635 words

10 September 2025

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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New 23,000 sq ft centre on 99th floor set to give a boost to city's struggling office property market and help the lender serve its wealthy customers

HSBC Holdings, Hong Kong's largest lender, yesterday opened a 23,000 sq ft wealth management centre in the International Commerce Centre (ICC), which is expected to give a boost to the city's struggling office market as well as helping the bank serve its wealthy clients.

The centre is located on the 99th floor of the ICC and is HSBC's largest **wealth management** office globally. It features 51 meeting rooms to accommodate 100 staff and clients, plus two event spaces that can host banquets for up to 220 people.

HSBC does not release rental information, but a source in the property market said ICC rents stood at HK\$65 to HK\$69 per square foot, indicating the new centre's rent would be HK\$1.5 million to HK\$1.6 million a month.

"With Hong Kong set to become the world's largest cross-border wealth hub by 2030, we are opening the world's tallest bank to serve our high-net-worth customers," said Janet Pang, HSBC Hong Kong's managing director and head of distribution for wealth and personal banking.

She said the location satisfied the needs of wealthy customers who wanted privacy while also enjoying the expansive views afforded by the ICC.

The ICC location is the bank's fourth large **wealth management** centre in the city. It planned to open a fifth location in the International Finance Centre in Central by the end of 2025, Pang said. The others are located in Tsim Sha Tsui, Causeway Bay and at HSBC's headquarters.

"Even amid a digital banking era, we found high-net-worth customers' demand for face-to-face meetings with our experienced wealth experts to handle their **wealth management**, succession planning and other financial needs," she said.

"That is why we found it necessary to have a physical **wealth management** centre."

In February, HSBC CEO Georges Elhedery said he would redirect US\$1.5 billion from "low-return" markets to high-growth areas like Hong Kong, mainland China, Singapore and India, with **wealth management** as a priority.

Financial firms like HSBC, Manulife, Standard Chartered and Sun Life have in recent years fought for sea-view offices in Tsim Sha Tsui and other tourist hotspots to open luxury **wealth management** centres.

This in turn has helped support the city's struggling office property market.

"We have seen more demand in the private and **wealth management** sectors, typically focused on offices with sea views and core locations," said Sam Gourlay, head of the office leasing advisory at JLL on Hong Kong Island.

Hong Kong's office-leasing activity rose for the fourth consecutive month in July, pushing down elevated vacancy rates that had weighed on rents, according to JLL.

In June, proprietary trading firm Jane Street Asia leased 223,437 sq ft across six floors in Henderson Land's New Central Harbourfront for HK\$137 per square foot, totalling HK\$30.6 million monthly, excluding fees.

Last month, insurer FWD Hong Kong signed a decade-long lease for 330,000 sq ft of office space in Taikoo Place, marking the largest office rental deal in the city this year.

"I do not think the trend is going to stop," Gourlay said.

"The government is supporting the development of Hong Kong as a global **wealth management** centre. The recent rebound in the stock market and the active IPO markets in Hong Kong would all support the growing **wealth management** business, which would lead to more demand from private banks or **wealth management** offices."

enoch.yiu@scmp.com

Document SCMP000020250909e19a00009

Exclusive: DBS PB to launch DPM services in Hong Kong

Cheryl Heng

442 words

9 September 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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DBS **Private Bank** is set to launch discretionary portfolio management (DPM) services in Hong Kong and is currently recruiting to lead the initiative, Citywire Asia understands.

The move follows a fivefold increase in the bank's DPM business over the past five years, with growth in North Asia expected to play a similar role, as highlighted in Citywire's Asia Discretionary Power Players [report](#) earlier this year.

'While our **private banking** clients around the world can already tap on the expertise of our DPM team in Singapore to create bespoke investment solutions, we are considering a local license in Hong Kong,' a bank spokesperson confirmed.

The launch is intended to provide more convenience for local clients and on-the-ground access, amid rising demand, the spokesperson added.

As part of the rollout, DBS said it is building a team. In May, the bank advertised for an executive director to lead its Hong Kong DPM business and serve as executive officer under the Securities and Futures Ordinance.

The role will involve working with **private bankers** to grow assets under management through customised mandates.

Private banks in Asia have [seen notable growth](#) in DPM assets over the past two years, as clients increasingly delegate portfolio management after suffering steep losses in 2022. DPM penetration has since climbed, with some banks reporting levels in the high single-digit to double-digit range.

To capture this trend, many firms are investing in DPM capabilities, expanding teams, infrastructure and distribution to build recurring fee revenues.

At Bank of Singapore, its Hong Kong branch recorded 53% year-on-year growth in DPM AUM and 33% year-on-year growth in DPM revenue, said Kelvin Tang, head of chief investment office, Hong Kong branch, Bank of Singapore.

DBS's own growth has been driven by new client acquisitions, higher investments from existing clients and conversions from advisory to discretionary mandates.

'Wealth clients around the world look to Asia as part of their diversification strategy. Singapore and Hong Kong, where our booking centres are, stand out as prime landing spots for them to access the growing pool of dynamic investment opportunities in the region,' said Christophe Marciano, head of discretionary portfolio management at DBS, in [Citywire's DPM report](#).

Marciano said sustaining double-digit growth is becoming more ambitious as its base expands, but it remains the trajectory.

In Asean markets, DPM is already well embedded, supported by a first-generation client profile and set to accelerate further as younger clients show greater openness to delegation, said Marciano. DBS expects North Asia to follow a similar path.

Document CWIRAS0020250909eI9900002

Former StanChart global wealth head joins Bain & Company

James Phillipps

153 words

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Citywire Asia

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Former Standard Chartered global wealth head Marc Van de Walle has joined Bain & Company as an external advisor.

In his new role, he will provide advice on **wealth management** and both private and retail banking, according to his 8 Sept LinkedIn update. He will also work with Bain's partners and consultants to 'enhance client engagements' and provide strategic input.

Singapore-based Van de Walle (pictured) was latterly global head of **wealth management**, deposits and mortgages at Standard Chartered in a four-year stint at the Anglo-Asian lender, before leaving last May.

Prior to that he was global head of products at Bank of Singapore, where he spent more than 11 years. He also spent five years at the bank's parent company, OCBC, as head of **wealth management**.

Van de Valle started at out ING, where he worked in Belgium, Luxembourg and the Netherlands.

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HSBC Private Bank: Q4 2025 Investment Outlook – Seizing the AI Liftoff, Riding the Fed Cuts

Distributed by Contify.com

700 words

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Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* The bank recommends diversifying investments through sector rotation, geographical diversification, and asset diversification to mitigate risks and capture opportunities.

* HSBC Private Bank identifies four priorities for Q4 2025: positioning for Fed cuts, capturing AI opportunities, mitigating currency and portfolio risks, and riding Asia's policy tailwinds.

* HSBC Private Bank recommends investing in Asian equities and bonds, driven by AI adoption, corporate governance reforms, and China's demand-side stimulus and supply-side reform.

Original Press Release:

Sept. 8 -- HSBC Private Bank issued the following news release:

Rapid advancements in AI innovation and expected Federal Reserve rate cuts are outweighing overly negative concerns about the impact of US trade tariffs and policy uncertainties, according to HSBC Private Bank.

The bank has advised its high net worth and ultra high net worth clients that the wait for Fed rate cuts will soon be over, which will help both economic activity and market sentiment. In its latest Investment Outlook, Seizing the AI Liftoff, Riding the Fed Cuts, it added that even if US economic growth slows a little, AI-led innovation is set to boost investment, productivity and market valuations.

Nevertheless, it is important to not ignore the headwinds and the risk of market volatility. HSBC Private Bank recommended to clients three ways to diversify: a sector rotation in US equities to address growth, inflation and valuation challenges; geographical diversification, including into Chinese tech stocks which trade at a discount compared to global peers; and asset diversification, particularly into highly rated bonds and alternative assets.

Its four priorities going into Q4 2025 are:

* Position for a new round of Fed cuts: The Fed's focus is turning to slightly lower growth, which is positive for bonds but likely to lead to further US dollar weakness. Lower interest rates will encourage investors to put their cash to work.

* Capture expanding opportunities in AI: AI innovation is in a real liftoff phase, and there is plenty of evidence of AI helping firms cut costs and improve services across industries. Firms across the AI ecosystem have plenty of earnings upside.

* Mitigate currency and portfolio risks: A multi-asset approach can manage portfolio volatility amid uncertain markets. Alternative assets and volatility strategies also provide downside protection in equity, bond and currency markets.

* Ride on Asia's policy tailwinds and structural trends: Asia will benefit from AI adoption, corporate governance reforms, China's demand-side stimulus and supply-side reform, which offer positive drivers for Asian equities and bonds.

Willem Sels, Global Chief Investment Officer at HSBC Private Bank and Premier Wealth, said: "It has been popular to take a bearish view on the US, with concerns over unconventional policies and rising debt. Yet, US economic data has generally surprised on the upside, and the latest earnings season had a near-record

percentage of upward surprises. Even as US economic growth slows a little, the stock market should do well as long as tech innovation continues.”

Cheuk Wan Fan, Chief Investment Officer, Asia at HSBC **Private Bank** and Premier Wealth, said: “Asian economies have shown remarkable resilience amid trade uncertainty so far this year. Asian equity and bond markets offer a diverse opportunity set for growth, income and diversification, powered by China’s AI innovation and supply-side reforms, Asia’s corporate governance reforms, rising dividend yields and a domestic consumption boom.”

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 57 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,214 billion at 30 June 2025, HSBC is one of the world’s largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Retail Banking, Banks, Regulatory and Legal, Cost Cutting, Artificial Intelligence]

Source: HSBC **Private Bank**

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Business

HSBC reshuffles leadership team in city

Enoch Yiu

569 words

5 September 2025

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Maggie Ng to take over as HK CEO amid **wealth management** expansion

HSBC has announced a reshuffle of its senior executives to strengthen its **wealth management** business, as subsidiary Hang Seng Bank faces higher property credit losses.

Starting next month and contingent on regulatory approval, Maggie Ng would assume the role of HSBC Hong Kong CEO, in addition to her existing duties as head of retail banking and wealth for the Hong Kong unit, the bank said yesterday.

Ng will replace Luanne Lim, who will take on the CEO role at HSBC's subsidiary Hang Seng Bank, replacing Diana Cesar.

Cesar will return to HSBC as vice-chairman of Hong Kong to advise the two co-CEOs of Asia and the Middle East, David Liao and Surendra Rosha. Before being assigned to Hang Seng in September 2021, Cesar served as CEO of HSBC Hong Kong for seven years.

"We are already the market leader in Hong Kong, and have substantial further opportunities to invest and grow," Liao said in a statement announcing the appointments.

"The appointment of a wealth expert to head the Hong Kong unit reflects HSBC's commitment to expanding its **wealth management** business, as the fee income from selling investment products is growing faster than the traditional lending business," said Tom Chan Pak-lam, permanent honourable president of the Institute of Securities Dealers, an industry body for brokers.

Ng, who joined HSBC in 2020 in her current role, has led the bank in expanding its **wealth management** business, which group CEO Georges Elhedery said earlier this year was to be the focus of expansion in the coming years. Before joining HSBC, Ng was Greater China CEO of IG Group, an online trading provider.

"Since joining HSBC, Maggie has overseen significant growth in our largest retail banking and **wealth management** market," the HSBC statement said. "She has a proven track record in delivering growth, improving customer advocacy, driving digital transformation and effectively managing risks."

In the first quarter, HSBC added 300,000 customers to its 6 million Hong Kong client base, as mainland visitors crossed the border to buy wealth products, insurance and other investments in the city, according to the bank's results announcement.

The reshuffle comes as a prolonged slump in the residential and commercial property markets in Hong Kong has proven to be a drag on Hang Seng's loan book. It made extra provisions to counter the effect of a 0.57 percentage point rise in non-performing loans, which reached 6.69 per cent of total loans at the end of June, up from 6.12 per cent at the end of 2024.

The provisions weighed on the bank's interim profit, which fell by 30 per cent to HK\$6.88 billion from HK\$9.89 billion a year earlier. It was the biggest percentage drop in earnings since the first half of 2022.

The boardroom shuffle at the two lenders was a "usual practice" as Hang Seng Bank heads were appointed by the parent company and "would not change the strategies of Hang Seng", said Kenny Tang Sing-hing, chairman of the Hong Kong Institute of Financial Analysts and Professional Commentators.

HSBC said that during Lim's four-year tenure as CEO of HSBC Hong Kong she had driven "significant business growth, brand and community engagement".

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COMPANIES & MARKETS

HSBC Singapore's wealth head sees nation as key to global wealth strategy

Tan Nai Lun

749 words

3 September 2025

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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As HSBC undergoes a global overhaul of its operations, Singapore remains a key priority of the bank's strategy to "future-proof" itself, said Ashmita Acharya, head of international wealth and premier banking in HSBC Singapore.

"In the new sphere, there's a clear realisation that the home market needs to grow faster, but we need to diversify and look at other markets for a stronger future -- almost like future-proofing our growth strategy," she said.

The banking giant announced in October 2024 that it was embarking on an ambitious restructuring of its business worldwide and looking to simplify its organisational structure.

There are four main businesses, including the standalone business segments for its home markets in Hong Kong and the UK, each with its own personal banking and commercial banking divisions.

Operations in its remaining markets will be regrouped to form, thirdly, the corporate and institutional banking business, and the international wealth and premier banking business would comprise its fourth business segment.

This fourth segment includes HSBC's premier banking-focused businesses outside Hong Kong and the UK, its global **private bank**, and its asset management and insurance businesses.

HSBC shares in Hong Kong are up a third so far this year.

Singapore, UAE, China and India are the four priority markets for the wealth segment, Acharya said.

"The importance of Singapore has become very pronounced, and I think that shows with the investments we got this year," she said.

HSBC Singapore opened the second of its three planned wealth centres in July, as part of a multi-year transformation which includes a five-fold investment increase towards boosting its local physical network.

On the people front, it has made several senior hires in Singapore, including for its **private banking**, asset management and insurance segments.

Acharya said Singapore has a very broad catchment of clients who find it attractive, including family offices, businesses and retail wealth.

The Republic is safe, stable, has strong regulations and a forward-looking agenda, she added.

With heightened uncertainty in global stock markets, the stability of the Singapore dollar has been letting investors grow and protect their assets, she added.

Singapore is also Asia's preferred offshore-wealth destination, according to HSBC's Affluent Investor Snapshot released on Jul 9.

"When the pie is expanding, I think everyone will see opportunities in Singapore," she said.

"Who's going to capture that opportunity? It'll be the bank which has that consistency of delivery, is able to address the international needs of the client, and is able to look at that next-gen proposition," Acharya said.

Calling HSBC's international connectivity a "superpower, given its presence in multiple markets", she said it can help customers move between jurisdictions seamlessly.

More than half of HSBC Singapore's wealth customers are offshore customers. As at 2024, the lender had doubled offshore wealth from its key corridors in India and China, compared with three years ago.

HSBC also owns an insurance arm and asset management arm, which can help create bespoke products that meet the financial needs of its customers, she said.

Meanwhile, not only can the banking giant serve customers' business needs, it is able to handle personal needs across the entire wealth spectrum, from premier and premier elite to the **private-bank** segment.

Deepening relationships

Looking ahead, Acharya is aiming to deepen the wealth relationship with clients.

To continue building on its connectivity offering, she said the bank has to provide a consistent proposition across its markets, from service to digital offerings.

She also hopes to have more quality client conversations, outreach and education through its wealth centres in Singapore.

"It's not about having fancy hardware: everyone's got wealth centres, in all fairness," she said. "But the type of conversation we want to have with customers at the wealth centres has to change."

Furthermore, the bank is looking to work with partners, both internally and externally, to create better experiences for clients.

Acharya noted examples include the partnership with Raffles Medical for its integrated health and wealth centre; with the Singapore Tourism Board to showcase the Dempsey precinct through discounts and experiences for cardholders; and with cross-border payments network Dandelion to boost its global money transfers capability.

"This is not about generating revenue or product pitching; this is about helping clients plan better," she said.

"We don't want to be a transactional bank."

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Exclusive: Hong Leong Bank cherry-picks RMs from Julius Baer, StanChart

Priyanka Boghani

181 words

1 September 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

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The Malaysian bank continues to ramp up its Singapore presence, hiring two **private bankers** from Julius Baer and Standard Chartered to cover high net worth clients, according to an internal memo seen by Citywire Asia.

Melvin Heng and Ting Ting Tan have joined the **private bank** in Singapore, reporting directly to the **private bank**'s desk head, Chee Kien, the note said.

Heng moved over from Julius Baer, where he was covering HNW clients in Southeast Asia. Prior to that, he held various roles at Bank of Singapore, UOB and Standard Chartered.

Prior to Hong Leong Bank, Tan worked at Standard Chartered Bank as a relationship manager covering the SEA markets. She has also worked at DBS, ANZ and Citibank.

Hong Leong Bank remains one of the few that is aggressively building its **private bank** from the ground up, having set up a [new](#) HNW unit in July. Under former HSBC GPB fund selector, Jeffrey Yap, the bank has been focusing on [hiring](#) extensively for its **private bank** in Singapore and Malaysia.

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HSBC **Private Bank** leans on broad suite of services to partner ultra-rich families and entrepreneurs

Distributed by Contify.com

1,439 words

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Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC **Private Bank** is positioning itself as a holistic partner for ultra-high-net-worth individuals (UHNWI) and entrepreneurial families, offering a broad suite of services to cater to their diverse needs.

* The bank is well-positioned to provide a full spectrum capability, with both private and institutional offerings, to support UHNWI entrepreneurs and their families in navigating business transitions, succession planning, and wealth transfers.

* The bank is helping entrepreneurial families prepare for intergenerational wealth transfer, with US\$5.8 trillion expected to be transferred within Asia Pacific between 2023 and 2030, and UHNWIs accounting for about 60% of this amount.

Original Press Release:

Aug. 27 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

The rise of entrepreneurial families is rewriting the way **private banks** cater to ultra-high-net-worth individuals (UHNWI).

From growing their businesses to navigating new challenges and planning wealth transfers, they need a holistic partner with broad and deep capabilities such as HSBC **Private Bank** to help them sail through every milestone.

In the initial stages, as entrepreneurs grow their businesses, their families could expand as well in absolute size and frequently, in their involvement in the businesses. As UHNWI entrepreneurs and their families set up **family offices**, they are adopting the investment and asset management models similar to those that institutional investors practice.

In the process, they become more knowledgeable and demand more from the **private banks** they engage, says Tommy Leung, HSBC's Head of Global **Private Banking**, South Asia. They require a full spectrum capability – a banking partner with both private and institutional offerings – which HSBC is well-positioned to provide.

“With the growing number of **family offices** in Singapore over the last 10 years, they are being professionalised. They expect more institutional-like coverage, as opposed to the traditional wine and dine type of **private banking** relationships.”

These entrepreneurial families need support that could span from expanding the business's footprint in other markets, to exploring ways to raise capital and hedging their foreign currency exposures. These are above and beyond what a traditional, pure-play **private bank** can provide.

“Our big clients are always thinking about their operating company, whether it's cross-border mergers and acquisitions, optimising their capital structure or raising debt and equity. A lot of these are not traditional **private banking** topics. So if you put a banker who 'grew up' in the **private banking** world and hasn't acquired new skills, they would struggle to understand what the client is looking for,” Leung explains.

Hence, it is important that **private banks** can bring in executives with investment banking and capital market knowledge to the table.

Leung points to Kerri Lim, Head of Asia's Ultra High Net Worth segment at HSBC Global **Private Banking**, who joined in March 2024 with long-standing experience in investment banking in global markets. Sharnika Silva, Head of Trust and Fiduciary Services, Southeast Asia, also helps support and deliver services such as trust structuring and administration for both private and charitable trusts, as well as estate planning for UHNWIs and entrepreneurial families.

Bringing a team with experience in the various types of banking services is especially important for entrepreneurial clients with established businesses that have expanded to involve many branches of the family, or even related families.

"It's easy when we talk to one family at the top initially, but as the families transition, they may have a few families in the second and third generations. What each family wants to do is different. So from one relationship, it could end up to be four relationships," Lim explains.

Apart from operating their businesses, entrepreneurs are also tackling two key transitions.

Transitional challenge

The first is business transition, as it could face fresh demands such as that for greater environmental sustainability after decades of development.

"If you look at countries like Malaysia and Indonesia, a lot of the wealth was created in the natural resources sector, coal mining, oil and gas, palm oil and so on. Historically, these were fine. But over time, there's greater awareness of their impact on the environment. A lot of the clients also want to transition either into a more sustainable way of harvesting these natural resources, or shifting from fossil fuel to renewable energy," Leung says.

Succession planning is another challenge. Different members of an entrepreneurial family have differing interests, wants and aspirations. To preserve family unity, it is important to tailor not just the amount of inheritance each member receives, but also their future role in the business.

"Imagine someone spending the last 50 years building one company to a certain size... How do you pass on one company to multiple children? Do you divide it up? Do you split up the roles and responsibilities, (and decide) which branch takes which part of the company?" he asks.

Given the entrepreneur's decades of dedication in building and growing the business, just broaching the topic of succession planning and intergenerational wealth transfer can stir up emotions, even causing friction in some cases, he notes.

In HSBC's July report on family-owned businesses in Asia, 78 per cent of the 1,882 entrepreneurs surveyed globally say they would like to keep their business in the family.

Even so, two-thirds of respondents from mainland China, Hong Kong and Taiwan have not planned for how their businesses might continue after them.

"It is a state of affairs that seems likely to not only damage family harmony over the short term, but also jeopardise its wealth and business affairs over the longer one," the report states.

In such scenarios, HSBC **Private Bank**, through its support on various fronts for the entrepreneurial families, would already have a deep understanding of the family's dynamics to tailor a smooth transition.

For instance, while the entrepreneur may pass one part of the business to the eldest child, another branch of the family could end up with the financial assets and managing them through the **family office**.

This is where HSBC **Private Bank**'s suite of expertise and services can prove useful, in helping the entrepreneur build a **family office** framework and governance. In turn, it helps the entrepreneur and his **family office** manage the assets, while providing the right solutions to do so as well, spanning the areas of asset allocation and manager selections.

Succession planning

McKinsey calculates that US\$5.8 trillion of intergenerational wealth transfer will occur within Asia Pacific between 2023 and 2030, of which UHNWIs will account for about 60 per cent. This means Asian countries are rapidly creating new billionaires.

Given the large sums involved, potentially spanning family members who live in different countries, HSBC **Private Bank** can help entrepreneurial families prepare their wealth and transition plans, which may cover various tax jurisdictions.

While financial concerns are among the top priorities in succession planning, it isn't all about the money.

"Many of our clients have built significant businesses over decades, and when the time comes to think about the next generation, it's rarely just about the money," says Silva.

Managing the emotional aspect of intergenerational wealth transfer is also important – this entails looking at the focus and priorities, which could differ especially for larger families with several branches.

To manage every party's needs and aspirations, HSBC **Private Bank** can help every branch of the entrepreneur's family attain their goals.

While some may want to keep the business, another part may want to exit, or liquidate it. HSBC can tap its capabilities and network to help the clients find partners, or for those seeking to exit, to look at options to liquidate to generate liquidity for their future generations.

Leung likens the range of solutions that HSBC **Private Bank** provides to a grand piano with 88 keys.

"You have all sorts of products and solutions available, from the retail bank to the **private bank** to the corporate bank to the investment bank, but most people tend to play the same two octaves because this is their core focus. However, having people with the experience and relevant background allows us to play the whole grand piano and bring the right solutions to the right client."

With HSBC **Private Bank**'s leadership bench complete in Singapore, its capabilities are strengthened further for it to be a trusted and holistic partner for UHNWIs and entrepreneurial families, navigating them expertly through their journeys from business expansion, building **family offices**, ensuring sustainability and succession planning.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Retail Banking, Banks]

Source: HSBC Group

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HSBC GPB chases 2024's alts record on double-digit flow growth

Cheryl Heng
690 words
27 August 2025
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HSBC Global **Private Banking** is maintaining double-digit percentage growth in alternatives inflows this year after posting record numbers in 2024, driven by strong demand for hedge funds and evergreen private market funds globally.

'2025 continued with very strong momentum from 2024. April was slower given volatility in the market, but we started to see a pickup again,' said Mathieu Forcioli, global and Asia Pacific regional head of alternatives, wealth and premier solutions, HSBC. 'We are back to similar growth rates as seen in 2024.'

While the bank does not disclose alternatives assets under management at the **private banking** level, its alternatives exposure sits within HSBC Asset Management's \$808bn global platform, which also serves institutional clients.

Hedge funds inflows in the first half were strong as clients sought diversification amid higher equity-bond correlations, said Forcioli. Multi-strategy hedge funds and fund-of-hedge funds products typically offer higher expected returns than investment grade bonds with potentially lower volatility.

He said demand is skewed toward single-manager long-short and multi-manager, multi-strategy funds, building from last year's momentum.

Rival Asian **private banks** are seeing similar trends, building on last year's momentum, when the likes of UBS Global Wealth Management saw a 50% year-on-year surge in client demand for hedge fund investments.

Evergreen momentum

Private wealth clients too are diving into open-ended evergreen funds, which has fueled **private banks'** ambition to tap that source.

'The majority comes from new-to-private market investors,' shared Forcioli.

In 2024, the **private bank** recorded double-digit alternatives AUM growth, with private credit leading inflows, followed by private equity and infrastructure.

The focus for 2026 is building core private market allocations in suitable clients' portfolios, combining funds from large managers for broad asset class exposure, and layering in niche evergreen strategies and closed-end products for additional alpha.

On single-manager feeder offerings, the bank is primarily investing with existing managers, while exploring more secondaries, infrastructure and niche mid-market strategies.

The bank maintains continuous oversight of evergreen funds, monitoring cash levels and deployment pace monthly.

'We see whether they are within the boundaries that they set themselves, or they are struggling a little bit in terms of ramp up,' said Forcioli.

Cash drag remains a structural feature of open-ended vehicles, unlike closed-end drawdown funds. Forcioli emphasised the importance of managers' ability to deploy and manage capital consistently.

'We look at the scale and strength of their platform to deploy and manage,' Forcioli said, noting some managers cap inflows quarterly to stay aligned with deal pipelines. 'The portfolio has to live regularly with exits and investments.'

Performance across evergreen strategies has largely met expectations, he said, driving top-ups in 2025. PitchBook data shows an average one-year return of 8% for private capital evergreen vehicles.

HSBC prioritises seed portfolios and anchor investors when evaluating open-ended funds. 'Even for a global bank like us, the ideal situation is there is a seed portfolio,' he said.

If the vehicle is small relative to the manager's AUM and existing pipeline, it has minimal initial impact - though matching inflows and deployment becomes more complex as it grows.

On the closed-end side, HSBC Asset Management recently closed the seventh vintage of its Vision private equity strategy, which has raised \$2.6bn since its 2019 launch.

Clients can also access co-investments and secondaries, with more sophisticated investors participating in a deal-by-deal programme.

HSBC began investing in alternatives as early as 1989. While Forcioli declined to disclose growth figures, he said alternatives penetration across the **private bank**'s client base has been steadily rising over the past couple of years.

Within the group, HSBC Asset Management's investment team oversees operational and investment due diligence, as well as fund-of-funds management.

This team operates independently from Forcioli's unit under the **private banking** and wealth division, which focuses on onboarding across booking centres and partnering with asset managers and fund houses to provide education to bankers and advice to clients.

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Supplement 1

Navigating generational wealth: How UOB Private Bank's DPM delivers stability through market cycles

1,349 words

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ASIA'S wealth engine is accelerating. The region's population of individuals with assets exceeding US\$10 million grew by 5 per cent last year and is projected to rise by 8.7 per cent by 2028, according to Knight Frank's 2025 Wealth Report.

At the same time, a McKinsey study revealed that Asia is on the cusp of a major wealth transfer, with an estimated US\$5.8 trillion expected to change hands among Ultra-High-Net-Worth (UHNW) and High-Net-Worth (HNW) families by 2030.

"As more families seek professional support to manage their wealth, we are seeing strong growth in the DPM sector," says Benny Lee, Head of DPM at UOB Private Bank. "Clients appreciate having a trusted team to oversee their portfolios, with the discipline and transparency that give them peace of mind."

Best positioned for Asian generational wealth

Against this backdrop of generational transition, UOB Private Bank is well placed to support the ambitions of Asia's families, combining foresight, regional connectivity, and disciplined investment stewardship.

As a third-generation bank, UOB understands first-hand the values, discipline and long-term vision needed to build and preserve wealth across time. This perspective resonates strongly with Asian families, many of whom are navigating their own growth, succession and legacy planning.

UOB's extensive footprint across Asean and Greater China gives clients direct access to the region's growth corridors. The bank combines its on-the-ground market expertise with cultural fluency, recognising that in Asia, wealth decisions are often shaped not only by investment outcomes but also by family dynamics, intergenerational priorities and business considerations. This ability to balance financial strategy with cultural understanding is an advantage few global players can match.

"As Asia's prosperity grows, so do our clients' aspirations -- whether in business, family or legacy," says Lee. "Our deep roots in Asean allow us to connect those ambitions to meaningful opportunities, helping families not only safeguard their wealth but also shape their legacy."

The bank's One Bank approach further integrates corporate banking, investments, and advisory into a seamless experience, making it easier for clients to manage their financial affairs and focus on what matters most.

These strengths complement UOB Private Bank's DPM offering. It embodies the bank's philosophy through a structured, insight-led approach, helping clients stay focused, make informed decisions, and navigate market cycles with confidence.

Meeting evolving client needs

As second- and third-generation HNWI's take the reins, expectations are changing, with many coming in with deeper market familiarity and a stronger preference for transparency and control. For them, digital engagement has become the standard, with clients expecting real-time visibility into their portfolios and personalised solutions that reflect not only their financial objectives but also their lifestyles, family priorities and legacies.

While some are setting up their own family offices for greater autonomy, many continue to seek institutional expertise, insights, and risk frameworks that a private bank can provide.

"Our role is to fill the gaps and provide support where needed," says Lee.

CIO philosophy anchors DPM approach

UOB **Private Bank**'s DPM business was launched nine years ago, covering fixed income, balanced, and growth strategies. At its core is the philosophy of its Chief Investment Office (CIO), which champions advisory excellence that supports diverse investment journeys, from income generation and capital growth to legacy planning and philanthropy.

"We take a long-term view, managing our clients' wealth with the same care as we would our own," says Dr Neo Teng Hwee, Chief Investment Officer and Head of Investment Products and Solutions at UOB **Private Bank**. "Our strategies are shaped by each client's risk appetite and investment objectives, with the agility to seize opportunities even in volatile markets."

This disciplined approach helps clients stay focused by filtering out short-term market noise. By entrusting investment decisions to the DPM team, it reduces emotional reactions and cognitive biases ensuring portfolios remain strategically aligned with long-term goals.

Built on trust, proven in results

Trust is the cornerstone of DPM. When clients delegate the responsibility of managing their wealth, they expect foresight, integrity and accountability at every step. At UOB **Private Bank**, this trust is earned through transparency, consistent delivery, and open communication -- giving clients the assurance that their wealth is in capable hands.

That assurance is also reinforced by performance. Clients often highlight the consistency of returns and the lower volatility in their DPM portfolios, which have consistently delivered top-quartile results.

This combination of trust and outcomes sets UOB **Private Bank** apart. It allows clients to focus on what truly matters -- growing their businesses, nurturing their families and preserving legacies.

This commitment to stewardship has also been recognised externally, with UOB **Private Bank** named Best DPM in Singapore and Asia at the Euromoney **Private Banking** Awards 2025.

For Lee, the accolade is more than industry recognition. "It reflects the trust our clients place in us, and our responsibility to honour that trust every day," he says.

Delivering peace of mind

For many clients, peace of mind comes not just from performance, but from knowing their wealth is guided by discipline through every market cycle.

One such client, supported by senior client adviser Shawn Ang, had a demanding career and little time to actively manage his wealth.

"We worked closely with our portfolio managers to tailor a strategy that fit his needs, and kept him updated regularly," Ang says. Over time, the client shared that having professionals oversee his portfolio gave him stability and the confidence to stay the course, without the stress of day-to-day decisions.

That same steady approach was instrumental in navigating the pandemic-induced market correction in 2020. The team acted decisively to reduce risk exposure and later redeployed capital as conditions improved.

"We acted with conviction, and that made a difference," Lee says.

These timely actions helped preserve client confidence in the team's ability to safeguard and grow wealth, even in the most turbulent periods.

Confidence through transparency

Transparency and engagement remain central to the DPM experience. Clients have access to real-time dashboards via mobile and Web, along with timely CIO insights through reports and podcasts. They also receive periodic and ad hoc performance reports with commentary that provides clarity on positioning and progress.

This visibility, Lee says, goes hand in hand with active oversight. Portfolios are reviewed quarterly or semi-annually to ensure alignment with client goals and market conditions, with rebalancing carried out as needed.

Proactive dialogue during major market events or life milestones further ensures that portfolios remain resilient and responsive.

Looking ahead

To serve clients in an increasingly complex environment, the team is enhancing its toolkit with technology that improves timeliness and insight.

This includes the use of artificial intelligence (AI) productivity tools to help portfolio managers track corporate developments as well as curate both macro and company-specific research. They are also assessing AI-driven portfolio optimisation and risk analytics.

At a broader level, UOB **Private Bank** is exploring AI applications such as chatbots and digital assistants for client engagement, as well as predictive analytics to better anticipate client needs and market shifts.

Yet even as innovation reshapes the industry, the bank remains anchored in its role as a trusted steward of wealth. With deep regional insight, disciplined investment and risk frameworks as well as a commitment to long-term generational success, UOB **Private Bank** continues to stand alongside its clients, helping families navigate change and build legacies that last.

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Business Times Breaking News

Standard Chartered supports UHNW families across borders and generations

1,255 words

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Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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From **family offices** to digital-first experiences, the bank is helping clients build resilient structures, navigate complexity, and create lasting legacies

FOR today's ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) families, managing wealth goes far beyond investment returns.

From navigating complex cross-border structures to shaping philanthropic legacies, clients are increasingly looking for banks to be trusted advisers for every stage of their family succession and legacy journey.

At Standard Chartered, that means combining global expertise with personalised, multi-generational support and engagement.

Capturing opportunities to future-proof legacies

Raymond Ang, global head, private bank and affluent clients, and head, wealth and retail banking, Greater China and North Asia at Standard Chartered, notes that the needs of UHNW clients have evolved significantly.

"The opportunities lie in capturing these trends and serving clients' needs in each of these areas effectively," he says.

One key trend is the institutionalisation of wealth management, with more families establishing dedicated **family offices** – over 2,000 in Singapore and more than 2,700 in Hong Kong.

Another is the "significant amount" of upcoming intergenerational wealth transfers. McKinsey & Co projects US\$5.8 trillion will move between UHNW and high-net-worth families in Asia-Pacific from 2023 to 2030, with 60 per cent coming from UHNW families.

"Servicing the next generation of clients effectively is critical in ensuring a smooth wealth transition," Ang adds.

UHNW clients are also increasingly working with external asset managers (EAMs).

While the EAM space in Asia and the Middle East is not as developed as in the West, it is "witnessing rapid growth", Ang observes, adding that the total assets under management in Singapore crossed S\$6 trillion in 2024, according to the Monetary Authority of Singapore, signalling the tremendous opportunity for EAMs to tap on.

There has also been a notable shift in investment preferences. "They are looking for highly curated opportunities, co-investment options, and often, solutions tailored to specific sector interests or geographic preferences," he says.

This includes private markets opportunities, which offer uncorrelated returns and portfolio diversification.

To meet these needs, the bank launched the Standard Chartered Private Markets Co-Investment Club earlier this year. The platform connects clients with established private equity managers who curate global co-investment opportunities.

Demand has been strong for private credit, infrastructure, technology, and health care – which are known for attractive yields, inflation protection, and long-term growth potential.

Sustainability is another rising priority. "We observe a growing number of our business owner clients seeking our advice and insights on sustainability to help future-proof their businesses," Ang notes.

The bank has committed to mobilise US\$300 billion of sustainable and transition finance by 2030, supported by over 150 frontline and subject matter sustainability experts.

Digital preferences are evolving too. “While many older generation UHNW clients value personal relationships and traditional service models, more are increasingly adopting the digital channel, alongside the younger UHNW clients who prioritise digital capabilities and seamless online experience,” says Ang.

Technology, therefore, remains central to the bank’s strategy. “Technology integrated with a human touch supports a higher level of client service by fostering a cohesive and integrated experience for our clients,” Ang says.

This ranges from secure messaging through WhatsApp and WeChat, to trading platforms that provide access to global markets, market insights, and seamless trade execution.

Standard Chartered is also using data and generative artificial intelligence tools to enable personalised insights and holistic client management at scale.

A trusted adviser, helping to prepare families for the future

Mike Tan, global head, wealth planning and family advisory at Standard Chartered Global Private Bank, points to the scale of the coming transition where wealth is expected to pass from one generation to the next.

Many UHNW families, he says, are not fully prepared – especially those with members across multiple jurisdictions and complex family dynamics.

“Without proper succession planning, these families leave their wealth vulnerable to uncertainty and potential disruption,” Tan says.

To address this, Standard Chartered works with external advisers to help clients establish resilient and flexible structures that reflect evolving tax and regulatory requirements. The bank also helps families set up family governance frameworks and communication platforms.

“It is important for family members to have a forum to communicate with one another, exchange ideas, align objectives, and preserve family values, beyond just managing family wealth,” says Tan.

A common challenge is the generational gap. “Family members in different generations grew up in a different environment and culture and probably had different educational journeys,” he notes.

These differences can lead to mismatched expectations around roles, responsibilities, and succession – compounded by taboos that delay open conversations about death and succession planning.

The bank encourages early engagement. In October, it will host the NextGen Forum in Dubai as part of its Global Families Network. “This one-day programme is specially curated for the next generation of family members and business leaders,” says Tan.

It will cover topics such as leadership, sustainability, and entrepreneurship, featuring younger family members who have launched new ventures or taken on pivotal roles in their family businesses.

The Global Families Network is an exclusive platform for UHNW families to exchange insights and experiences in a private setting. It aims to support clients outside of the formal planning cycle by fostering early engagement across multi-generational families, allowing them to address changing family needs and market cycles.

Philanthropy is also playing a larger role in legacy planning. “Philanthropic giving, as a tool for creating shared family values and building a legacy for UHNW families, plays a very significant role today,” says Tan.

Philanthropic donations in Asia hit US\$33 billion in 2024. Next-gen donors are expanding beyond education and health care to support causes such as climate change and social justice – with a strong focus on impact measurement. Families also want to collaborate with others to partner and work together on causes they are passionate about.

Some are also exploring tools such as blended finance and impact investing. Others contribute beyond money: volunteering time, mentoring, or joining boards of non-profit organisations. “For many, philanthropy can imbue the family’s legacy with purpose and achievement,” Tan adds.

Choosing the right giving structure – such as a donor-advised fund, charitable trust, or foundation – depends on goals, scale, and operational needs. Consolidating philanthropic giving into a single platform can help align family decision-making and build family cohesiveness.

Supporting families with a global presence and footprint is a core part of the bank's approach.

Its global wealth planning and family advisory team operates across Hong Kong, Singapore, Dubai, and London, sharing best practices, regulatory updates, and client case studies.

More families are also considering newer hubs such as Saudi Arabia and Indonesia, along with traditional centres like London, Switzerland, Hong Kong, and Singapore.

Family offices are increasingly being used not just for investment, but also for training next-gen members, supporting philanthropy, and implementing governance.

"As each family is unique and has diverse needs, the final structure or location selected by the family often reflects their unique circumstances," says Tan.

Relationship management is highly customised. "There is no one-size-fits-all solution," he notes. The bank often engages separately with different generations, operates on an open architecture platform, and connects families with a wide network of external professionals.

Crucially, Standard Chartered's wealth planning and family advisory team is not bound by sales targets. "Our advice-led model allows us to focus on the client, thereby building a long-term relationship," says Tan.

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HSBC defends wealth strategy as Swiss unit cuts Middle East clients

Paromita Dey
488 words
25 August 2025
Citywire Middle East
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HSBC is seeking to reassure clients and regulators alike that its Middle East and Swiss wealth businesses remain at the core of its global growth plans, even as the bank faces the delicate task of unwinding relationships with some of the Middle East's wealthiest clients.

The lender's head of international wealth and premier banking, Barry O'Byrne, has reaffirmed the group's commitment to growing its regional presence. He stressed that HSBC's strategy involves significant investment in its Middle Eastern business alongside its Swiss hub.

'We're proud to have been the first international bank in the Middle East, continue to have deep roots in the region and are fully committed to our customers who are at the heart of everything we do,' O'Byrne said in an emailed statement.

'Switzerland plays a key role in how we support clients globally – it's one of our core wealth hubs. Our strategy is to significantly grow our wealth business, and we have been doing so successfully. This strategy will see continued investment in both our Middle East and Swiss businesses to deliver best in class service to our customers,' he added.

The emphasis comes at a sensitive time with HSBC's Swiss **private bank** in the process of cutting ties with more than 1,000 clients from Saudi Arabia, Lebanon, Qatar and Egypt, as reported by Bloomberg. Many of those accounts hold assets exceeding CHF100m (\$124.5m).

The reshuffle is part of a wider strategy unveiled in October 2023, aimed at simplifying HSBC's operations and channelling resources into areas where it believes it has a competitive edge. For the Swiss unit, that has meant narrowing its focus, while offering departing clients the option to transfer their business to other jurisdictions within the bank.

Last month, financial watchdog Finma faulted HSBC's Swiss **private bank** for failing to conduct adequate due diligence on politically exposed persons and has restricted it from onboarding new such clients. The lender has also been drawn into a Swiss investigation into alleged money laundering linked to the former governor of Lebanon's central bank Riad Salameh, further intensifying scrutiny.

The decision to exit a swathe of Middle Eastern accounts comes at a moment when the region is drawing unprecedented interest from global wealth managers. Rivals including UBS, Julius Baer and Goldman Sachs have expanded their Gulf operations aggressively, capitalising on a surge in family offices and high-net-worth individuals.

HSBC has seen the exit of several senior bankers this year. Farzad Billimoria, who was the CEO and head of **private banking** business in the UAE for almost three decades, [departed the bank](#) in March for Barclays.

Basit Saiyed, who was the head of investments and wealth solutions, Menat, for HSBC's global **private banking** and wealth unit for four years, [joined](#) Abu Dhabi Islamic Bank (ADIB) in February.

Document CWIRME0020250826el8p00005

HSBC's Swiss unit culls wealthy Middle East clients amid regulator scrutiny

Laith Al-Khalaf in London

558 words

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Financial Times (FT.Com)

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English

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Watchdog previously barred bank from taking on high-risk customers over lax anti-money laundering checks

HSBC's Swiss **private bank** has launched a cull of more than 1,000 wealthy Middle Eastern clients, as it faces ongoing scrutiny from regulators over high-risk clients.

The bank will be terminating its relationship with a slew of customers from countries such as Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Lebanon and Egypt — many of whom have assets of more than \$100mn — according to people familiar with the matter.

HSBC's Swiss **private bank** has informed affected clients that they will no longer be able to use its services and will be sending out letters advising them to move their accounts elsewhere in the coming months, one of the people said.

Barry O'Byrne, chief executive of HSBC's International Wealth and Premier Banking unit, said the bank had an "absolute commitment to both our Middle East and Swiss Wealth businesses".

He added: "Switzerland plays a key role in how we support clients globally — it's one of our core wealth hubs. Our strategy is to significantly grow our Wealth business and we have been doing so successfully. This strategy will see continued investment in both our Middle East and Swiss businesses to deliver best in class service to our customers."

The changes, which were first reported by Bloomberg News, come amid an ongoing crackdown by the Swiss banking watchdog, Finma, on HSBC for its vetting procedures of some high-risk clients.

In 2024, HSBC's Swiss **private bank** was barred from taking on prominent public figures as clients after Finma found that the bank had breached anti-money laundering legislation. The regulator found that HSBC had not undertaken the appropriate due diligence for multiple transactions between 2002 and 2015 in which more than \$300mn was transferred between Lebanon and Switzerland.

The watchdog found that HSBC had "failed to recognise the indications of money laundering presented by these transactions; it likewise failed to satisfy requirements for the initiation and continuation of customer relationships with politically exposed persons, and was thus in serious breach of its due diligence obligations".

Finma ordered HSBC to undertake an anti-money laundering review for all its high-risk relationships with prominent public clients, known as politically exposed persons (PEPs). Finma said the bank could not start new relationships with PEPs until it had completed its review.

The bank designates clients with more than SFr100mn (\$124.7mn) as being "high risk" and requiring greater due diligence. A client's risk rating also takes into account other factors, including nationality.

HSBC revealed last month that authorities in France and Switzerland were investigating it "in connection with alleged money laundering offences in respect of two historical banking relationships".

As HSBC is forced to cut back its client list, rivals are bolstering their **wealth management** teams in the Middle East to service the needs of ultra-high net worth individuals.

While HSBC has long dominated the region's capital market activity, it has lagged behind in **private banking**, and has seen the exit of several senior bankers in the division. Its Swiss unit hired Aladdin Hangari, who was a senior **wealth manager** at Credit Suisse, in 2023, to increase its **wealth management** presence in the Middle East.

Document FTCMA00020250824e18o000p1

Standard Chartered eyes affluent growth via digital wealth-lending and global network

Paromita Dey

838 words

21 August 2025

Citywire Middle East

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English

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Standard Chartered is sharpening its affluent and wealth management strategy by combining its global network, digital platforms and bespoke wealth solutions.

With affluent clients in the UAE and beyond seeking global connectivity and tailored solutions, the bank is positioning itself to capture the next wave of growth.

Ayesha Abbas, who oversees affluent and wealth solutions for Europe, the Middle East, Africa and Pakistan, said the bank's approach is anchored in understanding clients' goals and shaping solutions around them, supported by experienced relationship managers and specialist teams.

'We first understand the client's existing needs — we don't create them,' Abbas said. 'We assess their time horizon and attitude to risk, understand their goals, present solutions to them, and from there they select the portfolio that works best for them.'

Evolving client needs

According to Abbas, wealth lending, like other financial solutions, ranges from low to high risk and is matched to clients with the appropriate risk profile.

The solutions span from straightforward offerings for retail investors to more sophisticated structures that allow clients to seek returns and to unlock liquidity while diversifying across an array of underlying strategies across multiple jurisdictions. Such structures are generally reserved for accredited investors with higher net worth and greater investment experience.

For ultra-high-net-worth clients, typically \$10m and above, the focus is on bespoke strategies. These include discretionary portfolio mandates, legacy planning, wealth preservation and trust structures, with somewhat lesser emphasis on aggressive leverage.

In the segment just below that, however, Abbas sees more appetite for calculated risk. 'Often these are younger executives and professionals willing to explore more advanced strategies. While we encourage clients to explore global opportunities, we still recommend building a core portfolio aligned to long-term goals and risk appetite, making only tactical adjustments as markets evolve through periodic portfolio reviews.'

She added that risk appetite now also cuts across age groups and geographies. For example, South Asian clients often favour income-generating portfolios, regardless of their disposable income levels.

A major enabler for the bank's affluents and wealth management growth is digital innovation. Standard Chartered's mutual fund platform allows clients to apply for wealth lending entirely online, while still offering face-to-face and voice channels for those who prefer personal interaction.

'We've made it possible for clients to manage their wealth anywhere, anytime,' Abbas said. 'Clients can log in, view their full investment portfolio, and transact from anywhere. It's quick, easy, and seamless. However, we remain open and available for those who prefer in-person or phone conversations.'

This hybrid approach ensures flexibility and efficiency without losing the personal connections that many investors still value, she added.

What investors want now

Abbas said clients broadly fall into three categories: experienced investors who know exactly what they want, those who rely entirely or mostly on banker advice, and independent investors who track markets closely and use tools like online equities trading, ETFs backed by their selection of regular investment plans.

The common thread, she noted, is the need for consistent engagement, particularly in volatile markets. 'In April, during a period of turbulence, our CIO office worked with advisers and relationship managers to keep clients informed. This proactive communication approach created a sense of calm at a time of extreme uncertainty.'

Systematic investment strategies, once thought to be of lesser interest in the Middle East, are in fact gaining traction among our clients. Many clients are using them to plan for long-term goals such as their children's education or their retirement. The bank promotes these through webinars, seminars, and client discussions, emphasising their role in disciplined wealth building over the long term.

'Systematic investment plans within feeder funds help clients benefit from dollar-cost averaging, building a solid nest egg over time,' added Abbas.

What lies ahead

Standard Chartered is focused on offering comprehensive solutions that span cash management, home finance and wealth planning, alongside continued product development and client engagement.

AI will play a larger role in enabling relationship managers through data-driven insights and automated client reporting, but Abbas stressed that human interaction will remain central. 'Many clients still value personal relationships with their advisers, so we'll always maintain this balance.'

Another priority is cross-border connectivity. Standard Chartered's global footprint enables clients to connect their wealth between key hubs such as Hong Kong, Singapore, the UAE and Jersey.

'A UAE-based client might want to invest in Singapore because of business interests or property holdings there, or they may have children studying there,' Abbas explained. 'We help them plan and execute across jurisdictions. The choice of location is often about diversification, but the product selection, risk appetite, and time horizon remain specific to the individual client.'

With digital platforms gaining traction, feeder funds expanding their reach, and affluent clients increasingly seeking global diversification, Abbas believes Standard Chartered is well-positioned to capture the next wave of growth in wealth and retail banking.

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UOB Private Bank Next Gen Programme 2025: Empowering future UHNW business leaders in Oxford and London

Distributed by Contify.com

1,395 words

15 August 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* UOB **Private Bank**'s 2025 Next Gen Programme was held in Oxford and London, bringing together 20 participants from eight countries for a transformative week-long programme.

* The Programme focused on Artificial Intelligence in family-owned business to drive long-term sustainability, with participants engaging with successful family business leaders and AI experts on topics like AI-driven business decision making and AI ethics.

* The Programme also featured expert-led sessions on effective leadership, scaling family businesses, and responsible ownership practices, with a focus on preparing UHNW successors for their future responsibilities and challenges.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Aug. 15 -- UOB **Private Bank** issued the following news release:

- Held outside of Asia for the first time, this year's Programme placed strong emphasis on Artificial Intelligence in family-owned business to drive long-term sustainability

UOB **Private Bank** successfully concluded its 2025 Next Gen Programme, held from 3 to 9 August in Oxford and London, United Kingdom. Hosted outside of Asia for the first time, this year's Programme was held at the prestigious University of Oxford, bringing together 20 participants from eight countries.

UOB **Private Bank**'s Next Gen Programme is a transformative week-long programme designed to equip the next generation of Ultra-High-Net-Worth (UHNW) family business stewards with the necessary skills and mindsets as they inherit their family wealth. Now in its third consecutive international run, the Programme aims to prepare UHNW successors for their future responsibilities and challenges as custodians of legacy, structured with a focus on the themes of Entrepreneurship, Digital Innovation and Technology, balancing progressiveness with heritage.

Mr Chew Mun Yew, Head of UOB **Private Bank**, shared, "The hard work and commitment of family business leaders should be preserved and nurtured for generations to come. In the Asia Pacific region, up to USD 6 trillion worth of assets are expected to be transferred to the next generation by 2030, with financial hubs Singapore and Hong Kong being the key hubs facilitating these wealth flows.[1] Our award-winning Next Gen Programme empowers UHNW families to navigate the complexities of wealth transition with confidence, equipping next-generation leaders with knowledge and practical skills to manage, grow and preserve their family wealth across generations. We are grateful to the University of Oxford for hosting this inaugural Europe edition, which brings global perspectives and offers valuable networking opportunities for our young leaders."

Programme highlights: Integrating Artificial Intelligence and legacy; the Oxford experience and industry immersion

The 2025 Programme was thoughtfully designed with Artificial Intelligence (AI) related components interwoven throughout the agenda. More than a trending topic, AI now serves as a strategic lens for business leaders – interlinked with governance, investment decisions, and leadership evolution. Participants engaged with successful family business leaders and AI and tech experts on topics like:

* leveraging AI and data analytics to drive business decision making;

- * integrating AI into **wealth management**;

- * navigating AI ethics; and

- * leading effectively in a tech-driven future.

This emphasis on AI and technology reflects the growing imperative for next-generation leaders to harness AI for innovation, resilience and long-term value creation for their family businesses.

This year's Programme also featured expert-led sessions, delving into areas such as effective leadership within multigenerational business, strategies to scale the impact of family businesses and unlocking the complexities of family business dynamics and governance.

The Ownership Project 2.0: Private Capital Owners & Impact at the University of Oxford's Saïd Business School added further depth to the 2025 Programme. Helmed by Dr Bridget Kustin, Director of this global research initiative, the session was anchored upon research on private capital ownership and family business impact. Discussions explored responsible ownership practices and strategies to identify unique impact potential, and the real challenges of stewarding family wealth across generations.

Dr Bridget Kustin shared, "Family enterprise is a backbone of global business activity. Family owners' inherent interest in legacy, community, and intergenerational time frames for value creation favour responsible ownership. I'm grateful that financial institutions like UOB are recognising the need to support the next generation of responsible family owners through educational programmes that can challenge and inspire. In translating our global family business research data and theory into actionable insights for Programme participants, we equip them with the skills and mindsets needed to navigate this quickly changing world."

This year participants also had the opportunity to experience the academic and cultural heritage of Oxford, staying at St Edmund Hall and engaging with leading minds at Saïd Business School, Magdalen College, and Balliol College. They also enjoyed a series of industry immersion experiences to broaden their global perspective, including a visit to UK's top-ranked startup hub at Founders Factory, along with other iconic cultural locations.

Mr Lim, one of this year's participants, shared, "From exploring the applications of AI to reflecting on family business stewardship and gaining strategic insights at Macfarlanes on private and family wealth, the programme was a masterclass in technology and next-generation leadership. Engaging with peers from diverse family business backgrounds, against the inspiring settings of Oxford and London, provided fresh perspectives and meaningful lifelong connections I hope to carry forward."

Award-winning Next Gen Programme in its fifth run since 2020

Launched in Singapore in 2020, UOB **Private Bank**'s Next Gen Programme was created to cater to the growing need among UHNW clients to equip the next generation with essential **wealth management** competencies to protect their family legacies. With its strong ASEAN footprint and proven expertise in **wealth management**, UOB **Private Bank** is well positioned to engage early with next-generation leaders early, not only as a knowledge partner, but also as a conduit for seamless intergenerational wealth transitions.

UOB **Private Bank**'s Next Gen Programme is differentiated by its partnerships with renowned academic providers and industry experts. These provide global business insights and perspectives, empowering next-generation leaders with the skills, knowledge and outlook needed to grow and sustain their family business in a rapidly changing world.

The Programme also offers a platform for participants to build their network with like-minded leaders. To drive long-term engagement, participants are enrolled into an alumni network comprising UOB **Private Bank**'s leadership team, industry professionals, mentors and peers. Currently more than 50 alumni strong, this peer network facilitates a continuous exchange of ideas, experience and strategies among the next-generation of leaders, with UOB **Private Bank** providing support through advisory services and tailored **wealth management** solutions.

UOB **Private Bank** is committed to securing the long-term interest of its clients, remaining steadfast in its dedication to supporting Asian UHNW families in their intergenerational wealth transfer planning.

About UOB

UOB is a leading bank in Asia. Operating through its head office in Singapore and banking subsidiaries in China, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand and Vietnam, UOB has a global network of more than 470 branches and offices in

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19 markets in Asia Pacific, Europe and North America. Since its incorporation in 1935, UOB has grown organically and through a series of strategic acquisitions. Today, UOB is rated among the world's top banks: Aa1 by Moody's Investors Service and AA- by both S&P Global Ratings and Fitch Ratings.

For nine decades, UOB has adopted a customer-centric approach to create long-term value by staying relevant through its enterprising spirit and doing right by its customers. UOB is focused on building the future of ASEAN – for the people and businesses within, and connecting with, ASEAN.

The Bank connects businesses to opportunities in the region with its unparalleled regional footprint and leverages data and insights to innovate and create personalised banking experiences and solutions catering to each customer's unique needs and evolving preferences. UOB is also committed to help businesses forge a sustainable future, by fostering social inclusiveness, creating positive environmental impact and pursuing economic progress. UOB believes in being a responsible financial services provider and is steadfast in its support of art, social development of children and education, doing right by its communities and stakeholders.

For media queries, please contact media@uobgroup.com

Footnote:

[1]
<https://www.mckinsey.com/industries/financial-services/our-insights/asia-pacifics-family-office-boom-opportunity-knocks>

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Education, Artificial Intelligence, ESG]

Source: UOB **Private Bank**

Document ATINBK0020250818e18f000jj

Swiss crypto bank taps ex-StanChart global PB head to lead Asia

Cheryl Heng

259 words

14 August 2025

Citywire Asia

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English

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Swiss-regulated crypto bank Amina Bank has tapped a former global head of private banking at Standard Chartered to lead its Hong Kong and Apac operations.

Taking on the new role is Michael Benz, who has over three decades of Asian **wealth management** experience, according to a 13 August release.

His prior roles include CEO of Merrill Lynch **Wealth Management** Asia and product and services head at UBS **Wealth Management** Apac.

'Michael's expertise in both traditional finance and crypto makes him the ideal leader to continue our expansion across Asia,' said Amina CEO Franz Bergmueller. He said Benz's network and understanding of client needs helps evolve the firm's crypto products and capabilities.

The appointment follows a standout year for the Swiss-based bank, which saw revenues climb 69% in 2024 to reach \$40.4m.

With Benz's appointment, the bank will accelerate its expansion of crypto banking services. Amina plans to roll out enhanced technology platforms in the second half of 2025 while forging new strategic partnerships in Hong Kong.

Hong Kong's rapidly evolving regulatory landscape makes the timing particularly strategic.

Recent developments, including the Securities and Futures Commission's ASPIRe roadmap for tokenised securities, the Hong Kong Monetary Authority's newly implemented stablecoin licensing framework, and the government's Digital Asset Policy 2.0 initiative, create opportunities for institutional crypto banking services.

Founded in 2018, Amina holds licenses from Switzerland's Finma, Abu Dhabi's FSRA, and Hong Kong's SFC.

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Supplement 1

OCBC Group: Greater than the sum of its parts

1,227 words

6 August 2025

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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MORE than nine decades after three struggling banks merged for survival in the Great Depression, OCBC Group has honed the art of being greater than the sum of its parts. This, and its long-standing presence in Asia's most dynamic markets, drives its "One Group" push today.

That is the heart of OCBC's corporate strategy, refreshed in 2022, which focuses on capturing ASEAN-Greater China trade and investment flows and rising Asian wealth -- trends OCBC expects will continue for years to come. The payoff is clear: 2024 marked the group's third consecutive year of record earnings, which hit S\$7.59 billion.

It is testament to the group being in the right place, at the right time, with the right approach to capture opportunities by working as One Group.

Deep Asean-Greater China roots

And where it is today is the result of a Greater China and Asean network built up over decades, with roots in key markets that predate its own 1932 founding.

Three Hokkien banks in Singapore -- Chinese Commercial Bank, Ho Hong Bank and Oversea-Chinese Bank -- merged to form OCBC when their 1920s prosperity crumbled due to plummeting rubber prices and foreign exchange losses. But they had expanded regionally by then.

Hence, when OCBC opened its Chulia Street doors in 1933, it did so as the Straits Settlement's strongest and largest local bank -- with 17 branches across Malaya, the Dutch Indies, China and Hong Kong.

In Singapore, OCBC expanded from commercial banking to develop expertise in investment banking, fund management, and the fiercely competitive retail banking space. From financing post-war rebuilding and rapid industrialisation to Singapore's rise as a financial services hub, OCBC was there.

OCBC pioneered local banking innovations too -- from Singapore's first "mobile bank" bussing into suburbs in 1958, to the first 24-hour cash withdrawal ATM in the 1980s, and in the last decade, biometric authentication and a full suite of cross-border mobile payments.

In Malaysia, branches opened in Penang, Muar and Malacca in 1917 laid the foundations for OCBC Malaysia's 1994 incorporation and OCBC Al-Amin's 2008 establishment as the first Singapore-based Islamic bank in Malaysia.

In Indonesia, OCBC -- which has had a Sumatra branch since the 1920s -- was the first Singapore bank to acquire an Indonesian banking stake. It now holds 85 per cent of Bank NISP, while its 2024 acquisition of PT Bank Commonwealth extends its **wealth management** presence.

On mainland China, OCBC has had an uninterrupted 100-year presence since opening a branch in Xiamen in 1925. As at March 31, 2025, OCBC China operates 15 branches across 14 mainland cities.

Positioned to follow flows

With over 340 branches and representative offices in Asean and over 50 in Greater China, the group is poised to effectively capture today's trade and investment flows.

Asean and China were each other's largest trading partner for a fifth consecutive year in 2024, with bilateral trade in goods exceeding US\$980 billion. Amid an uncertain US tariff regime and ongoing supply chain shifts, Asean continues to attract foreign direct investment.

Chinese companies are moving from "China-plus-one" to "China-plus-n" strategies, simultaneously investing across multiple Asean markets, group chief executive Helen Wong noted in OCBC's 2024 annual report. They target Vietnam for general manufacturing, Malaysia for advanced manufacturing, and Indonesia for its large population and natural resources.

This key customer segment -- Chinese companies expanding into Asean -- grew nearly 30 per cent year-on-year in 2024. They are served by OCBC's twin hubs: its Singapore headquarters finance and manage regional investments, while Hong Kong serves as a first stop for Chinese fundraising.

Strategic, integrated advantage

OCBC Group today spans six commercial banks across key growth markets (Singapore, Malaysia, Indonesia, mainland China, Hong Kong and Macau), Islamic bank OCBC Al-Amin, regional private bank Bank of Singapore, South-east Asian asset manager Lion Global Investors, securities house OCBC Securities and leasing unit Pac Lease. It also owns a large part of Great Eastern Holdings (GEH), the oldest and most established life insurance group in Singapore and Malaysia. In addition, the group holds the maximum permissible 20 per cent stake in associate Bank of Ningbo, one of China's 20 systemically important banks.

OCBC's international network in Europe, Australia and the US is equally important as it supports corporate customers seeking new markets and establishes a presence in global financial markets.

Operating as a comprehensive financial services group thus differentiates OCBC from bank-only players in the region.

Under Wong's leadership, OCBC has emphasised a One Group approach to drive synergy by leveraging the collective strengths of the OCBC franchise and offering customers a holistic solution across the OCBC network. "This composition and synergistic nature of OCBC Group is not easily replicated. It is the result of deliberate, strategic moves over decades," said Wong in the annual report.

Its **wealth management** franchise exemplifies this. OCBC's 2010 acquisition of ING Asia Private Bank created Bank of Singapore, enabling seamless customer progression from consumer banking through Premier Banking and Premier Private Client to ultra-high net worth services.

Combined assets under management from OCBC Bank, Bank of Singapore and Great Eastern Holdings now position the group among the region's largest **wealth managers** too.

Great Eastern represents another strategic integration. The relationship, which dates to the 1950s, deepened in 1992 when Great Eastern became the first insurer to be an exclusive bancassurance partner of OCBC. Over the years, this relationship has become more tightly woven.

With this strong relationship comes synergies which would enable OCBC to offer a comprehensive suite of banking, wealth, health, and protection products to both customer bases. In Singapore, 70 per cent of Great Eastern customers hold OCBC products, while 30 per cent of OCBC customers hold a Great Eastern policy.

OCBC's long-standing conviction has thus been that more can be achieved with Great Eastern as a close-knit part of the group.

Singapore's heritage bank

The year Singapore gained independence, 1965, was also when Lee Kong Chian -- OCBC's chairman since World War II's end -- retired after leading OCBC through Singapore's post-war rebuilding as it grew into a leading regional financial institution.

So quickly did the bank outgrow its distinctive China Building that by 1970 it was demolished to make way for new headquarters. OCBC Centre -- built on the same enlarged plot of land -- was Singapore's first building by renowned architect I.M. Pei. Completed in 1976 as South-east Asia's tallest building, it is now a National Heritage Board historic site.

Today, six stained-glass panels preserved from the old China Building overlook the main hall's ATMs -- three depict commerce, industry and farming, and three show scenes from the bank's early history. Their preservation speaks of how the founders' vision of OCBC as a pillar of society -- one that thrives when society is served and enriched -- lives on.

"While we must move quickly with our transformation efforts, I would like to emphasise the importance of having our purpose and values at the heart of every decision. That is non-negotiable," Wong said in the 2024 annual report. "We have and will always put our customers, community and shareholders first."

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HSBC Hong Kong desk head joins JP Morgan **Private Bank**

James Phillipps

173 words

5 August 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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JP Morgan has recruited an HSBC desk head to bolster its Hong Kong team.

Ryan Mak, who spent more than 12 years at HSBC **Private Banking**, joined the Wall Street bank as an executive director, according to his 5 August LinkedIn update.

Prior to being a desk head, a role Mak held for over a year, he was an investment counsellor team head. Before HSBC he had a five-year stint at Standard Chartered Bank as a relationship manager.

JP Morgan **Private Bank** has been approached for comment.

The US giant has seen a bit of turnover this year, with its head of 23 Wall for Southeast Asia, Kola Luu, joining Goldman Sachs [last month](#). JPM's vice chair for Asia, May Hsu, [also exited](#), moving to J Safra Sarasin, along with senior colleagues Ng Guo Quan and Lawrence Lee.

JPM also hired a [China banker](#) for its Hong Kong team, with Xi Shi joining from Wayne Bowers to cover ultra-high net worth client.

Document CWIRAS0020250805e18500001



Business

Standard Chartered to launch digital platform aimed at tech-savvy, young investors

Enoch Yiu

735 words

4 August 2025

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English

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The digital platform is part of the lender's planned US\$1.5 billion investment in the **wealth management** business over the next five years

Standard Chartered, one of Hong Kong's three note-issuing banks, will this month launch a digital platform for tech-savvy young investors as part of the lender's effort to attract affluent customers, according to its Hong Kong chief.

The platform would allow investors to carry out investment research and trade a range of products such as stocks, funds and other alternative assets, Mary Huen Wai-yi, the bank's CEO of Hong Kong, Greater China and North Asia, said in a media briefing on Friday.

"Traditionally, many wealthy customers like to talk to bankers or relationship managers about their investments. But the new generation of investors may prefer to trade on a digital platform by themselves," Huen said.

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"This is why we believe a new digital platform would help us attract a new group of mass and premium clients who have the potential to become our private banking clients in future."

The new platform was part of the lender's planned US\$1.5 billion investment in the **wealth management** business over the next five years, with Hong Kong to be the focus of the expansion, [group CEO Bill Winters told the Post in February](#).

The bank will also open its sixth **wealth management** centre in Hong Kong this year, after opening two such centres in Taiwan and three on the mainland in recent years. These have been effective in attracting wealthy customers to establish long-term relationships with the bank, Huen said.

Affluent **wealth management** is a key global growth engine for Standard Chartered, which last Thursday reported its first-half net profit rose 41 per cent to US\$3.07 billion.

Hong Kong figures prominently in the bank's growth plan. Underlying pre-tax profit in the city for the first half jumped 39 per cent to a record US\$1.45 billion, representing 30 per cent of the total, making Hong Kong the lender's biggest market.

This was driven by an 8 per cent growth in the number of affluent clients who had more than HK\$200,000 (US\$25,477) deposited with the bank in the first half, with net new money from these clients jumping 35 per cent, Huen said.

With the expected US interest rate cut in the second half and the low Hong Kong interbank rate – with the one-month Hibor below 1 per cent – Huen said banks' interest income would be affected.

"Increased fee income in the second half would be able to offset the impact of the low interest rate," she said.

The equities market has bounced back, with the Hang Seng Index rising more than 20 per cent so far in 2025, on top of an 18 per cent rise last year, which has encouraged investors to become more active.

"The improved sentiment also helps corporate clients feel more comfortable borrowing money to expand. I believe we can see single digit growth in loans this year," she said.

Standard Chartered's Hong Kong unit has seen a 79 per cent expansion of credit impairment to US\$168 million, including US\$58 million related to commercial real estate in the city.

Huen said its lending for commercial real estate was US\$2.1 billion, representing only 2 per cent of its US\$86.6 billion loan book in Hong Kong.

"I do not think we need to worry as our exposure to commercial real estate is low, while most lending is very healthy," she said.

Standard Chartered will continue to support its Hong Kong corporate clients in expanding overseas and conducting cross-border trade businesses, Huen added. Its bankers will lead clients on visits to Southeast Asian markets and the Middle East in the coming months to explore new opportunities.

"Amid the threat of [high US tariffs], we have seen many Hong Kong customers wanting to set up product plants in other Asian cities or to sell products in these markets," Huen said.

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MINT, Money

How Standard Chartered's Saurabh Jain has built wealth with mutual funds, EPF

Neil Borate, Jash Kriplani

1,065 words

3 August 2025

Mint

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English

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New Delhi, Aug. 3 -- Saurabh Jain, 48, managing director and Head - Wealth Management and Affluent Client Segments at Standard Chartered Bank, has spent over two decades in banking. Despite managing complex investment products and strategies professionally, Jain keeps his personal investing approach simple.

All his equity investments are in publicly listed, open-ended instruments. He avoids sectoral, thematic, or style-based bets. His portfolio comprises 8-10 mutual fund schemes diversified across categories and market capitalizations, left untouched for years to compound tax-free. He has also strategically maxed out Employees Provident Fund (EPF) and Public Provident Fund (PPF) contributions in the past.

In an interview with Mint, Jain shares his investment journey and philosophy. Edited excerpts:

My father was extremely organized with his personal finances. He maintained a file for every financial year, with neatly arranged records going back decades. He updated them methodically every week. When he passed in January 2022, his files were up to date till December 2021.

Another incident had a lasting impact. As a child, I once bought fruit and told the vendor I'd pay later. My father was furious and told me never to borrow. He taught me: "jitni chaadar ho utna hi pair pasaro"-live within your means and avoid leverage.

I started as a management trainee with ITC Ltd in Kolkata in 2000, then moved to Citi in 2003. In the early years, I had minimal expenses as I lived with my parents, so I had a decent investible surplus. Still, I only began investing in equities in 2005. In hindsight, I should have started earlier.

It's split into 63% equity, 35% debt, and 2% cash. Within equity, 82% is in mutual funds and 18% in direct stocks. Most of the debt exposure is in EPF, with some in PPF and Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana for my daughter.

I hold 8-10 actively managed diversified equity mutual funds-no thematic or sectoral funds, as they don't align with my buy-and-hold strategy. I believe "time in the market" matters more than timing it. I rarely reshuffle my portfolio, and annual churn is less than 5%.

My investing approach is simple, and I avoid hybrid products because I do my own asset allocation.

A large part of my debt investments are in EPF, with the remaining in PPF. I have let both my EPF and PPF compound over 25 years uninterrupted. The 8.25% tax-free rate of interest in EPF is attractive. I have even maxed out EPF in some years, i.e. contributed 88% of basic to EPF in 2020. These debt investments are all illiquid, but for liquidity purposes I have a large equity buffer.

Yes. I bought a house in 2010 in Bengaluru. At that point, rental yield was 6.5% and the home loan interest rate was 8.5%. So, it was an attractive deal. But I sold it along with another house and booked capital loss due to indexation benefit. I used this loss for tax-saving by off-setting gains on some of my equity investments.

In 2021, I bought another property in Mumbai, which I now use as my primary residence. Don't have any outstanding home loan right now. There is a home loan overdraft (OD) I have kept active, but since I've parked the entire principal in the account, for all practical purposes it is paid off.

My equity portfolio has delivered 17-18% CAGR over nearly 20 years.

I plan to retire at 55. I'm currently 48. I am targeting 40-times my annual expenses as retirement cover. I am close to it at present. I am not including my daughter's education goal in this, which is ongoing right now. I have already provided separately for this. People consider 25-times cover, but that's not enough for me. I would rather be more conservative on my retirement cover.

Broadly four things - 1) Disciplined investing - I have invested systematically in equities through SIPs (systematic investment plans) for 20 years now. 2) I generally add more to equities when the stock market dips. I don't always get it right, but overall this has helped me improve my returns. For example, I added equities when markets corrected during the 2008 global financial crisis and more recently in 2020 amid Covid-19 crash. 3) Staying for the long-term is another strategy that has worked for me. During the global financial crisis, my initial investments tanked, but staying invested and buying further on dips boosted my returns. I stayed put for the long-term and the markets eventually recovered. 4) All through my career, I have had a high savings rate typically in excess of 30%. My focus is on what I can control than the returns.

The biggest learning has been the power of compounding and how it kicks in, in the later years. In my 25-year investing journey, the last five years have seen my portfolio triple.

The other strategy, which is not necessarily related to investing, but I have used is keeping a home overdraft facility. I have not withdrawn anything from it, but I have kept it active, just in case I need it. Will keep it active for a few more years as it acts as an emergency cash pool I can dip into anytime.

I have life insurance cover of Rs.3 crore, which will continue till I am 60. Apart from this, I have a health cover of Rs.50 lakh and super top-up of Rs.1 crore. This is over and above the employer health cover.

Reits (real estate investment trusts) and Invits (infrastructure investment trusts) as the yields seem attractive there and offers significant portfolio diversification. I would also like to increase my global allocation. Invest in equities listed on foreign exchanges as the mutual fund route for foreign equities has largely been closed.

Not yet.

My daughter's education in the UK is ongoing, and I've already set aside funds. Later in life, I'd like to travel more.

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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

Finance

Markets

Hong Kong Property Downturn Stings HSBC; Higher expenses, a large write down and an investigation into money-laundering allegations also weigh on the bank

By Joe Wallace and Kosaku Narioka

737 words

30 July 2025

19:56

The Wall Street Journal Online

WSJO

English

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LONDON—Since Georges Elhedery [became chief executive](#) of HSBC last fall, investors have mostly cheered his efforts to streamline Europe's biggest bank by assets.

They weren't so pleased with the quarterly results HSBC published Wednesday, thanks in part to a downturn in Hong Kong's commercial property market. [Shares fell](#) more than 4% in London, having previously risen 45% since Elhedery took over.

The bank, which is based in London but was founded in Hong Kong and makes most of its money in Asia, booked a charge of \$1.1 billion tied to expected loan losses. That is up by about \$700 million from the second quarter of 2024.

Higher expenses, attributed to Elhedery's

[organizational revamp](#), were another drag on earnings. So was a \$2.1 billion paper [loss against HSBC's stake](#) in China's Bank of Communications .

Another blot: HSBC disclosed that Swiss and French law-enforcement agencies were investigating its **private bank** over allegations of money-laundering offenses.

[Trouble in Hong Kong's office market](#) continues to hurt the lender. In recent years, high interest rates and China's economic slowdown have weighed on property prices in the city, which are some of the world's most expensive.

Elhedery said efforts by the Hong Kong government had stabilized the residential market, but that office rents and prices were under pressure from oversupply.

The borrowers HSBC worries about are "substandard or credit-impaired," Elhedery said, adding that they account for less than 5% of HSBC's exposure to Hong Kong real estate. The bank has already earmarked losses of about \$500 million on loans of under \$1.5 billion, limiting further bad news.

Much of HSBC's lending in Hong Kong is to strong developers that are part of conglomerates with cash streams from different businesses, said Chief Financial Officer Pam Kaur.

The charge pinched HSBC's pretax profit, which fell 29% from a year earlier to \$6.3 billion in the second quarter. After tax, profit fell short of analysts' forecasts compiled by Visible Alpha.

Elhedery said he was encouraged by recent trade deals but that it may take time for clients who paused investment decisions after [President Trump's tariff announcements](#) in April to spring into action. HSBC is a major financier of global trade.

On Wednesday, HSBC wrote down its valuation on its stake in Shanghai-based Bank of Communications. In recent years, a gap opened between HSBC's valuation of the shareholding and the lower value implied by BoCom's stock price.

Combined with a dilution of its stake following BoCom's recapitalization by the Chinese government, that led to a loss of \$2.1 billion.

"These are paper losses. They are not actual losses," Elhedery said, adding that they didn't affect the bank's capital levels or its ability to pay dividends or buy back shares.

Elhedery has pushed the bank to focus on its strengths: retail banking in the U.K. and Hong Kong, acting as a bridge for large companies to global markets and helping wealthy clients with their finances.

Despite the drop in profits, Wednesday's results showed progress toward those objectives, said Citigroup analyst Andrew Coombs. HSBC said it would buy back \$3 billion more of its shares to return money to shareholders. The performance of the wealth-management and **private-banking** division was particularly strong, he said.

Even so, the bank's quarterly report carried a reminder of the risks of serving the world's rich at a time of proliferating sanctions and scrutiny by Western authorities of lenders' work with "politically exposed persons."

HSBC said the investigations in Switzerland and France related to two historical banking relationships, and that the probes were at an early stage. Last year, Switzerland's financial regulator said HSBC had conducted two high-risk relationships without carrying out adequate checks. It said they involved moving hundreds of millions of dollars from Lebanon to Switzerland and back again from 2002 to 2015.

The regulator ordered HSBC's Swiss **private bank** not to do any new business with PEPs until it had reviewed its money-laundering controls.

Write to Joe Wallace at joe.wallace@wsj.com and Kosaku Narioka at kosaku.narioka@wsj.com

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Exclusive: Former UBS GWM Indonesia banker to resurface at HSBC

Priyanka Boghani

178 words

29 July 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A former UBS Global Wealth Management Indonesia banker is slated to join HSBC Global Private Banking, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Edy Panggabean will join the growing ranks of HSBC GPB's SEA team, which has seen plenty of movement recently. Citywire Asia understands he will be working under Urban Bingelli, and Hammad Hashmi, the bank's market head for Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore.

A spokesperson from HSBC declined to comment on the hire.

Panggabean left UBS GWM after almost two decades with Credit Suisse and UBS GWM combined. He also worked at Citigroup for four years, according to his LinkedIn page.

The news comes as HSBC GPB announced its [hiring spree](#) for the Southeast Asia region, with seven appointments that included Leonard Eggert onboarded as a relationship manager for its Indonesia team.

'We're continuing to build momentum across Southeast Asia by investing in top talent and deepening our cross-border capabilities,' Tommy Leung, head of HSBC GPB, South Asia, said at the time of the appointments.

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Business Times Breaking News

Banking & Finance

DBS, OCBC, UOB Q2 results likely to be weighed down by lower interest rates

Tan Nai Lun

759 words

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But loan growth and recovery in **wealth management** activity could buffer declines, with trading income possibly surprising on the upside: analysts

[SINGAPORE] The trio of local banks will likely post weaker results for the second quarter of 2025, weighed down by lower net interest income from falling interest rates, analysts said.

They are expected to post their Q2 financials next month, beginning with OCBC on Aug 1 and followed by DBS and UOB on Aug 7.

Net interest margins (NIMs) will probably be “materially lower” in Q2, said Thilan Wickramasinghe, head of research and regional financials at Maybank Securities Singapore.

He noted that the Singapore Overnight Rate Average (Sora) was down 50 basis points – due to “massive” domestic liquidity, partly because of safe haven inflows – while the Hong Kong Interbank Offered Rate (Hibor) was at its lowest since 2022.

The Sora decline provided only partial relief in funding costs, as banks “weigh off preserving market share”, he said.

DBS Group Research analyst Lim Rui Wen also expects NIMs to fall quarter on quarter by a high single digit, due to the lower Sora and Hibor.

The rates’ impact will likely be more pronounced as more loans get repriced against reduced benchmark rates throughout Q2, she added.

However, she noted that OCBC’s and UOB’s repricing of their fixed-deposit and flagship deposit account interest rates should buffer falling asset yields in subsequent quarters.

Wickramasinghe also pointed out that loan growth was better than expected in Q2, probably due to front-loading demand ahead of the expiry of US President Donald Trump’s tariff moratorium.

While this may partially offset downsides in net interest income, it is unlikely to arrest sequential decline, the researcher said.

Trump impact

Analysts also said that Trump’s “Liberation Day” tariffs in April likely weighed on market sentiment, impacting **wealth management** fees in turn.

Tay Wee Kuang, an analyst at CGS International, said that macroeconomic uncertainty could continue to dampen fee income in the second half of the year, despite equity market sentiment having slowly recovered.

Nevertheless, Lim of DBS expects **wealth management** income to remain a tailwind for Singapore banks in the medium term, as **wealth management** activity began recovering in May.

This is also supported by ongoing growth in assets under management (AUM), she said. “The investible portion of AUM is expected, as clients reallocated funds from fixed-deposit rates and (treasury-bill) rates, which continue to see declining rates through Q2.”

Wickramasinghe likewise expects sequential improvements in **wealth management** fees, given falling domestic benchmark rates and risk-on market conditions.

He added that significant volatility around foreign exchange, trade and interest rates would likely have supported trading income in Q2, which could surprise on the upside, especially for DBS and UOB.

Higher credit costs

Meanwhile, the three banks' credit costs could trend towards the higher end of their respective 2025 guidance, due to weakness across Asean economies such as Thailand and Indonesia, said Tay.

"However, we do not expect total credit costs to change drastically quarter on quarter, as we believe the pre-emptive general provisions recognised by the Singapore banks in Q1 should remain sufficient amid the current credit cycle," he added.

Ongoing reviews of second-order impacts from the US tariffs may also lead the banks to maintain or increase their general provision buffers, said Lim. Therefore, general provisions write-backs are unlikely this year, she noted.

CGS International and Maybank Securities kept their "neutral" call on the Singapore banking sector, with Tay noting that the lenders lack growth catalysts in an uncertain economic outlook.

The analysts expect UOB to restore its guidance for 2025, which it had suspended in Q1.

They are also awaiting more clarity from OCBC on its strategy, following its failed bid to privatise its insurance arm, Great Eastern. Clarity around returns may also take longer to resolve due to the lender's "unexpected leadership change", Wickramasinghe said.

But Lim, who has "hold" calls on OCBC and UOB, expects the banks' dividend yields of up to 6.5 per cent to continue supporting share prices.

"As asset quality remains largely benign, and dividend yields stay attractive, comparable to Singapore real estate investment trusts, we expect share prices to remain well-supported in a low interest-rate environment and due to the safe haven appeal of the Singapore dollar," she said.

Ongoing share buyback programmes across the local banks should also translate to meaningful returns for shareholders, she added.

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Business

Sales of new life policies hit record high in first quarter

Enoch Yiu

573 words

26 July 2025

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Life insurance sales in Hong Kong rose 43 per cent in the first quarter to a record high on demand for protection and estate planning from high-net-worth customers and visitors from the mainland, as the city seeks to become a wealth management hub to rival global leaders such as Switzerland.

The industry wrote HK\$93.4 billion worth of new life policies, up from HK\$65.3 billion a year earlier, the Insurance Authority said yesterday. It was the highest first-quarter sales tally since the regulator was established in 2016.

Hong Kong insurers had a record year in 2024, with a 21.4 per cent jump in sales to HK\$219.8 billion, courtesy of a world-record policy sold by HSBC Life.

"Hong Kong's insurance industry continued its strong momentum in early 2025, supported by sustained demand for savings, health and protection products from both local customers and mainland Chinese visitors," said Patrick Graham, CEO of Manulife Hong Kong and Macau.

The regulator has yet to reveal data on policy sales to mainland visitors, having earlier decided to release it after a review about disclosures of non-local buyers.

Mainland visitors are a big source of clients for Hong Kong insurers, with some turning their trips into investment missions to hedge against yuan depreciation.

The number of mainland visitors rose 6.3 per cent in the first quarter to 9.3 million from a year earlier, according to the Tourism Board, representing 76 per cent of all tourist arrivals.

HSBC Life maintained its market leadership with more than HK\$20 billion of new business premiums during the quarter, giving it a 21.5 per cent market share, according to the Insurance Authority.

"We continue to see an increasing appetite for insurance from the high-net-worth segment this year," said Daisy Tsang, CEO for Hong Kong and Macau at HSBC Life.

"Clients are looking for more comprehensive, multifaceted solutions like life insurance", which were effective tools for risk management and intergenerational wealth transfers, she added.

Insurance executives are positive about the outlook amid sustained demand from mainland visitors. The city's ageing population is also helping boost the "silver economy", prompting HSBC, Manulife, BOC Life and others to step up retirement products with regular payout features.

Manulife also saw strong first-quarter growth, with sales more than doubling, according to its results for the period.

The insurer had enhanced its support for high-net-worth clients by setting up a team for them, while also forming more partnerships to provide cross-border medical services in the Greater Bay Area, Graham said.

BOC Life CEO Wilson Tang said his company reported strong growth, thanks to life and retirement products.

"BOC Life will continue to offer insurance, retirement and medical products to capture opportunities from the silver economy and the development of the Greater Bay Area," he said.

In November, the company unveiled a programme under which its Hong Kong customers could use the value of their policies to help them travel to or live in 18 mainland cities, including the nine that are part of the bay area, where the cost of living is lower.

"We will continue to develop services and products to meet the increasing demand from Hongkongers who want to retire" in the bay area, Tang said.

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DBS Private Bank, Hamilton Lane offer customised private assets solution in Asia

Distributed by Contify.com

1,244 words

23 July 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* DBS **Private Bank** and Hamilton Lane have collaborated to offer a bespoke private assets solution, known as Private Assets Tailored by Hamilton Lane (PATH), to DBS' ultra-high net worth clients and **family offices** in Asia.

* PATH enables qualified investors to curate a diversified portfolio of private market funds spanning private equity, credit, infrastructure, and real estate, tailored to their unique investment goals, risk tolerance, and preferences.

* The partnership brings together DBS' **wealth management** leadership in Asia and Hamilton Lane's three-decade track record and deep domain expertise in private markets, providing a best-of-both-worlds approach for clients.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, July 23 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

- Enables UHNW clients and **family offices** to invest in a fully customised and diversified private assets portfolio
- Amid current market turbulence, investing in private assets can offer investors meaningful diversification and enhance portfolio resilience

Amid growing client demand for alternative investments, DBS **Private Bank** and Hamilton Lane (Nasdaq: HLNE) have collaborated to offer the bank's ultra-high net worth clients and **family offices** a bespoke private assets solution. The latest move widens individual clients' access to a customised portfolio of top-tier private asset funds that, till now, has been largely available to only institutional investors.

Known as Private Assets Tailored by Hamilton Lane ("PATH"), the solution enables qualified[*] investors to curate a diversified portfolio of private market funds spanning private equity, credit, infrastructure, and real estate. PATH also offers the advantage of a portfolio tailored to each investor's unique investment goals, risk tolerance and preferences. It brings together DBS' **wealth management** leadership in Asia and Hamilton Lane's three-decade track record and deep domain expertise in private markets, as one of the world's largest private markets investment firms.

Even as private assets gain traction among investors, many investors lack a systematic portfolio approach often due to limited access to top-tier funds and the resources needed for rigorous due diligence. DBS **Private Bank** clients can enjoy a best-of-both-worlds approach: they gain access to Hamilton Lane's expertise and fund selection through PATH, without losing sight of their overall portfolio asset allocation.

"We've seen a nearly five-fold increase in our clients' assets under management in private assets over the past five years, reflecting the growing appetite for resilient, long-term investment opportunities beyond public markets," said Shee Tse Koon, Group Head of Consumer Banking and **Wealth Management**, DBS Bank. "With PATH, we are taking this momentum further by offering our clients an investment solution that comes with a level of customisation, transparency and diversification rarely seen in the private wealth space. More importantly, with a lower entry point compared to traditional institutional structures, PATH also makes private markets investing more accessible, allowing more of our clients to participate meaningfully in this asset class."

James Martin, Head of Global Client Solutions at Hamilton Lane, said: "Asia's private wealth investors are amongst the most sophisticated in the world, and this partnership with DBS is a key step in providing bespoke access to this discerning investor base. In an increasingly complex trade environment with uncertainties around

tariff and capital market volatility, we believe diversification of asset types and access to high-growth, privately held firms is paramount. This launch is the latest milestone in Hamilton Lane's journey as a global leader in providing institutional-grade private markets access to a broader set of investors."

As of 31 March 2025, Hamilton Lane manages and supervises approximately USD 958 billion in assets globally, drawing on 34 years of private markets expertise and access to proprietary data through Cobalt—one of the industry's largest databases with insights on over 64,070 funds and 164,490 portfolio companies[**]. This depth of insight underpins the firm's rigorous due diligence and portfolio construction process.

Since its launch some weeks ago, PATH has garnered strong interest among the bank's clients. "In fact, we recently closed a mandate with a **family office** client who saw tremendous value in PATH complementing his alternatives allocation, while remaining aligned with his investment profile and long-term wealth planning objectives," added Mr Shee.

The launch builds on DBS **Private Bank**'s continued efforts to broaden access to private markets in response to growing client demand. Eligible clients also gain access to exclusive opportunities through the bank's Private Assets Club, which provides early exposure to high-growth sectors such as artificial intelligence, biotechnology, space technology, and other frontier innovations. DBS has also facilitated exits from some of these investments, delivering significant realised returns for clients.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 16 consecutive years from 2009 to 2024.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

About Hamilton Lane

Hamilton Lane (Nasdaq: HLNE) is one of the largest private markets investment firms globally, providing innovative solutions to institutional and private wealth investors around the world. Dedicated exclusively to private markets investing for more than 30 years, the firm currently employs approximately 760 professionals operating in offices throughout North America, Europe, Asia Pacific and the Middle East. Hamilton Lane has approximately \$958 billion in assets under management and supervision, composed of more than \$138 billion in discretionary assets and more than \$819 billion in non-discretionary assets, as of March 31, 2025. Hamilton Lane specializes in building flexible investment programs that provide clients access to the full spectrum of private markets strategies, sectors and geographies. For more information, please visit our website or follow us on LinkedIn

Footnotes:

[*] Private asset solutions and strategies are only available to eligible accredited clients of DBS **Private Bank** and DBS Treasures Private Client. Associated risks should be carefully considered.

[**] As of 31 March 2025

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Private Equity and Venture Capital, Partnerships and Alliances]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

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BANKING & FINANCE

HSBC Global **Private Banking** appoints new senior leadership across S-E Asia, Australia markets

Chloe Lim

654 words

23 July 2025

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** announced on Tuesday (Jul 22) a series of senior appointments to deepen its coverage across South-east Asia, Australia and international markets.

These include Joanne Ng, who joins as a desk head for the Singapore team. She will lead a team of relationship managers to focus specifically on serving emerging high-net-worth (HNW) clients in Singapore.

Ng has more than 22 years of experience in **wealth management**, and joins from OCBC Premier Private Client. She will report to Hammad Hashmi, market head for Singapore, Malaysia, and Indonesia.

In December 2024, Annie Lim was also appointed as a desk head for Singapore, where her team focuses HNW and ultra-HNW (UHNW) segments. She has nearly 30 years of **private banking** experience across Lombard Odier, Credit Suisse, Standard Chartered and American Express.

In addition, Tim Morse will join the bank in August 2025 as senior business development manager, based in Australia. He held prior leadership roles at Citibank, JPMorgan and Deutsche Bank, and will focus on deepening collaboration between HSBC's onshore franchises and offshore **private banking** teams.

Tom Kinnear has also joined the bank as a relationship manager, covering Australia and international markets. He has extensive experience in global markets and institutional client coverage, and reports to Kapil Khanna, desk head for Australia, Japan and international markets.

Khanna assumed his position in July 2025 and is based in Singapore. He has experience in managing UHNW client relationships across Asia-Pacific and Europe, the Middle East and Africa, and was previously head of international investment counselling at HSBC.

He now leads coverage strategy for key developed markets -- focusing on founders, family businesses and internationally mobile clients.

Mina Chan was appointed desk head for the Philippines and Japan in April this year. Based in Hong Kong, she has been with HSBC since 2004, most recently leading the investment counselling team for the Philippines, Japan and international markets. Chan now oversees coverage teams in Ma-nila, Hong Kong and the broader region, and reports to Abhishek Mehrotra, South-east Asia and international market head.

Meanwhile, Tony Wong was appointed desk head for Malaysia in March 2025. He has over 17 years of **wealth management** experience at Citi, where he held various leadership roles. At HSBC, he leads the Malaysia team, and drives strategic growth across the market through internal collaboration and enterprise partnerships.

For the Malaysia team, Rayner Wong joins from Julius Baer and Samuel Chi joins from HSBC Premier. Both take on relationship manager roles, supporting client growth and coverage in the market.

Benjamin Wang was appointed desk head for Thailand and Vietnam in January, after serving as interim desk head since July 2024. With more than two decades in **private banking** across South-east Asia and Hong Kong, he leads HSBC's Thailand onshore and offshore teams from Singapore and Bangkok, focusing on client strategy and growth.

Urban Binggeli also joined the bank as desk head for Indonesia in January. He has over 15 years of **wealth management** experience, including previous roles at UBS and Credit Suisse. Based in Singapore, Binggeli focuses on strengthening HSBC's relationships with UHNW clients and family offices in the Indonesian market.

Senior relationship manager for the Indonesia team, Le Hong Sie, and relationship manager Leonard Eggert will report to Binggeli.

Le brings over 30 years of experience at HSBC in Indonesia, and now transitions into **private banking** coverage from Singapore.

As for Eggert, he previously spent six years as a corporate banker in Indonesia before relocating to Singapore in 2021, where he worked with German state-owned KfW bank prior to joining HSBC.

Tommy Leung, head of global **private banking** for South Asia at HSBC, said: "We're continuing to build momentum across South-east Asia by investing in top talent and deepening our cross-border capabilities."

Document STBT000020250722el7n003vi

Standard Chartered reveals growing appetite for transition investing in latest Sustainable Banking Report

Distributed by Contify.com

890 words

22 July 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Standard Chartered has a growing appetite for transition investing.
- * The bank's latest Sustainable Banking Report highlights opportunities for sustainable growth across Asia, Africa, and the Middle East.
- * Standard Chartered's business model combines cross-border capabilities with **wealth management** expertise.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, July 22 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

- New research shows that 87% of high-net-worth investors are interested in transition investing
- Barriers to investing include perception of higher risks, lack of benchmarking and perception of low returns
- Further awareness needed to bridge the knowledge gap around transition investing

Standard Chartered has today released new research that points to growing interest in transition investing^[1], with 87% of high-net-worth investors surveyed demonstrating appetite for this emerging area of investment. Data highlighted that interest in transition investing alongside sustainable investing more generally is overwhelmingly high at 87% and 83% respectively.

These findings were revealed in the Bank's latest Sustainable Banking Report^(Opens in a new window), which this year looks at transition investing and its potential to become the next wealth frontier. The report, titled "Transition investing: the next wealth frontier?", is based on a survey of 1,600 high-net-worth individuals across eight markets – Hong Kong, India, Mainland China, Malaysia, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan and the United Arab Emirates – and examines investor sentiment towards transition investing.

The report revealed investor interest in a range of transition themes that have the potential to support the transition towards a low-carbon economy, with green hydrogen, low-emission fuels and carbon capture and storage emerging as the top three themes of interest.

- * Green hydrogen (49%)
- * Low-emission fuels (47%)
- * Carbon capture and storage (45%)
- * Electric vehicles (44%)
- * Carbon markets (42%)
- * Electrification (32%)

Despite growing interest, the data highlighted that investors face several barriers when it comes to transition investing. The perception of higher risks was a top consideration among investors, with report findings also revealing considerations around a lack of benchmarking to compare investment products, and the perception that such investments could bring about low returns.

* Perception of higher risks (50%)

* Lack of benchmarks to compare with other investment products (46%)

* Perception of low returns (44%)

While investor appetite is strong, the findings indicated a gap in understanding, with only 15% of investors able to fully define the concept of transition investing[2]. To address this challenge and support clients, Standard Chartered has launched a Transition Investing Guide to provide clear and practical investor guidance for evaluating transition-related funds.

Samir Subberwal, Global Head, Wealth Solutions, Deposits and Mortgages, and Chief Client Officer, Standard Chartered said: "Over the years, our Sustainable Banking Reports have looked at a range of opportunities for investors, while showcasing sustainable investing as a key area of interest. We continue to see strong interest in sustainable investing among our affluent clients, and the concept of transition investing is one that our clients are increasingly interested in being educated on. As a leading international **wealth manager**, we remain committed to supporting our clients to empower them with the knowledge and tools they require to help enable the shift towards a low-carbon future."

Clarissa Tee

Wealth and Retail Banking Communications

About the Sustainable Banking Report 2025

The Sustainable Banking Report 2025(Opens in a new window) surveyed high-net-worth individuals with assets under management of USD1 million or more across eight key markets – Hong Kong, India, Mainland China, Malaysia, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan and the United Arab Emirates. A total of 1,600 respondents, aged 25 to 66 years old, participated in the survey in Q4 2024.

Transition Finance at Standard Chartered

We align ourselves to our Transition Finance Framework(Opens in a new window), which sets out the assets and activities that qualify under a 'transition' label when we undertake Transition Finance. Our Transition Finance Framework defines Transition Finance as any financial service provided to clients to support them aligning their business and / or operations with a 1.5-degree trajectory and is informed by the 2023 International Energy Agency Net Zero Emissions 2050 scenario.

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

Footnotes:

[1] Transition Investing is a sub-set of Sustainable Investing. It refers specifically to investing with the ambition of supporting and enabling the transition to a low carbon economy. This expands impactful investments to those outside of traditional climate solutions (e.g. renewable energy), to include companies in high-carbon sectors which have credible plans to align or maintain alignment of their business with a net zero trajectory. This can include organisations in sectors such as steel, and cement, but also companies which enable the transition of these sectors (e.g. scrap steel producers).

[2] Survey respondents were first asked an open-ended question on what they think transition investing is about before they were presented with a definition and examples.

[Category: Investment Banking and Brokerage, Asset and **Wealth Management**, ESG]

Source: Standard Chartered

Document ATINBK0020250722el7m000mi

Exclusive: HSBC GPB boosts SEA desk with seven appointments

Priyanka Boghani

372 words

22 July 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** (GPB) continues its hiring drive for the Southeast Asia region, bolstering its Singapore, Australia, Indonesia and Malaysia desks through a combination of new hires and internal reshuffles, Citywire Asia can reveal.

The bank has hired Tim Morse, Australia-based senior business development manager and Tom Kinnear, a relationship manager from the global markets and institutional coverage segment, to cover the Australia market.

Morse was a former marker manager for Thailand, Australia, New Zealand and Brunei at Citi **Private Bank**, and has also held stints at JP Morgan and Deutsche Bank. He will focus on deepening the collaboration between HSBC's onshore franchises and offshore **private banking** teams.

Kinnear will cover the Australia and international market from Singapore, where he will report to the recently [named](#) desk head for Australia, Japan and international, Kapil Khanna.

The Australia market falls under Abhishek Mehrotra, market head Southeast Asia international's team.

In addition, the **private bank** has hired Joanne Ng, as desk head for the Singapore team, reporting to Hammad Hashmi, market head, Singapore, Malaysia and Indonesia. She will lead a team of relationship managers serving the HNW clients. She joins from OCBC Premier Private Client.

For Malaysia, the bank has rejigged its teams internally, naming Le Hong Sie as a senior relationship manager after over 30 years across multiple corporate and institutional roles at HSBC. The Indonesia team, led by its desk head, Urban Binggeli, sees Leonard Eggert onboarded as a relationship manager.

Meanwhile, Rayner Wong and Samuel Chi Hao Kee join the Malaysia team as relationship managers, from Julius Baer and HSBC Premier, respectively.

The hires follow a string of developments in the bank's Southeast Asia strategy this year, that saw the appointments of Hong Kong-based Mina Chan as desk head for Philippines and Japan, Tony Wong as desk head of Malaysia in March, Benjamin Wang as desk head for Thailand and Vietnam in January and Annie Lim as desk head of Singapore in December 2024.

'We're continuing to build momentum across Southeast Asia by investing in top talent and deepening our cross-border capabilities,' said Tommy Leung (pictured), head of HSBC GPB, South Asia.

Document CWIRAS0020250722e17m00007

Business

Standard Chartered Global Chinese Services Hosts Landmark Global Market Outlook Event in Singapore

Yicai

988 words

21 July 2025

Yicai Global

YICAIG

English

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(Yicai) July 21 -- On July 17, 2025, Standard Chartered Bank hosted "Now's the time to flourish without borders—Standard Chartered Bank 'Global Chinese Services' H2 2025 Global Market Outlook" event at The Fullerton Hotel Singapore, gathering **wealth management** experts, business leaders, and key clients. This event, in partnership with Yicai, specially invited two distinguished guests to join the grand gathering. Organized by Standard Chartered Global Chinese Services, this landmark event shared the latest in-depth Global Market Outlook (GMO) insights and facilitated discussions on global Chinese group's development concerns across enterprise development, personal growth, and family wellbeing. This is the first ever Mandarin outlook event for priority banking clients in Singapore, and one of the few of its kind in Singapore. It aimed to address their unique challenges and opportunities, fostering exchanges and guidance for future endeavors.

"Global Chinese Services" offers a holistic, group-level service system for global Chinese, elevating offerings and refining strategies via cultural nuance recognition, aligned with the "3P Theory (Product-led, Proposition-led, and Purpose-led)" to explore mission-driven cross-cultural value creation. Long focused on clients' aspirations beyond wealth, fostering shared identity values among global Chinese (resonating with "shared destiny"), Standard Chartered leverages its worldwide network to deliver localized expertise as China's corporate globalizes and SMEs expand overseas, providing personalized banking, wealth, and legacy planning solutions, and integrated resources for healthcare, education, and overseas living, to support the global Chinese to expand their business, elevate their professional success, and empower their family prosperity.

Richard Li, Group Head of Global Chinese, Standard Chartered Bank, quoted at the event, "Through this GMO event, we not only shared Standard Chartered's latest **wealth management** insights, but also engaged in deep conversations around how global Chinese—especially entrepreneurs going global—can navigate today's complex macro environment. This dialogue has further strengthened our commitment to supporting global Chinese clients across their enterprise, personal, and family needs, including the increasingly important dimension of cultural and identity-based aspirations."

James Lye, Global and Singapore International Banking Head, Standard Chartered Bank, welcomed clients to the event with an opening address. Lye highlighted Standard Chartered's international network and cross-border expertise. "We pride ourselves on being a trusted partner to our clients as they navigate an increasingly complex global landscape. Our strength as a leading international **wealth manager** allows us to bring timely and on-ground insights like those shared at the outlook event to our clients, connecting them to global opportunities," adds Lye.

2025 H2 Global Market Outlook and Investment Strategies

Ethan Wang, Head of Investment Strategy, Standard Chartered Bank China, and Audrey Goh, Head of Asset Allocation, Wealth Solutions Chief Investments Officer, Standard Chartered Bank, provided in-depth analysis of the market trends and investment strategies for the second half of 2025.

Ethan Wang explained the metaphor in the H2 GMO theme "Whale fall nourishes all life; tide ebbs, boat advances" that describes the shifting global dynamics, highlighting the potential convergence of "U.S. exceptionalism." He noted that the global economic engine is moving from U.S. dominance to a more balanced state, with a weakening U.S. dollar reshaping asset allocation—particularly in ex-Japan Asia and China equities—alongside non-U.S. dollar bonds and gold, where gold acts as a hedge against volatility and currency risks. Ethan Wang advised global Chinese investors to embrace flexibility, exploring sustainable finance and digital assets beyond traditional options.

Audrey Goh highlighted the U.S. dollar's decline as a transformative shift, potentially driving capital inflows into emerging markets via lower dollar borrowing costs. This trend will reshape international trade and exchange rates, creating new investment opportunities globally. She detailed strategies: reducing cash holdings in favor of structured deposits, mutual funds, and ETFs; prioritizing high-quality dividend stocks for stable income; and tailoring allocations—conservative investors leaning into bonds, income seekers combining high-yield bonds and dividends, and growth-focused investors targeting clean energy and AI.

Global Chinese Insight Fireside Chat: Navigating Global Challenges for Overseas Entrepreneurs

The fireside chat, centered on "Navigating Global Challenges for Overseas Entrepreneurs," was moderated by Richard Li, with Lee Kok How, Economist, Lecturer and Columnist in Singapore; Han Lei, MD of Hann-Ocean Technology Group, an outstanding representative of Global Chinese entrepreneur, joining the discussion.

When talking about the challenges brought by global changes, Lee Kok How pointed out, based on market observations, that enterprises need to strike a balance between adapting to local policies and maintaining their own roots, and particularly emphasized the anchoring role of cultural and value identity in cross-border development. Henry L Han, drawing on his own experience in global expansion, added that to gain a firm foothold amid uncertainties, both systematic strategic adjustments and adherence to one's core values are essential.

In his summary, Richard Li elaborated on Standard Chartered Bank's philosophy in coping with the changing times: advocating "Be Bold, Be True" as the key to navigating through volatility. Based on this, Standard Chartered focuses on the in-depth needs of global Chinese and building a global Chinese community. It not only supports their cross-border business expansion and family planning through integrated financial resources but also makes efforts to preserve their cultural roots and identity. From providing Chinese-language services and linking global cultural resources to facilitating education and inheritance planning for the next generation, it comprehensively supports global Chinese in achieving steady development in the changing times, making cultural identity a driving force for development across regions.

The event in Singapore not only provided valuable market insights of 2025 H2 Global Market Outlook but also demonstrated Standard Chartered Bank's commitment to its "Global Chinese Services" initiative, aiming to support the global Chinese community in achieving their business, financial and life goals in an ever-changing global environment.

[Click here to view image.](#)

Document YICAIG0020250721eI7I00031

Nomura names ex-StanChart exec as ME, Europe wealth head

Paromita Dey

335 words

21 July 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Nomura has confirmed the appointment of Harish Hemandas as head of its international wealth management (IWM) business for the Middle East and Europe, according to an internal memo seen by Citywire Middle East.

Hemandas joins from Standard Chartered, where he served as managing director and held several senior roles across private banking, treasury, and global financial markets. With more than 30 years of experience in the region, Hemandas most recently led the growth of Standard Chartered's private banking business across the Middle East and Africa.

He [succeeds Adil Khan](#), who previously led Nomura's IWM business for the Middle East, Africa, and South Asia, and stepped down after five years in the role.

Based in Dubai, Hemandas will lead Nomura Singapore Limited's Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) branch, subject to regulatory approvals. He will also serve as the senior executive officer (SEO) and head of coverage for the Middle East and Europe.

In his new role, Hemandas will be tasked with scaling Nomura's IWM franchise by driving business with high- and ultra-high-net-worth individuals, family offices, external asset managers, and other key client segments across the Middle East and Europe. As SEO, he will also oversee governance and control for the DIFC branch, ensuring regulatory compliance and robust risk management as the platform expands.

He will report to Singapore-based Anurag Mahesh, head of coverage for Southeast Asia, Global South Asia, and the Middle East at Nomura IWM.

The Japanese lender [first unveiled](#) plans to grow its wealth management presence in the region in 2022, with the launch of a DIFC branch under Nomura Singapore Limited. The firm [received a category 4 licence](#) from the Dubai Financial Services Authority (DFSA) and officially opened its office in July 2023.

The IWM platform focuses on serving high-net-worth clients, single-family offices, and external asset managers across the UAE and broader Middle East, including the GCC, North Africa, and the Levant.

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DBS appoints Loic Voide as Head of Private Banking for Middle East & Africa

Distributed by Contify.com

908 words

14 July 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* DBS Bank appoints Loic Voide as Head of **Private Banking** for Middle East & Africa, effective 1 August 2025.

* Loic Voide was previously Chief Executive Officer and Chief Country Officer of Deutsche Bank (Switzerland) and has held senior positions at UBS **Wealth Management** and Credit Suisse.

* DBS operates in the Middle East through its branch at the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) and serves **private banking** clients across the GCC and Africa with tailored investment advisory and bespoke portfolio diversification solutions.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Regional, July 14 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

DBS Bank today named Loic Voide to the newly-created role of Head of **Private Banking** for Middle East & Africa (MEA), effective 1 August 2025. He will be based at DBS' branch in the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC).

Voide was most recently Chief Executive Officer and Chief Country Officer of Deutsche Bank (Switzerland). Prior to that, he served as co-CEO and Head of **Private Banking** for MEA. A veteran of the **wealth management** industry with deep expertise in the MEA region, Voide has held senior positions at several leading **private banks** including UBS **Wealth Management** and Credit Suisse.

At DBS, Voide will report to Vikas Jaidka, Region Head (Middle East, Africa, NRI), DBS **Private Bank**, and be responsible for driving growth and performance across the region, with a focus on ultra-high net worth clients and their families.

Said Shee Tse Koon, Group Head of Consumer Banking and **Wealth Management**, DBS Bank: "The growth of our **wealth management** franchise is underpinned not only by Asia's burgeoning wealth but also our ability to facilitate capital and wealth flows between the Middle East, Asia and beyond. We are therefore delighted to have Loic on board. Loic brings with him a wealth of experience and will play an integral role in taking our **private banking** business in the region to the next level. We will continue to strengthen our franchise by adding to our talent pool and investing in technology, as part of our commitment to providing bespoke wealth solutions via our award-winning 'phygital' model."

DBS operates in the Middle East through its branch at the DIFC. The Dubai presence offers many advantages, including being a vital gateway to the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) countries and Africa – two key wealth corridors that anchor the bank's global **wealth management** footprint.

In recent years, DBS has also observed a growing trend of Middle Eastern families establishing family offices in Asia, with Singapore and Hong Kong – where the **private bank**'s booking centres are located – emerging as preferred destinations. Dedicated wealth planning teams support these clients with customised legacy and estate planning services to meet multi-generational needs.

Leveraging its award-winning 'phygital' model and world-class wealth platform, DBS serves **private banking** clients across the GCC and Africa with tailored investment advisory and bespoke portfolio diversification solutions. The bank also advises clients on both their personal and business needs through its integrated 'One

Bank' approach, allowing them to tap into its corporate and investment banking capabilities to expand their businesses across Asia.

As at April 2025, DBS' high net worth assets under management stood at USD 236.6 billion, placing third in Asian **Private Banker's** Asia 2024 AUM league table. Most recently, DBS was named "World's Best **Private Bank** for HNW" and "Asia's Best **Private Bank**" by Euromoney and "Best **Private Bank** in Asia for Family Offices" by Professional **Wealth Management**. These accolades are an endorsement of DBS' wealth proposition, strong culture of innovation and client focus.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 16 consecutive years from 2009 to 2024.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Retail Banking, Banks, Management/ Leadership Changes]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020250723e17e000gr

Exclusive: StanChart PB cancels client event in Thailand on compliance concerns

Priyanka Boghani

621 words

10 July 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered **Private Bank** has had to call off its event for Thailand-based clients in the country's capital, Citywire Asia understands.

The British lender, which does not have an onshore presence in Thailand via a securities or operating business license, decided to scrap the function after an internal review.

Citywire Asia reached out to Standard Chartered for a comment.

The local regulator, the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC), issued a circular last year cautioning that services cannot be provided to Thai investors without obtaining a securities/derivatives license.

According to a translation of the circular, the SEC said 'foreign business operators and their personnel must exercise caution to ensure their actions or missions do not constitute operating a business without a license'.

The SEC gave examples of presenting or acting in a regular business manner to offer securities services, including soliciting Thai investors to use investment services.

The regulator said this includes inviting individuals to attend training, opening trading accounts, managing funds and offering sale or providing information or advice on investment products. Organising seminars and promotional activities through direct contact or online channels, and using a foreign website were also all classified as 'wrongful activities'.

For securities businesses, the penalties include imprisonment for a term of two to five years and fines ranging from THB200,000 (\$6,120) to THB500,000. For derivatives businesses, the penalties include imprisonment for a term of up to three years, a fine not exceeding 300,000 baht, or both.

Having already run events in Singapore, the Philippines and other key markets in the region, Standard Chartered **Private Bank** is seeking ways to increase the number of onshore clients it caters to. This is the first time it has had to cancel an event in the country.

Citywire Asia understands that the bank has not been approached by the regulator.

Thailand in demand

Thailand continues to be an attractive place for **private banks** due to the ease of doing business there. Its pegged to become the billionaire capital of Southeast Asia and was home to 28 in 2023, according to a UBS report, and over 125,000 US dollar millionaires.

But there are differing views on how best to capture the growing onshore opportunity. Some banks, such as BNP Paribas **Wealth Management**, DBS, LGT and HSBC, have set up an onshore entity in Thailand, while others, like UBS Global **Wealth Management** and Standard Chartered, run an offshore Thailand business from Singapore.

UBS GWM **shuttered** the onshore Thailand **wealth management** business of Credit Suisse's following its takeover in 2023, moving their onshore clients to the Singapore offshore booking centre. The Swiss giant, however, does have an investment bank in Thailand.

Citi **Private Bank** also does not have a presence in Thailand, but has had an entity for corporate clients for many years, according to its website.

Meanwhile, Julius Baer took the joint-venture route with Siam Commercial Bank.

The country is also attracting interest from external asset managers and multi family offices, such as Hong Kong-headquartered Raffles Family Office. Raffles FO, which has a presence in Thailand with a representative office in Bangkok, set up its new office in May 2024, led by managing director and market head of Thailand, Thidatip Thitikarunwong.

The move came in response to increasing interest and queries from wealthy individuals and families in Thailand, Chi-man Kwan, group CEO and co-founder of Raffles FO said at the time of the opening.

In October 2023, Singapore-based TriLake Partners also announced the opening an office in Thailand, helmed by Patrick Lauener, COO, partner and head of the representative office of TriLake Partners in Thailand.

Document CWIRAS0020250710eI7a00001

THE STRAITS TIMES

Front Page Business

S'pore must balance risks as it seeks new opportunities: Chee

Angela Tan

739 words

10 July 2025

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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Singapore must be willing to take some risks to capture new opportunities in the burgeoning **wealth management** sector.

This was the thrust of a doorstep interview given on July 9 by Minister for National Development Chee Hong Tat, who is deputy chairman of the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS).

He told the media after a visit to DBS Bank that Singapore must be willing to take some risks even as it strives to maintain high standards and be a convenient and trusted financial centre.

"When we talk about risk, we take a risk-proportionate approach and not zero-risk approach because if we are overly 'kiasu', I think we would not be able to capture new opportunities," he said, using the local lingo that refers to a grasping attitude arising from a fear of missing out on something.

"So there is a need for us to strike a balance and go for high standards but a risk-proportionate approach, not a zero-risk approach."

Mr Chee was speaking after his visit to DBS, where he met the bank's chief investment officer for consumer banking and **wealth management**, Mr Hou Wey Fook, and several relationship managers.

He said the two goals of wanting to maintain high standards in the sector on the one hand, and making sure processes are efficient and convenient for customers on the other are not mutually exclusive.

MAS has been working closely with industry partners to see how it can strike a good balance between the two different objectives and to continue to improve processes.

The financial regulator has cut the time taken for family offices to apply for tax incentives to "within three months" from 12 months previously, Mr Chee noted.

MAS is also working with private banks to see how it can further cut the time taken for customers to set up and open accounts, he added.

"We will still have to do the necessary checks," he said.

Mr Chee said MAS will work with the industry to provide greater clarity in terms of what the regulator wants banks and relationship managers to focus on to avoid second-guessing and delaying the opening of customers' accounts.

MAS is also working with other government agencies, including the Economic Development Board, to help high-net-worth individuals seeking to come to Singapore to bring more of their investments here.

This "whole-government approach" could see Singapore helping the super-rich set up new companies and operations here, invest in companies, potentially list on the Singapore Exchange, and more as they see the Republic as "a trusted, stable place where they can make long-term plans", Mr Chee said.

His comments came in the wake of MAS' announcement on July 4 that it has imposed on nine financial institutions (FIs) composition penalties totalling \$27.45 million over breaches related to a \$3 billion money-laundering case in 2023. All nine FIs, including UOB, UBS and Citi, accepted the penalties for their violations.

The 2023 money-laundering case underscores the need for continued vigilance by banks and other intermediaries because Singapore, as an international financial centre, is an attractive location to both legitimate wealth and money launderers, observers said.

Those involved used forged documents and made claims unsupported by documentation to explain their fund inflows and source of wealth to the financial institutions.

Some FIs did not adequately establish and corroborate customers' purported source of wealth and follow up on suspicious transactions.

MAS' actions pertain to FIs' controls and compliance against money laundering and financing of terrorism. It noted that the breaches arose out of "poor or inconsistent" implementation of these policies and controls.

The police had also investigated the case and taken decisive actions, including the seizure and recovery of sizeable assets.

In its supervisory examinations of pertinent FIs with nexus to the \$3 billion money-laundering case, MAS had investigated FIs beyond the nine that had received composition penalties.

Despite the uncertain global environment, Singapore's **wealth management** sector has been resilient. Assets under management here reached \$5.41 trillion as at Dec 31, 2023, up 10 per cent from 2022.

Mr Chee said Singapore has seen a "very healthy" growth in its **wealth management** sector over the last five years, with the compound annual growth rate of more than 8 per cent witnessed for private banking client assets.

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Stock in news

Affluent Indians shift gears as interest rises in alternatives, gold, global investing: HSBC report

Nishtha Awasthi

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The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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Wealthy Indian investors are signaling a notable shift in their investment strategy, with a rising preference for alternative assets, managed solutions, and overseas diversification, according to the HSBC 2025 Affluent Investor Snapshot. The report, based on a survey of 10,797 affluent investors across 12 global markets, reveals a growing appetite for diversified portfolios, especially among Indian investors who are increasingly looking beyond traditional holdings. HSBC notes that affluent Indians are now leaning toward multi-asset strategies, alternative investments, and managed products like mutual funds, reflecting a broader evolution in wealth management goals. According to Sandeep Batra, Head of International Wealth and Personal Banking at HSBC India, "There is a notable shift among affluent individuals in India toward a more strategic approach to portfolio management.

There is a growing emphasis on making money work harder over extended time horizons." He added that Indian investors are "actively diversifying across various asset classes, including alternatives, and exploring opportunities beyond their domestic markets." Gold, alternatives lead portfolio changes Within Indian portfolios, gold has seen the highest increase in allocation over the past year, rising from 8% to 15%, followed by alternative investments. Managed investments, equities, and gold remain the dominant holdings. Indian investors also maintain the lowest average cash allocation in Asia at just 15%, indicating a higher willingness to deploy capital into growth-oriented assets. Globally, Gen Z and millennial investors are leading this trend, cutting down cash allocations from 31% to 17% on average. In India, while affluent investors have already reduced cash allocations, their global peers remain divided: 30% plan to increase cash allocations, 20% plan to reduce them, and half intend to keep them unchanged over the next 12 months. Also read: Baseless and malicious: Vedanta slams Viceroy report, says claims 'meant to discredit' the group Global diversification on the rise Affluent investors in India and globally are also showing rising interest in international diversification. The US ranks as the top destination for overseas investments, while markets like Singapore, Hong Kong, UAE, and the UK also remain attractive. HSBC's findings show that 4 in 10 global affluent investors plan to invest internationally in the next 12 months, with the highest intent reported in the UAE (56%) and Singapore (50%). Notably, investors in key wealth hubs not only look abroad but also show strong preferences for investments within their own regions. The report also notes increasing interest in opening overseas investment accounts, with the US, Singapore, and Hong Kong ranking highest in preference. Confidence high despite global uncertainty Despite macroeconomic headwinds, Indian investors remain significantly more optimistic than their global counterparts. According to HSBC's findings, over 90% of Indian respondents are confident in achieving their short-term goals, more than 80% in medium-term goals, and 86% in long-term financial objectives. Globally, 8 in 10 affluent investors remain confident in meeting their financial goals, with retirement planning emerging as the most important long-term priority across generations. In India, property investment, financial support for family, and personal well-being savings top the list of financial priorities. Additionally, 85% of Indian respondents expressed satisfaction with their quality of life, underscoring both financial confidence and lifestyle security despite rising living costs and broader economic concerns. The report highlights a growing trend of portfolio evolution, where affluent Indian investors are increasingly turning toward alternatives, reducing idle cash, adding gold, and exploring international markets, with confidence and strategic clarity driving the shift. (Disclaimer: Recommendations, suggestions, views and opinions given by the experts are their own. These do not represent the views of The Economic Times)

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NRI Work

Singapore cuts queue time for global rich to set up family offices

503 words

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The Economic Times

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Singapore has reduced the wait time for family offices applying for tax incentives from 12 months to three, according to the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS). The move was confirmed by MAS Deputy Chairman Chee Hong Tat during a visit to DBS Group Holdings Ltd., as reported by Bloomberg. He said MAS is also working with private banks to help wealthy clients open accounts faster. "We are also working closely with the private banking industry group to see how we can further reduce the time taken for the clients to set up" accounts, he said. Growth of single family offices At the UBS Asia Wealth Forum held in Singapore earlier this year, Chee said the number of single family offices in Singapore rose to 2,000 in 2024—up from 1,650 in 2023. This reflects a 21 per cent increase in just one year, according to a Reuters report published in January. "There will be, I think, more interest from investors to look at Singapore as a key node and hub in Asia," Chee told participants at the forum.

"We want to see how we can offer greater variety of investment options, including for people who want to put their wealth here also to grow their wealth," he added. Singapore has benefited from strong inflows of wealth into Asia, aided by a favourable tax regime, political stability, and its role as a regional investment base. Indian diaspora reshapes Singapore's family office landscape Nearly 60 per cent of Asia's family offices are now based in Singapore, The Straits Times reported. Among the high-profile names is the Ambani family, which set up its Singapore family office in 2022. They are joined by a younger wave of Indian entrepreneurs who are now formalising their succession plans through dedicated structures to avoid internal disputes and improve asset governance. According to DBS Bank, an estimated US\$4 trillion (S\$5.3 trillion) in wealth is expected to transfer across generations among the Indian diaspora over the next decade. In 2023, about 6,500 high-net-worth Indians moved abroad, with Singapore remaining one of the preferred destinations. "Singapore is a top destination for ultra-high-net-worth individual Indian families looking to establish a family office outside of India," said Shee Tse Koon, head of consumer banking and wealth management at DBS. Many Indian families are now shifting away from traditional holdings like real estate and gold, opting instead for a more diversified mix of public equities, private capital, and start-up investments. According to DBS, Indian family offices have participated in over 200 start-up funding rounds over the past two decades. This shift in strategy reflects broader concerns over volatility in the real estate sector, both in India and abroad. Family offices are increasingly focused on formalising their wealth management through structures that support trust management and estate planning, ensuring continuity across generations.

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MINT, News

Three months to set up: Singapore reduces wait time for family offices to woo world's super-rich

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Mint

HNMINT

English

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New Delhi, July 9 -- Singapore's financial watchdog has decided to shorten the waiting time for wealthy people who are looking to manage their assets in the Asian wealth hub.

The move aims to solidify Singapore's wealth management industry even as the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS) vows to uphold tight regulatory standards, a senior official said on Wednesday.

In a significant change, wealthy individuals and families applying for tax incentives to set up their family offices in the city-state will now need less time than before, reported Reuters.

Previously, this process could take up to 12 months. However, after the change, the applicants can expect to wait up to a maximum of three months.

This expedited timeline was announced by Chee Hong Tat, the Deputy Chairman of MAS, during a media visit to DBS Group Holdings Ltd., the country's biggest bank

Beyond family offices, the regulatory body is also actively working with private banks to help their clients open accounts faster.

"We are also working closely with the private banking industry group to see how we can further reduce the time taken for the clients to set up" accounts, said Chee.

This initiative reflects Singapore's goal of creating a more efficient and attractive space for global wealth.

Chee's comments underscore Singapore's calculative approach to expanding the country's local wealth management sector.

The government is willing to take what it calls "proportionate" risks to foster the industry's growth while also ensuring that its high standards of financial integrity and regulation are not compromised.

Singapore is swiftly climbing the ranks among the world's largest asset-management centres and emerging as a preferred destination for offshore wealth stewardship, reported Bloomberg.

It is also emerging as a growing spot for family offices and philanthropy as the number of Single Family Offices (SFOs) in Singapore has grown from 400 in 2020 to 1,650 as of September 2024, solidifying its status as a key destination for global wealth management, the report said.

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HSBC announces Sami Abouzahr as Global Head of Investments and Managed Solutions, Wealth and Premier Solutions

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513 words

8 July 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Sami Abouzahr will spearhead the bank's wealth product strategy and deliver sustainable investment solutions to **private banking** and premier wealth clients globally.

* He will lead the Ultra High Net Worth Solutions Group (USG) to leverage the team's expertise in driving seamless client experience for ultra high net worth individuals, families, and entrepreneurs worldwide.

* Sami Abouzahr currently serves as Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions, Hong Kong, and will continue to lead the team until the appointment of his successor.

Original Press Release:

July 8 -- HSBC **Private Bank** issued the following news release:

HSBC announces the appointment of Sami Abouzahr as Global Head of Investments and Managed Solutions, Wealth and Premier Solutions, effective 1 July 2025. In his new role, Sami spearheads the bank's wealth product strategy and delivery of sustainable investment, fund, discretionary portfolio management and alternative investment solutions to **private banking** and premier wealth clients globally.

Based in Hong Kong, Sami continues to report to Lavanya Chari, Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions, HSBC. With the expanded responsibilities of this role, he also leads the bank's Ultra High Net Worth Solutions Group ('USG') to leverage the breadth and depth of the team's expertise in driving seamless client experience for ultra high net worth individuals, families and entrepreneurs worldwide.

Sami is currently Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions, Hong Kong, and continues to lead the team until the appointment of his successor, in due course. Throughout his career in financial services, Sami has held several leadership positions across the bank's operations in Hong Kong, mainland China and the UK, spanning wealth management, asset management and wholesale banking.

Lavanya Chari, Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions, HSBC, said: "We have been advising our clients to diversify their investment portfolios to mitigate risks amid market uncertainties. This appointment will reinforce the implementation of our market insights to guide our clients in accessing investment opportunities across regions, sectors and asset classes.

"I'm confident that Sami will continuously instil our client-centric ethos when developing and delivering innovative solutions to help our clients realise their ambitions along their wealth journey, from growing to passing on their wealth to the next generation."

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 58 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,054 billion at 31 March 2025, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Financial/ Capital Market, Asset and Wealth Management, Management/ Leadership Changes]

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